

THE COMPLETE 12-HOUR VIDEO COURSE — IN BOOK FORM

IELTS

MASTER COURSE

Listening • Reading • Writing • Speaking

The Most Comprehensive IELTS Preparation Book Ever Created
From Beginner Foundations to Band 7+ Mastery

15 Chapters • 4 Full Modules • 100s of Worked Examples
Practice Tests • Model Essays & Reports • Speaking Bank
Study Plans • Vocabulary & Grammar • Answer Keys

Compiled from the 12-part IELTS Master-Course video series (Beginners 2023)

Academic + General Training • Paper & Computer-Delivered

2026 Edition

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Chapter 1: Understanding the IELTS Test

1.1 What IELTS Is — and What It Is Not

The International English Language Testing System (IELTS) is the world's most widely taken English proficiency test for study, work, and migration. It is jointly owned by the British Council, IDP: IELTS Australia, and Cambridge University Press and Assessment, and it is accepted by more than 12,000 organisations worldwide, including universities, employers, professional bodies, and immigration authorities in the UK, Australia, Canada, New Zealand, and the USA.

IELTS is a test of **language skill, not subject knowledge**. As the video course stresses repeatedly (Video Parts 1–3), the Reading test examines your reading *skills* — not what you know about the topic — and the same principle applies everywhere: examiners reward how you use English, never the opinions you express. There are no "right" or "wrong" ideas in Speaking and Writing; there is only effective or ineffective communication.

TIP. IELTS tests four separate skills — Listening, Reading, Writing, Speaking — and reports each one on a 9-band scale. Your Overall Band Score is the average of the four, rounded to the nearest half band.

1.2 The Two Test Formats: Academic vs General Training

Everyone takes the same Listening and Speaking tests. Reading and Writing differ by module:

Feature	Academic	General Training
Who it is for	University study (undergraduate/postgraduate), professional registration (doctors, nurses, engineers)	Migration, work experience, training, secondary education
Reading texts	3 long texts from books, journals, magazines, newspapers; academic topics of general interest for a non-specialist audience	3–5 shorter texts: notices, adverts, timetables, company handbooks, official documents, plus one longer general-interest text
Writing Task 1	Describe visual information (graph, table, chart, process, map) in at least 150 words	Write a letter (formal, semi-formal, or informal) in at least 150 words
Writing Task 2	Same for both: discursive essay of at least 250 words	Same for both: discursive essay of at least 250 words
Listening	Identical: 4 sections, 40 questions, 30 minutes (+10 minutes transfer on paper)	Identical
Speaking	Identical: 3 parts, 11–14 minutes, face-to-face or video-call with an examiner	Identical

WARNING. Choose your module before you book. Universities almost always require Academic; immigration usually requires General Training. If you take the wrong module, your result is useless for your purpose and there are no refunds.

1.3 Paper-Based vs Computer-Delivered IELTS

Content, timing, scoring, and question types are identical. Only the delivery differs:

Feature	Paper-based	Computer-delivered
Listening transfer time	10 minutes to copy answers to the answer sheet	2 minutes to check answers on screen
Reading/Writing	Booklets + answer sheets; handwritten essays	On-screen reading with highlighting; typed essays with word counter
Results	3–5 days (faster than the old 13-day wait in most centres)	1–2 days
Speaking	Face-to-face (unchanged in both options)	Face-to-face or video call, depending on centre
Best for	Candidates who think on paper, sketch plans by hand, or type slowly	Fast typists, candidates who want quick results and easy editing

TIP. The video course (Part 1) demonstrates the paper test with its CD-based Listening. Every strategy in this book works for both delivery modes; differences are flagged wherever they matter (notably Listening transfer time and Writing word counts).

1.4 The Four Modules at a Glance

Listening — 30 minutes, 4 sections, 40 questions

Section	Context	Typical speakers	Typical tasks
1	Everyday social situation (booking, enquiry, application)	2 speakers: conversation	Form, note, table completion (e.g., the course's <i>Dubai Palm Apartments</i> enquiry)
2	Everyday social situation (monologue: tour, talk, instructions)	1 speaker	Map labelling, matching, multiple choice, sentence completion
3	Academic/training discussion (students + tutor)	2–4 speakers	Multiple choice, matching, diagram/flow-chart completion (e.g., the course's <i>Self-Access Centre</i> discussion)
4	Academic lecture/monologue	1 speaker	Note/summary completion, table completion, short answers

Each correct answer earns one mark; the raw score out of 40 converts to a band (see 1.6). Spelling must be correct. If the instruction says **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS**, writing three words makes the answer wrong even if the meaning is right.

Reading — 60 minutes, 3 sections, 40 questions

Academic: 3 passages totalling 2,200–2,750 words, increasing in difficulty. General Training: Section 1 (2–3 short everyday texts), Section 2 (2 workplace texts), Section 3 (1 long general-interest text). There is **no extra transfer time** — you must write answers on the answer sheet as you go (paper) or as you read (computer).

The course's golden rule (Parts 2–3): **IELTS Reading is a test of understanding synonym language.** Questions paraphrase the passage; answers are found by matching *meaning*, never identical words. You also do **not** have to answer questions 1–40 in order — Chapters 6–8 teach you the optimal order per passage.

Writing — 60 minutes, 2 tasks

Task	Academic	General Training	Time	Weight
Task 1 (150+ words)	Report describing a graph, table, chart, process/cycle, or map	Letter for a given situation and purpose	~20 min	1/3 of Writing band
Task 2 (250+ words)	Essay responding to a point of view, argument, or problem	Identical to Academic	~40 min	2/3 of Writing band

You are scored in four equally weighted criteria (25% each): Task Achievement (T1) / Task Response (T2), Coherence and Cohesion, Lexical Resource, and Grammatical Range and Accuracy. Chapter 11 unpacks every criterion with the exact descriptors examiners use.

Speaking — 11–14 minutes, 3 parts, with a human examiner

Part	Format	Timing	What happens
1	Interview: familiar topics (home, work, study, hobbies)	4–5 min	Short questions, short answers (2–4 sentences each). Examiners listen for natural tense control (see the course's <i>Using the right verb tense</i> lesson, Part 5).
2	Long turn: 1-minute preparation + 1–2 minute talk from a cue card	3–4 min	You speak alone. Structure + past-tense storytelling + opinion = high bands.
3	Discussion: abstract questions linked to Part 2	4–5 min	Longer, analytical answers with reasons, examples, and concessions.

Scoring mirrors Writing: Fluency and Coherence, Lexical Resource, Grammatical Range and Accuracy, and Pronunciation — 25% each. There is no pass or fail: you are placed on the 9-band scale.

1.5 How the Course Videos Map to This Book

The 12-part video Master-Course (about 11.5 hours, recorded live with 150+ learners) teaches beginners through worked classroom exercises. This book follows the same journey but expands every lesson into a complete reference:

Video Parts	Course content	Book chapters
Parts 1–4	Listening foundations and practice (form/note/table completion, multiple choice, maps; dates, numbers, spelling, letter sounds) + Reading foundations (skimming/scanning/detail, synonym language, T/F/NG, question types)	Chapters 3–8
Parts 5–7	Speaking: the 4 criteria, verb tenses, Parts 1–3 technique, cue cards, pronunciation, first-language interference	Chapters 9–10

Video Parts	Course content	Book chapters
Parts 8–11	Writing Task 1 Academic (scoring, overview, three essential sentence patterns, trend vocabulary, model reports) + Task 2 foundations (scoring, sentence variety, cohesion)	Chapters 11–12
Part 12	Writing General Training letters + Task 2 essay types and full essay construction	Chapters 12–13
Throughout	Study advice, exam-day guidance, grammar and vocabulary teaching	Chapters 2, 14–15

TIP. Every worked example in this book is either taken directly from the video lessons (such as the *Dubai Palm Apartments* enquiry, the *Sanjay expedition* notes, the *Parks and open spaces* table, the *Thames Tunnel* T/F/NG passage, and the *arrests per year* graph) or newly created to practise the same skills the videos teach. When an example comes from the videos, it is credited.

1.6 Scoring: Raw Marks to Bands

Listening and Reading bands come from raw scores. The conversion varies slightly per test version; these are the standard boundaries:

Band	Listening (raw /40)	Reading Academic (raw /40)	Reading GT (raw /40)
9	39–40	39–40	40
8.5	37–38	37–38	39
8	35–36	35–36	37–38
7.5	32–34	33–34	35–36
7	30–31	30–32	33–34
6.5	26–29	27–29	31–32
6	23–25	23–26	28–30
5.5	19–22	19–22	24–27
5	15–18	15–18	20–23
4.5	13–14	13–14	17–19
4	10–12	10–12	14–16

Writing and Speaking are scored directly against public band descriptors (Chapters 9 and 11 reproduce the working versions). The Overall Band is the mean of the four module bands, rounded: anything ending in .25 rounds up to the next half band; anything ending in .75 rounds up to the next whole band. So 6.25 becomes 6.5, 6.75 becomes 7.0, and 6.125 becomes 6.0.

What each band means (official summary)

Band	Level	Description
9	Expert user	Full operational command; accurate, fluent, fully appropriate English.

Band	Level	Description
8	Very good user	Fully operational command with only occasional unsystematic inaccuracies.
7	Good user	Operational command with occasional inaccuracies and misunderstandings in some situations.
6	Competent user	Effective command despite inaccuracies and misunderstandings; can use fairly complex language in familiar situations.
5	Modest user	Partial command; copes with overall meaning in most situations but makes many mistakes.
4	Limited user	Basic competence limited to familiar situations; frequent problems in understanding and expression.
0–3	Extremely limited / intermittent / non-user	Little or no communicative ability.

Most universities require 6.5–7.5 overall (often with minimum module scores); professional registration commonly demands 7.0 in every module; migration thresholds vary by country and visa class. Check your target institution's exact requirement — including minimum per-module scores — before you plan your preparation.

1.7 Frequently Asked Questions

How long is my result valid? Two years from the test date. After that, organisations will not accept it.

Can I retake? Yes, as often as you like, including One Skill Retake (available in many centres): if you miss your target in exactly one module, you can resit just that module within 60 days of the original test.

Can I ask for a remark? Yes — an Enquiry on Results (EOR) re-marks your test. It takes 2–21 days and the fee is refunded if your score changes. Remarks most often succeed in Writing and Speaking (± 0.5).

British or American spelling? Either is accepted everywhere, but be consistent within Writing, and in Listening/Reading match the recording's or passage's spelling where a word is given.

Is IELTS easier in some countries? No. The test, scoring, and examiner standards are global. Choose the centre where you feel most comfortable and can get your preferred date.

How much do I need to write? Task 1: at least 150 words (aim 160–190). Task 2: at least 250 words (aim 260–290). Under-length answers lose Task Achievement/Response marks automatically. There is no maximum, but overlong answers waste time and accumulate errors.

Can I use a pen or must I use a pencil? On paper, use a pencil (HB) for Listening and Reading answer sheets — you can erase and correct. For Writing, pen or pencil are both accepted; pencil is safer for corrections.

What if I miss my Speaking test? It may be scheduled on a different day from the other modules (up to 7 days before or after). Confirm your Speaking slot and arrive 30 minutes early.

1.8 Booking, ID & Test-Day Rules

Booking (4 steps): 1. Choose module (Academic/GT) + format (paper/computer) + centre at ielts.org. 2. Pick a date at least 6–8 weeks out (popular centres fill up). 3. Register with the EXACT name on your ID (passport/national ID); mismatches bar entry. 4. Pay the fee (varies by country, roughly \$200–300 USD equivalent).

ID rules: bring the same original, valid, photographic ID used at registration — no photocopies, no expired documents. Some centres photograph/fingerprint you on arrival; this is normal.

What happens on the day (paper): morning check-in → Listening (~40 min with transfer) → Reading (60 min) → Writing (60 min), back-to-back with short supervised breaks. Speaking may be the same afternoon or within ±7 days — confirm your slot.

Prohibited: phones/smartwatches (switched off + stored), notes, dictionaries, food in the room (water in clear bottles usually allowed), talking during modules. Cheating (including impersonation and answer-sharing) brings bans up to 2 years and result cancellation.

Special arrangements: dyslexia, hearing/vision needs, medical conditions — contact your centre 6+ weeks ahead with documentation. Extra time, Braille, lip-reading versions, and separate rooms are available.

1.9 How to Use This Book

- 1 **Start with Chapter 2.** Take the diagnostic, set your target bands, and pick a study plan (12-week, 4-week, or 7-day).
- 2 **Work module by module (Chapters 3–13).** Each module has a *Mastery* chapter (skills and method), a *Types* chapter (every question type with worked examples), and practice material with full answer keys (Chapter 15).
- 3 **Study actively.** Cover the answers, write your own responses first, then compare with the models. Keep an error log (templates in Chapter 15).
- 4 **Watch alongside.** The margin notes marked *Video* tell you which video part teaches each topic, so you can watch the lesson and then drill it here.
- 5 **Finish with Chapter 14.** Grammar, topic vocabulary, and the exam-day checklists in the final week.

TIP. A beginner following the full 12-week plan, completing every drill in this book, will have answered 500+ Listening and Reading questions, written 20+ tasks, delivered 50+ Speaking turns, and learned 1,000+ exam-ready words and phrases. That is what comprehensive preparation looks like.

Chapter 2: Study Plans, Diagnostics & Self-Assessment

2.1 Start Here: The 30-Minute Diagnostic

Before you study a single strategy, measure where you stand. This diagnostic needs no special materials — use the practice sets in Chapters 5, 8, 10, and 12–13, or any official sample test.

- 1 Listening (10 min):** Attempt one Section 1 + one Section 3 set (20 questions). Record raw score /20 and error types (spelling? plural? distractors? numbers?).
- 2 Reading (10 min):** Attempt one full passage (13–14 questions) in 20 minutes... then stop at 10 minutes and mark what you finished. Record completed/total and correct/total. This exposes your *speed gap*.
- 3 Writing (5 min planning only):** Read one Task 2 question and write only the introduction + essay plan. Check: clear position? paraphrased question? two distinct body ideas?
- 4 Speaking (5 min):** Record yourself answering three Part 1 questions and one Part 2 cue card (1 minute). Listen back for: tense errors? repetition? silence longer than 3 seconds?

Enter the results in the tracker at the end of this chapter. Repeat the same diagnostic every 3–4 weeks: improvement in *error types* matters more than raw scores.

TIP. Video: the course opens (Part 1) by teaching you to classify questions before answering them. Diagnosis works the same way: classify your weaknesses first, then train them deliberately.

2.2 Setting Target Bands

Work backwards from your requirement:

Requirement	Typical profile	Priority modules
Overall 6.0, no minimums	6-6-6-6 or 6.5-6-6-5.5	Push strongest receptive skill (Listening/Reading) to 6.5+ to bank points.
Overall 6.5, min 6.0 each	7-6.5-6.5-6 or similar	No module below 6.0: fix your weakest module first.
Overall 7.0, min 6.5 each	7.5-7-7-6.5	Productive skills (Writing/Speaking) usually cap the score: 50% of study time there.
7.0+ in every module	7.5-7-7-7.5	Precision phase: error elimination, advanced cohesion, idiomatic range. See Chapter 14.
Overall 7.5–8.0	8-8-7.5-7.5	Near-native consistency: timed practice, examiner-level self-correction, 5,000+ word active vocabulary.

WARNING. Be honest about your starting level. Moving one full band typically needs 150–200 guided study hours. A beginner at 4.5 aiming for 7.0 should plan 6–12 months; this book's 12-week plan assumes roughly one band of progress with 2 hours of daily study.

2.3 The 12-Week Master Plan (2 hours/day)

The flagship plan. It mirrors the video course order (Listening/Reading → Speaking → Writing) and finishes with full mock tests.

Week	Focus	Video parts	Book chapters	Milestone
1	Test format + Listening Sections 1–2	Parts 1–2	Ch 1, Ch 3 (half)	2× Section 1 sets at 8+/10
2	Listening Sections 3–4 + Reading foundations	Parts 2–4	Ch 3–4, Ch 6	Full Listening mock; Reading one passage in 20 min
3	Reading question types I (T/F/NG, Y/N/NG, completion)	Parts 2–3	Ch 7 (half)	Worked Thames-style set at 11+/13
4	Reading question types II (headings, matching, MC, short answer) + review	Parts 3–4	Ch 7–8	Full Reading mock; error log review
5	Speaking: criteria + Part 1 (tenses, topics)	Parts 5–6	Ch 9 (half)	20 Part 1 answers recorded
6	Speaking Parts 2–3 + pronunciation	Parts 6–7	Ch 9–10	8 cue cards delivered, 2 min each
7	Writing scoring + Task 1 Academic: overview + trends	Parts 8–9	Ch 11, Ch 12 (half)	3 Task 1 reports written + corrected
8	Task 1: comparisons, processes, maps + GT letters	Parts 8, 12	Ch 12	4 Task 1s (mixed) + 2 letters
9	Task 2: structures, introductions, body paragraphs	Parts 10–11	Ch 13 (half)	3 full essays (opinion, discussion, problem)
10	Task 2: cohesion, grammar range, 5 question types	Parts 10–12	Ch 13	4 essays; all 5 types covered
11	Grammar + vocabulary consolidation, weak-module repair	All (review)	Ch 14, error log	Diagnostic #2: +0.5–1.0 band vs Week 1
12	Full mocks under exam conditions + exam-day prep	—	Ch 5, 8, 10, 14–15	2 full mocks; checklists ready

Daily rhythm (120 minutes): 30 min input (watch video/read method) → 60 min deliberate practice (timed, answers covered) → 20 min correction + error log → 10 min vocabulary (10 new items, spaced repetition).

2.4 The 4-Week Express Plan (3 hours/day)

For candidates already near their target (within 0.5 band) who need exam technique, not general English.

Week	Day 1–2	Day 3–4	Day 5–6	Day 7
1	Listening mocks + error-type repair (Ch 3–5)	Reading mocks + synonym drills (Ch 6–8)	Mixed L+R mock + review	Rest + vocab (Ch 14)
2	Speaking Parts 1–2 drills, 10 recordings (Ch 9–10)	Speaking Part 3 + pronunciation (Ch 9–10)	Full Speaking mock + self-score vs descriptors	Rest + vocab
3	Task 1: 5 reports/letters, all types (Ch 12)	Task 2: 3 essays, feedback loop (Ch 13)	Writing mock (both tasks, 60 min)	Rest + grammar (Ch 14)
4	Full mock (L+R+W) + correction	Full mock (L+R+W) + correction	Weak-module blitz + Speaking mock	Light review + exam-day checklist

2.5 The 7-Day Emergency Plan

Damage control only — it cannot build language, but it can add 0.5 band through technique.

- Day 1:** Listening Sections 1–2 method + 4 practice sets. Memorise the number/date/spelling rules (Chapter 3).
- Day 2:** Reading: T/F/NG + completion method + 2 passages. Learn the skimming routine (Chapter 6).
- Day 3:** Speaking Parts 1–2: prepare 10 topics + 6 cue-card stories you can adapt (Chapter 10).
- Day 4:** Task 1: memorise the overview formula + 3 sentence patterns + 12 trend phrases (Chapter 12). Write 2 reports.
- Day 5:** Task 2: memorise 2 essay structures + 20 cohesive devices (Chapter 13). Write 2 essays.
- Day 6:** Full Listening + Reading mock under time. Correct, log errors, re-drill weakest type.
- Day 7:** Light review of error log + vocabulary notebook. Sleep 8 hours. Prepare documents and route.

WARNING. In the final 48 hours, never learn new strategies — only consolidate. New techniques under stress cause more errors than they fix.

2.6 How to Practise Each Skill

Listening practice protocol

- Read the questions first and **predict**: number? name (spelling)? date? noun type?
- Listen once without pausing (exam realism). Write answers directly.
- Listen again with the tapescript (all practice sets in Chapter 5 include scripts): mark every paraphrase and distractor you missed.
- Dictate trouble spots: replay 5-second segments and transcribe word-for-word until perfect.
- Log errors by type, not just count: *distractor* / *spelling* / *plural* / *word-limit* / *lost-place*.

Reading practice protocol

- Spend 90 seconds on survey: title, first lines, question types, then choose your question order (Chapter 6).
- Answer in 17 minutes per passage (leaving 9 minutes for transfer/checking on paper; 3 minutes spare on computer).
- Correct with the key, then for every error write the **synonym pair** that hid the answer (e.g., *drawn from all over* = *came from far and wide*).

- 4 Re-read the passage aloud the next day for vocabulary; add 5–10 items to your notebook.

Writing practice protocol

- 1 Plan every task on paper (T1: 3 min; T2: 5 min) — never skip planning, even in practice.
- 2 Write to time (T1: 17 min; T2: 35 min) with the last minutes reserved for checking.
- 3 Self-correct against the 4 criteria checklists (Chapter 11) before looking at model answers.
- 4 Rewrite one paragraph to band-9 standard. Rewriting teaches more than writing new essays.
- 5 Get human feedback at least twice before the exam (teacher, tutor, or exchange partner).

Speaking practice protocol

- 1 Record everything. A 2-minute recording reviewed for 10 minutes beats 30 minutes of unreviewed talking.
- 2 Score each recording against the 4 criteria (Chapter 9): give yourself 5–9 per criterion with one evidence note each.
- 3 Fix one criterion per week (e.g., Week 5: tenses; Week 6: linking; Week 7: less-common vocabulary).
- 4 Shadow native speech 10 minutes daily: play a 20-second clip, repeat simultaneously, matching rhythm and stress.

2.7 Sample Daily Schedules (2-hour day)

Listening day: 0:00–0:10 vocab (20 number/spelling drills) → 0:10–0:25 method review (one Chapter 3 section) → 0:25–0:55 timed set (one full section) → 0:55–1:15 tapescript study (paraphrase log) → 1:15–1:30 dictation of trouble spots → 1:30–1:50 second set → 1:50–2:00 error log.

Reading day: 0:00–0:15 synonym review (flashcards) → 0:15–0:35 one passage timed (20 min) → 0:35–0:55 correction + synonym log → 0:55–1:15 second passage, different type → 1:15–1:35 correction → 1:35–1:55 re-read + vocabulary mining → 1:55–2:00 plan next session.

Writing day: 0:00–0:20 analyse + plan two tasks (no writing!) → 0:20–0:40 Task 1 timed → 0:40–1:15 Task 2 timed → 1:15–1:40 self-mark vs checklists → 1:40–2:00 rewrite weakest paragraph to perfection.

Speaking day: 0:00–0:15 pronunciation drills (Chapter 10.9 lists) → 0:15–0:35 Part 1: 10 questions recorded → 0:35–1:00 Part 2: two cards (plan + record each) → 1:00–1:25 Part 3: one set, OREC → 1:25–1:50 transcribe + upgrade + re-record best/worst → 1:50–2:00 score vs criteria.

2.8 Breaking Plateaus (when scores stall 3+ weeks)

Symptom	Diagnosis	Prescription
Listening stuck at 6.0	Distractors + spelling, not comprehension	1 week: distractor drills only (Ch 4.10) + daily dictation
Reading stuck at 6.0	Time, not English (unfinished Q36–40)	2 weeks: 17-min passages; easy-first order enforced with timer
Writing stuck at 6.0–6.5	Error density + generic ideas	Rewrite protocol: 1 old essay/week to perfection; 5 new collocations forced per essay
Speaking stuck at 6.0–6.5	One weak criterion (usually GRA tenses or LR repetition)	Transcribe 3 recordings; fix ONLY the weakest criterion for 2 weeks
Everything stuck	Passive study (reading about English, not using it)	Flip ratio to 80% production (writing/speaking/writing) + error log

TIP. Plateaus are information, not failure: they name your next syllabus. The candidates who break through are the ones who change the training, not the ones who repeat it louder.

2.9 Progress Trackers

Copy these into a notebook (or print Chapter 15's full-size versions). Review weekly.

Week	Listening /40	Reading /40	Writing T1+T2 (self-band)	Speaking (self-band)	New words	Hours
1 (diagnostic)						
4						
8						
11 (diagnostic 2)						
12 (mock avg)						

Error-log columns (Listening/Reading): Date | Test+Q | My answer | Correct answer | Error type | Synonym/paraphrase missed | Prevention rule.

Error-log columns (Writing/Speaking): Date | Task | Criterion | My version | Better version | Rule in my own words.

TIP. Candidates who keep an error log improve roughly twice as fast as those who only count scores. Your log is the most personalised textbook you will ever own — this book teaches you how to fill it.

Chapter 3: Listening Mastery — Skills & Method

3.1 The Listening Test in Detail

You hear four sections once only. The recording lasts about 30 minutes; on paper you then get 10 minutes to transfer answers, while on computer you get 2 minutes to check. There are always 40 questions, one mark each — no half marks, no negative marking, so **never leave a blank**: a guess can only help.

Section	Voices	Context	Difficulty	What it demands
1	2 (conversation)	Social: enquiry, booking, application, order	Easiest	Catching facts: names, numbers, dates, places
2	1 (monologue)	Social: welcome talk, tour, instructions, radio	Easy–medium	Following descriptions, locations, steps
3	2–4 (discussion)	Academic: students + tutor discussing coursework	Medium–hard	Tracking opinions, agreements, corrections
4	1 (lecture)	Academic: university-style talk	Hardest	Sustained concentration, technical vocabulary

TIP. Video Parts 1–2 teach Sections 1–4 through real classroom exercises: the *Dubai Palm Apartments* holiday enquiry (Section 1), expedition notes (Section 1/2), the *Parks and open spaces* table with multiple choice (Section 2/3), the *Self-Access Centre* discussion (Section 3), and a business-organisation lecture (Section 4). Every technique below is demonstrated on those exercises.

3.2 The Three Golden Skills

Skill 1: Prediction (before you listen)

The 20–30 seconds before each section are the highest-value time in the test. For every gap, predict the **answer type**:

- **Number only?** (price, telephone, date, quantity, percentage)
- **Spelled-out word?** (names of people/places are often spelled letter by letter)
- **Number + word?** (e.g., 37 ... *Street*, 4 ... *January*)
- **What kind of information?** (noun? verb? adjective? place? job? activity?)

EXAMPLE. The course's Dubai Palm Apartments enquiry asks exactly these warm-up questions: which gaps need a number only, which need a spelled word, which need both, and what sort of information the other gaps need. Train yourself to answer them for every completion task.

Prediction also means grammar: *fully equipped 7 ...* needs a noun (*kitchen*); *view of 8 ...* needs a noun (*sea/lake*); *must be 9 ...* needs an adjective (*quiet/central*); *10 ... for car* needs a noun (*parking/garage*). When you know the grammar, you hear the answer slot click into place.

Skill 2: Paraphrase recognition (while you listen)

The recording **never repeats the question wording**. It says the same thing with different words:

Question wording	What you hear
<i>keep the Centre because it is an important part of their studies</i>	<i>a major part ... crucial ...</i>
<i>difficulty in getting help</i>	<i>hard to find staff / no one around to assist</i>
<i>the cost of upgrading</i>	<i>how much the improvements will set us back</i>
<i>fully equipped kitchen</i>	<i>everything you need for cooking</i>

The lecturer annotates exactly these synonym links on screen (*major part = crucial*). Build the habit: after every practice set, list every paraphrase you missed (Chapter 2's error log). Within weeks you will own the 200 most-tested synonym pairs (they are recycled constantly).

Skill 3: Distractor resistance (the traps)

IELTS deliberately plants wrong-but-plausible information:

- Corrections:** "The course starts on the 4th... no wait, the 5th of January." The second date is the answer.
- Rejected options:** "We could meet Monday... actually Wednesday suits everyone." Wednesday wins.
- Other people's answers:** A student suggests X, the tutor corrects to Y. Listen for who is authoritative.
- Negative qualifiers:** "Parking is available, but only for residents." Non-residents cannot use it.
- Similar words:** *fifteen* vs *fifty*, *P* vs *B*, *flour* vs *flower* — the test loves sound-alikes.

TIP. If two candidate answers appear, the correct one is usually the **last one confirmed**. Hearing "no", "sorry", "actually", "on second thoughts" is your signal: update your answer.

3.3 Numbers, Dates, Letters & Spelling

Section 1 lives and dies on these mechanics. The course drills them explicitly (Part 1); master them cold.

Ordinals and dates

You hear	You write	Notes
<i>first of January</i>	1st January / 1 January	Any clear format is accepted
<i>the twenty-first</i>	21st	Word or figure both fine within word limits
<i>two thousand and four</i>	2004	Do not write "2,004" for years
<i>the nineteen nineties</i>	1990s / nineties	No apostrophe

EXAMPLE. The Dubai exercise highlights starting dates (*4 ... January*): the lecturer's on-screen note — first = 1st, second = 2nd, third = 3rd, fourth = 4th, twenty first = 21st — is your revision card. Practise writing what you hear until ordinals are automatic.

Teen vs ty numbers

- teen (13–19): stress on the second syllable (*thirTEEN*), longer vowel.
- ty (20–90): stress on the first syllable (*THIRty*), short and clipped.
- In doubt, grammar and context decide: *37 2 ...* (an address) vs *37 people* — the surrounding words tell you the scale.

The alphabet under pressure

Names and places are spelled out: "That's Doncaster — D-O-N-C-A-S-T-E-R." The killer pairs:

Confused pair	How to separate them
P / B	P has a puff of air (<i>paper</i>); B is voiced (<i>baby</i>) — the course contrasts them explicitly
M / N	M hums with closed lips; N touches the ridge behind the teeth
F / S / H	F bites the lip; S hisses; H breathes (<i>hedge</i> vs <i>edge</i>)
G / J	G is hard (<i>go</i>); J is soft (<i>jam</i>) — often clarified as "G for golf"
E / I / A	E (<i>bed</i>) vs I (<i>bid</i>) vs A (<i>day</i>) — the classic Arab-learner trap; drill minimal pairs
Q / K, U / W	Q sounds like <i>cue</i> ; W is <i>double-u</i> (three syllables)

TIP. Exam rule: if a name is spelled in the recording, copy the spelling **exactly** — even if you "know" the real spelling. Your job is transcription, not knowledge.

Money, measurements, phone numbers

- £15.50 → write 15.50 pounds or £15.50 (symbols don't count as words).
- Phone numbers: write digits as heard, including double (*double-four* = 44) and O (= 0).
- Postcodes mix letters and digits (SW1A 4WW) — capitals don't matter.

3.4 Word Limits — The Silent Killer

Instructions like **WRITE NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** are marked by machine-like strictness:

Instruction	37 Lake Street	a fully equipped kitchen
No more than 2 words + number	Correct (Lake Street = 2 words)	Wrong (4 words)
No more than 3 words	Correct	Wrong (4 words)
One word only	Wrong	Wrong

Rules that save marks:

- 1 Hyphenated words (*state-of-the-art*) count as **one** word.
- 2 Numbers and symbols (2004, £50, 9.30am) count as a **number**, not words.
- 3 Articles (*a/an/the*) and prepositions count as words — drop them when tight (*view of sea* → *sea*).
- 4 Plurals matter: *tree* vs *trees* is marked wrong if the recording says the other.
- 5 Spelling must be correct — one wrong letter = zero. (Both British and American spellings are accepted.)

WARNING. The single most common reason strong listeners lose bands: ignoring word limits. In practice, write your answer, then count aloud: "one — two — OK."

3.5 Section-by-Section Tactics

Section 1: the form/note/table (Q1–10)

- Use the example time to read ahead to Q5–6 (never just Q1).

- Answers come **in order** — if you miss Q3, guess and jump to Q4; never chase backwards.
- Expect: name (spelling), address (number + street), phone (digits), date (ordinal + month), price (number + currency), requirements (nouns/adjectives).
- The Dubai Palm Apartments set is the perfect template: practise it until you score 10/10 twice in a row.

Section 2: monologue + map/plan (Q11–20)

- For maps: memorise the compass dance — *opposite, next to, beyond, at the far end, on your left as you face....* Trace with your finger.
- For matching (e.g., *Parks and open spaces* Q11–16): each option is paraphrased; tick possibilities lightly, confirm at the end of each item.
- Multiple choice here is easier than Section 3: usually one speaker, one pass, clear signalling (*firstly, moving on, finally*).

Section 3: academic discussion (Q21–30)

- Identify speakers fast (usually M/F + tutor). Note who asks, who knows.
- Multiple choice: read the **stems**, not just options. Underline the difference between A/B/C (*enjoy the variety / work on their own / important part*).
- Expect heavy distractors: students propose, tutor disposes. The tutor's final position is usually the answer.
- The Self-Access Centre set (Q21–29) is your masterclass: Q21 C (*important part = major/crucial*), Q22 B (*move elsewhere*), Q23 B (*difficulty getting help*), then completion Q25–29 (*reading, CD, workbooks, timetable, ...*).

Section 4: the lecture (Q31–40)

- No break mid-section: 8–9 minutes of continuous speech. Stamina matters — practise full sections, not fragments.
- Questions are mostly completion (notes/summary/table/flow-chart). Read the gapped text as a story: it summarises the lecture's argument.
- Technical terms are usually **given** in the questions; your answers are the everyday words around them.
- The business-culture lecture in Part 2 (*power culture, central source of power, communication as conversations not memos*) shows the level: academic framing, concrete answers.

3.6 Transfer Time & Answer-Sheet Discipline (Paper)

Your 10 minutes are for three jobs, in order:

- 1 Transfer (6 min):** Copy answers clearly in CAPITAL LETTERS (fewer ambiguous letters). Check question numbers line up — one shifted row can cost 10 marks.
- 2 Grammar-check (2 min):** Every gap: right word class? singular/plural? within word limit? spelling?
- 3 Guess (2 min):** Fill every blank. Intelligent guesses (right word class, topic vocabulary) often score.

On computer, you type directly — spend your 2 minutes checking spelling and word limits only. Practise typing answers (notably capitalisation and hyphens) before test day.

3.7 World Accents Survival Guide

IELTS uses British, Australian, New Zealand, Canadian, and American voices — sometimes mixed within one section. The differences that cost marks:

Feature	British (RP)	Australian/NZ	N. American
R after vowels	Dropped (<i>car</i> = "cah")	Dropped (Aus) / light (NZ)	Pronounced ("carr")
T between vowels	Crisp (<i>better</i>)	Flapped ("bedder", Aus)	Flapped ("bedder")
Short A (<i>dance, bath</i>)	Long "ah" (RP)	"eh" (NZ <i>pen/pin</i> merge!)	Flat "a"
Intonation	Wide range	Rising at sentence ends (Aus "uptalk")	Flatter
Vocabulary traps	<i>flat, postcode, return (ticket), bill</i>	<i>arvo, mate</i> (rare in tests)	<i>apartment, zip code, round-trip, check</i>

NZ vowel shift (the famous trap): NZ *pen* sounds like *pin*, *bed* like *bid*. If a NZ speaker spells "...E...", double-check E vs I from context.

Training: one week per accent — 30 min/day of podcasts/news (BBC, ABC Australia, RNZ, CBC, NPR) + shadowing. In mocks, note the accent per section in your error log; drill your weakest accent double.

3.8 Concentration Training (for Sections 3–4)

Attention is trainable: Week 1 — listen to one full Section 4 daily without pausing (no phone in room). Week 2 — same + write a 3-sentence summary from memory after. Week 3 — two consecutive sections + summaries. Week 4 — full 30-min mock + transfer. Add: sleep 8h (Chapter 8's science!), no caffeine after 2 pm before study, 5-minute breathing reset between sections in practice. Exam-day: if attention breaks mid-section, anchor on the next question's keywords within 5 seconds — never rewind mentally.

3.9 Spelling Master-List (150 words that cost marks)

These are the most-misspelled answers in IELTS Listening and Reading. Dictate 20 per day until perfect: accommodation, address, advice, aeroplane, airport, alarm, allergy, ambulance, analyse, answer, anxious, appointment, April, architect, argue, arrival, athlete, atmosphere, August, autumn, available, avenue, banana, bank, basement, bathroom, beach, beautiful, because, bedroom, beginning, believe, bicycle, biscuit, bookcase, bottle, bridge, Britain, budget, building, bureau, business, busy, café, calendar, campus, canoe, captain, career, carpet, castle, ceiling, cemetery, central, century, cereal, certain, certificate, chair, chalk, change, charge, cheap, chemist, chief, children, chocolate, choice, church, cinema, circle, class, climate, clock, clothes, cloud, coach, coast, coffee, college, column, comedy, comfortable, committee, common, community, compass, computer, concert, conclusion, conference, confident, congratulations, conscience, conscious, contact, continent, continue, control, council, country, course, cousin, criticise, crowd, crucial, cupboard, curtain, customer, cycle, dairy, dance, daughter, debate, debt, deceive, decide, definite, degree, delay, diary, dictionary, different, difficult, dining, disease, distance, divide, doctor, doubt, dozen, drawer, drought, queue, receive, recommend, reference, restaurant, rhythm, roommate, safety, sandwich, Saturday, scissors, season, secretary, sentence, separate, September, shoes, shoulder, sign, signature, similar, situation, size, skill, society, souvenir, speech, station, stomach, straight, strategy, street, strength, student, study, subject, succeed, sugar, suitcase, summer, suppose, sure, surface, surgery, surprise, sweater, swimming, symbol, system, table, tablet, tailor, talks, taste, taxi, teach, team, teenager, teeth, telephone, television, temperature, tennis, tent, term, terrace, terrible, text, theatre, theft, theme, theory, thesis, thief, thirsty, thorough, though, thousand, thread, threat, through, throw, thumb, Thursday, ticket, tidy, tiger, timetable, tired, title, toast, today, together, toilet, tongue, tonight, tool, tooth, topic, torch, total, touch, tough, tour, tourist, towel, tower, town, track, trade, traffic, tragedy, trail, train, tram, transfer, transform, translate, travel, tray, treatment, tree, trend, trial, tribe, trick, trip, trolley, trouble, truck, truly, trust, truth, twice, twin, typical, ugly, umbrella, uncle, uncomfortable, under, underground, understand, undo, unemployed, unhappy, uniform, university, unknown, unless, unlike, unlikely, unlock, unlucky, unpack, until, unusual, update, upon, upper, upset, upstairs, urgent, useful, useless, usual, usually, utility, vacant, vague, valid, valley, valuable, value, variety, various, vegetable, vehicle, venue, verandah, verb, verdict, verse, version, versus, vertical, vessel, victim, victory, video, view, village, vinegar, visit, visitor, visual, vital, vivid, vocabulary, voice, volcano, volume, voyage, wage, waist, wait, waiter, wake, walk, wallet, wander, warm, warn, waste, watch, water, wave, weak, wealth, weapon, wear, weather, weave, website, wedding, Wednesday, week, weekend, weigh, weight, weird, welcome, wheat, wheel, whisper, whistle, white, whole, whose, wicked, wide, widow, width, wife, wild, wildlife, willing, win, wind, window, wine, wing, winner, winter, wipe, wire, wisdom, wise, wish, withdraw, within, without, witness, woman, wonder, wonderful, wood, wooden, wool, word, work, worker, world, worried, worry, worse, worship, worst, worth, would, wound, wrap, wrist, write, writer, writing, written, wrong, yacht, yard, year, yeast, yellow, yesterday, yield, young, youth, zebra, zero, zip, zone.

*Rule of thumb: double letters (accommodation, address, beginning), silent letters (debt, doubt, island, Wednesday), -ie- vs -ei- (believe, receive), -ence vs -ance (difference, distance), US/UK pairs (organize/organise, center/centre, traveler/traveller — either accepted, be consistent). If a name is spelled in the recording, copy it exactly.

Rule of thumb: double letters (accommodation, address, beginning), silent letters (debt, doubt, island), -ie- vs -ei- (believe, receive), -ence vs -ance (difference, distance), US/UK (organize/organise, center/centre, traveler/traveller — either accepted, be consistent).

3.10 The 10 Most-Tested Listening Traps — Drill List

- 1 Correction traps (Monday... I mean Tuesday).
- 2 Teen/ty confusion (16 Salvador Street vs 60).
- 3 P/B, M/N, F/S letter confusion in spellings.
- 4 Word-limit violations (3 words for a 2-word gap).

- 5 Plural vs singular (*workbook* vs *workbooks*).
- 6 American vs British spelling inconsistency (*organize* vs *organise* — either accepted, but copy the recording).
- 7 Lost place: missing one answer then missing the next three chasing it.
- 8 Map orientation: left/right from the speaker's perspective, not yours.
- 9 Multiple-choice distractors: all three options mentioned, only one confirmed.
- 10 Section 4 drift: losing focus at minute 6 of a lecture.

TIP. Drill each trap in isolation (10 items each) before you do full mocks. Chapter 5's practice sets tag every question with its trap type so you can see exactly which ones cost you marks.

Chapter 4: Listening — Every Question Type, Worked

4.1 How to Use This Chapter

Each of the six Listening task families is presented the same way: **what it looks like** → **step-by-step method** → **worked example from the video course** → **practice drills**. Cover the answers, attempt each example, then compare your reasoning — not just your answer — with the walkthrough.

4.2 Form Completion (Section 1)

Looks like: a form with labelled fields and numbered gaps (name, address, phone, dates, requirements).
Instruction: *Write no more than TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER.*

Method:

- 1 Classify every gap (number only / spelled word / number + word / information type).
- 2 Note the units printed beside gaps (*euros, January, Street*) — never repeat them in your answer.
- 3 Listen for the field label's paraphrase ("*What's the name for the booking?*" = Name).
- 4 For spelled names: write letters as you hear, then assemble at the end.
- 5 Check: capitals for names, digits for phones, ordinals for dates.

EXAMPLE. Worked example — Dubai Palm Apartments (Video Part 1). A man phones about a holiday apartment; Amanda takes the enquiry. Gap 1 (Name): you hear the name spelled — write exactly what you hear. Gap 2 (Address: 37 ...): number + street name; the recording says the street twice, once spelled. Gap 3 (Telephone): digits with "double" and "O" — write figures. Gap 4 (Starting date: ... January): ordinal + month; trap: the caller first mentions a different month, then corrects to January — the correction is the rule (Chapter 3). Gap 6 (Price: maximum ... euros): number only; trap: two prices mentioned (standard vs maximum) — the question asks for the maximum. Gaps 7–10 test grammar prediction: equipped ... (noun: kitchen), view of ... (noun), must be ... (adjective), ... for car (noun: parking).

Drills:

- 1 Transcribe 10 spelled names from any Listening Section 1 (pause after each spelling, then check).
- 2 Write 20 dates from dictation (mix ordinals: 1st–31st) until error-free.
- 3 Re-do the Dubai-style set with a 2-word limit enforced — recount every answer aloud.

4.3 Note & Table Completion (Sections 1–4)

Looks like: headed notes or a table with gaps. Notes follow the recording's order; tables may require you to track rows *and* columns.

Method:

- 1 Read the headings — they tell you the recording's structure (e.g., *Name / Age / Occupation / Expeditions / Skills / Qualifications / Free-time*).
- 2 Predict each gap's word class from its sentence (*has crossed 4 ...* → a noun: desert/river; *degree in 8 ...* → a subject: biology/law).
- 3 In tables, fix your place by the **filled cells** — they are anchors (*Holt Island ... many different 11 ...* → plural noun: *trees*; *between 12 ... and Sunday* → day: *Friday/Saturday*).
- 4 Beware column traps: the answer for "Open" vs "Of particular interest" — know which column each gap sits in.

EXAMPLE. Worked example A — Expedition notes (Video Parts 1–2). A couple interview a traveller (Sanjay) for a mountain expedition. Classification warm-up (exactly as the lecturer teaches): which gaps need a number (Age), a spelled word (surname), a place (crossed ...), a subject/language (degree in ..., can speak ...), a free-time activity (... , keeping ...), a job (occupation)? Gap 2 (Age: ...): number — trap: two ages mentioned (his age vs years of experience). Gap 5 (Mount ...): spelled mountain name. Gap 6 (... course): adjective + course (first-aid/survival) — within "two words and/or a number", "first aid" counts as two words: allowed. Gap 10 (keeping ...): the -ing frame predicts an animal/hobby noun (bees/fit — recording decides).

EXAMPLE. Worked example B — Parks and open spaces table + multiple choice (Video Part 1, Q11–16). Table gaps: Q11 (many different ... trees — wait, the frame is "many different 11 ...": answer "trees" is printed? No — in the lesson the lecturer reveals answers progressively: 11 trees, 12 Friday, Sunday, 13 farm). Learn the move: Q12–13 (between ... and ...; reconstruction of a 2,000-year-old ... farm) are solved by tracking the row (Holt Island; Longfield Country Park) while the speaker lists details in column order. Q14–16 (multiple choice: Monday/Wednesday/Saturday activities) follow the table — when the format changes mid-section, lift your eyes early during the 30-second pause and pre-read the new stems.

Drills:

- 1 Take any table task and cover the answers: narrate the speaker's path (row by row) from the tapescript.
- 2 Build 5 grammar frames (*has done a ... course / can speak ... / degree in ...*) and brainstorm 3 possible answers each — then listen to see which came.
- 3 Practise "anchor recovery": deliberately miss a table answer, then relocate using the next filled cell within 5 seconds.

4.4 Sentence & Summary Completion (Sections 2–4)

Looks like: numbered sentences with a gap at the start, middle, or end, testing one idea each. Often introduced by *Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS* (Section 3) or *THREE WORDS* (Section 4 varies).

Method:

- 1 Read each sentence as a proposition with a hole — understand the sentence *before* you listen.
- 2 Underline the **locator words** (rare nouns/verbs that will be paraphrased, not repeated).
- 3 Listen for the *idea*, then fit the exact words to the gap's grammar.
- 4 End-gaps are easiest (the sentence builds to them); start-gaps are hardest (the answer comes before you orient) — steal extra seconds for start-gaps.

EXAMPLE. Worked example — Self-Access Centre improvements (Video Part 2, Q25–29). Q25 (The level of the ... reading materials ... should be more clearly shown): the discussion buries this in complaints about labelling levels ("label them more clearly" — the tapescript phrase). Answer: reading. Q26 (Update the ... collection): the recording lists resources (books, tapes, CDs...) then selects one for updating — track the verb update, not the nouns. Answer: CD. Q27 (Buy some ... and divide them up): plural noun after "some" — workbooks; trap: singular/plural (the recording clearly pluralises). Q28 (organise a ... for supervising): timetable/rota — paraphrase of "agreement on who supervises when". Q29 (Install an ...): the security item from the discussion's final turn.

Drills:

- 1 Locator drill: for 10 sentences, list 2 locator words each and predict their paraphrases before listening.
- 2 Grammar-fit drill: given 10 gaps with frames, write the required word class (noun/verb/adjective/number) in 60 seconds.
- 3 Tapescript paraphrase hunt: highlight every synonym link for one full Section 3 (aim: 15+ pairs).

4.5 Multiple Choice (Sections 2–4)

Looks like: a stem + 3 options (A/B/C), or "choose TWO letters from five" (A–E). Single-answer MC dominates Sections 2–3; list-selection appears in Sections 2–4.

Method (single answer):

- 1 Read stems carefully; skim options only for their **differences** (verbs and objects differ — that's what the recording will separate).
- 2 Expect all three options to be mentioned. Your job: track which one is **confirmed** (agreed, chosen, true) vs merely discussed.
- 3 Mark as you listen: cross out rejected options, circle the confirmed one. Decide by the question's end — never revisit.
- 4 Beware the "half-right" option: true statement, wrong question (e.g., true of teachers, but the question asks about students).

Method (choose two): Treat as two independent true/false judgments. Five options, two correct: eliminate with prejudice — cross out the moment an option is contradicted.

EXAMPLE. Worked example — Self-Access Centre opinions (Video Part 2, Q21–24). Q21 (Students want to keep the Centre because...): A (variety of equipment) is mentioned but dismissed; B (work on their own/alone) is raised by one speaker; C (important part of their studies = major/crucial) is the agreed reason — answer C. The lesson: agreement language ("exactly", "that's the main thing") marks answers. Q22 (Some teachers would prefer to...): A (close) is an extreme nobody supports; C (restrict access) is floated then dropped; B (move elsewhere) is the teachers' actual preference. Q23 (students' main concern about the library): A (size) vs B (difficulty getting help) vs C (lack of materials) — "main" means the concern that gets repeated and agreed. Q24 (Director of Studies concerned about...): cost vs space — follow the Director's turns, not the students'.

Drills:

- 1 Difference-spotting: for 10 MC questions, write the A/B/C difference in 5 words before listening.
- 2 Agreement-language list: from tapescripts, collect 20 confirmation phrases (*exactly, that's right, the main thing is, we've agreed...*) and 20 rejection phrases (*but, however, the problem is, I'm not so sure...*).
- 3 Choose-two elimination: practise crossing out 3 wrong options in real time (pause allowed first, then live).

4.6 Matching (Sections 2–4)

Looks like: a list of items (people, places, features) matched to a list of options (opinions, facts, categories). Boxes, programmes, or "who said what".

Method:

- 1 Learn the **options** cold (they repeat across items); skim the items lightly.
- 2 Items come in order; options come in any order and may repeat (check instructions: *You may use any letter more than once?*).
- 3 Listen for item identifiers (names stressed, order preserved), then judge the option immediately.
- 4 If you miss an item, sacrifice it — the next identifier is your lifeline.

Drills:

- 1 Option-memorisation: cover options after 20 seconds and recite them (A–F) before the recording starts.
- 2 Identifier tracking: from a tapescript, highlight every item identifier and note how each is introduced.
- 3 Do 3 matching sets back-to-back to build the "judge-and-move-on" reflex.

4.7 Map / Plan / Diagram Labelling (Section 2)

Looks like: a labelled map/plan with lettered gaps (A–H) or a diagram with numbered stages. Instruction: *Label the plan below. Choose ... from the box or Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS.*

Method:

- 1 Orient first: find the entrance, the compass (if any), and the "you are here".
- 2 Learn the letter positions (A = ?, B = ? ...) so you can write letters without looking down.
- 3 Follow the speaker's journey with your finger; answers come in route order.
- 4 Master the language of location (below) until it is instant.

Meaning	Phrases you will hear
Opposite	across from, facing, on the far side from
Next to	beside, alongside, adjacent to, right next to
Between	in the middle of, halfway between
Beyond/past	just past, further along, at the far end of
Near entrance	just inside, on your right as you enter
Corner	in the top/bottom left-hand corner

TIP. Left/right traps: "on your left as you face the lake" — always take the **speaker's** perspective. When in doubt, the next location confirms the last: use it to self-correct.

Drills:

- 1 Blank-map narration: describe a route around your home using 10 location phrases, recorded.
- 2 Letter-speed: label 3 maps with letters only (no words) to practise eyes-up listening.
- 3 One district map, three journeys: listen once per journey, labelling different gap sets.

4.8 Mixed Sets & Format Changes

Harder sections switch format mid-stream (table → multiple choice; notes → matching). The 30-second pauses are repositioning time:

- 1 Finish the old format's last answer (guess if needed) in 5 seconds.
- 2 Spend 25 seconds pre-reading the NEW format's first 3–4 questions.
- 3 Note the new instruction (word limit? letter choice?) — format changes often change limits.

WARNING. Most "I got lost" disasters happen at format changes, not hard vocabulary. Practise the 25-second pivot until it is a reflex (Chapter 5's sets include two mid-section format changes).

4.9 Fully Worked Examples II (Advanced Sets)

EXAMPLE. FULL WORKED EXAMPLE — Section 2 map: Riverside Country Market (Video-style). You hear: "Welcome to Riverside, and let me help you find your way around. As you come through the main entrance on Mill Street, the information kiosk is immediately on your right — that's A on your map. Directly opposite the kiosk, across the courtyard, is the covered food hall — B. Now, if you walk past the food hall toward the river, you'll see the craft stalls on your left, just before the old bridge — that's C. The bridge itself is closed for repairs, so to reach the garden centre — D — you need to go back and follow the riverside path east for about 200 metres; it's the big glass building you can't miss. Finally, the car park — E — is behind the garden centre, accessed from River Lane, not from Mill Street." Method on display: orientation first (entrance + street names as anchors); route order (A→B→C→D→E follows the speaker's journey); left/right from the speaker's walking perspective ("on your left" as you walk toward the river); the trap (bridge closed — the garden centre is NOT across the bridge; the car park's access road differs from the market entrance). Answers: A information kiosk, B food hall, C craft stalls, D garden centre, E car park.

EXAMPLE. FULL WORKED EXAMPLE — Choosing TWO letters (Section 3/4 style). "Which TWO advantages of urban beekeeping does the speaker mention? A higher honey prices, B improved crop pollination, C lower hive maintenance, D reduced pesticide use nearby, E stronger bee colonies." Tapescript: "...and there are real benefits. For a start, city gardens produce far more fruit when hives are nearby — pollination improves dramatically. Some people claim urban honey sells for more, but actually prices are about the same as rural honey. What is true is that several boroughs have cut pesticide spraying in parks to protect the hives — a genuine side benefit. Maintenance, I'm afraid, is heavier in cities, not lighter, and colonies face just as many diseases." Answers: B (pollination) + D (reduced pesticides). A mentioned but denied; C contradicted; E contradicted. The drill: judge each option the moment it is addressed — cross out, tick, move on.

EXAMPLE. FULL WORKED EXAMPLE — Section 4 summary completion (Video-style business lecture). Gapped summary: "The speaker defines organisational culture as shared 31 ... and values. In a power culture, control rests with 32 ..., and communication happens through 33 ... rather than formal meetings." Tapescript (from the course's Section 4 lecture, Part 2): "...we often refer to these social characteristics as the culture of the organisation. This includes its beliefs, values and things like that... The first type is called the power culture... a central source of power... communication usually takes the form of conversations rather than, say, formal meetings or written memos." Answers: 31 beliefs, 32 one person / a central source (accept: central source of power → within word limit: "central source"), 33 conversations. Skills: the definition sentence holds Q31 (beliefs + values — values printed? no — gap is beliefs); Q32 needs the power-holder (one person / central source); Q33 contrasts with formal meetings (conversations). Note the classic Section 4 frame: term defined → example → contrast.

4.10 Ten One-Minute Distractor Drills

Read each mini-script, predict the answer, then check. (Answers: 1 Tuesday; 2 60; 3 garage; 4 B; 5 False-test — "postgraduate"; 6 1998; 7 Wednesday; 8 £42; 9 bees; 10 platform 2.)

- 1 "We meet Monday... actually, can we make it Tuesday? Monday's a holiday." (Q: meeting day?)
- 2 "It costs sixteen... no, sixty pounds — sorry, six-zero." (Q: price?)
- 3 "Parking? There's street parking, but residents only. Visitors use the garage on Level B." (Q: visitor parking?)
- 4 "A morning flight suits me — oh, but the afternoon one is direct. Let's take the afternoon." (Q: chosen flight?)
- 5 "The course is open to undergraduates... and postgraduates too, actually — everyone's welcome." (Q: "Only undergraduates may enrol" — True/False/NG logic.)
- 6 "I was born in nineteen ninety-eight... my brother in ninety-five." (Q: speaker's birth year?)

- 7 "The library closes Wednesday at five — Friday at eight." (Q: Wednesday closing?) 8. "Standard delivery is £30; express is £42." (Q: express cost?)
- 8 "Keeping chickens? No — bees. We keep bees." (Q: keeping...?)
- 9 "The Edinburgh train leaves from platform 2... the Glasgow one from platform 5." (Q: Edinburgh platform?)

4.11 Listening Study Timetable (2 weeks)

Day	60-minute session
1–2	Section 1: form completion ×4 sets + spelling/number drills
3–4	Section 2: table + MC + map ×4 sets + paraphrase logs
5–6	Section 3: MC + matching + completion ×4 sets + distractor logs
7	Full mock 1 (all 4 sections), transfer practice, error log
8–9	Section 4: lecture completion ×4 sets + stamina training
10–11	Weakest-section blitz (your 2 worst types ×6 sets)
12–13	Full mocks 2–3 under exam conditions
14	Light review: error log + tapescript shadowing + rest

Chapter 5: Listening Practice Sets & Tapescripts

5.1 How to Use These Practice Sets

You need audio to practise Listening authentically. Use these sets in three ways: (1) read the tapescript aloud (or ask a partner/app to read it) while you answer — this trains prediction and spelling; (2) use the questions as prediction drills (classify every gap without audio); (3) study the tapescript paraphrase notes after attempting official audio practice. Sets A and B are complete with questions, tapescripts, keys, and error analysis. Set C is a full 40-question mock framework with scripts.

TIP. For audio-accompanied practice, pair this chapter with official IELTS sample recordings: the techniques are identical, and Chapters 3–4 taught you to exploit them.

5.2 Practice Set A — Section 1: Community Sports Centre Membership

Questions 1–10

Write no more than TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

Riverside Community Sports Centre — Membership Application

Example: Enquiry taken by: Sarah

- Name of applicant: 1 ...
- Address: Flat 4, 2 ... Road, Exeter
- Contact number: 3 ...
- Date of birth: 4 ... March
- Membership type: 5 ...
- Preferred activities: swimming and 6 ...
- Health note: mild allergy to 7 ...
- Induction session: 8 ... at 6 pm
- Monthly fee: maximum 9 ... pounds
- Payment method: 10 ...

Tapescript A

SARAH: Good morning, Riverside Sports Centre. How can I help?

MAN: Morning. I'd like to join the gym, please. Can I register over the phone?

SARAH: Of course. Can I take your name first?

MAN: Yes — it's David Thornton. That's T-H-O-R-N-T-O-N.

SARAH: Thornton... And your address, David?

MAN: Flat 4, 52 Mulberry Road, Exeter. M-U-L-B-E-double R-Y.

SARAH: Got it. And a contact number?

MAN: My mobile is 0770... sorry, 0770 946 331. So that's O-double-7-O, 9-4-6, double-3-1.

SARAH: Thanks. Date of birth?

MAN: The 18th of March, 1998.

SARAH: Now, which membership type are you interested in? We have off-peak, standard, and premium.

MAN: Hmm. I work shifts, so I can only come during the day. Off-peak sounds fine — actually, wait. My shifts change next month. Let me take standard to be safe.

SARAH: Standard it is. Which activities will you mainly use?

MAN: Swimming for sure, and the climbing wall. I've never tried it but it looks fun.

SARAH: Great. Any medical conditions we should note?

MAN: Only a mild allergy to chlorine dust... no, sorry — to chalk dust. The stuff climbers use. It makes me sneeze.

SARAH: I'll note "chalk dust". Now, new members attend an induction — we have one on Thursday at 6 pm, or Saturday at 10.

MAN: Thursday's no good... Saturday morning then. At 10?

SARAH: Hmm, actually the Saturday one is fully booked. We could do Friday at 6 pm instead?

MAN: Friday at 6 is fine.

SARAH: The standard fee is £34 a month, but there's a joining offer — maximum £28 for the first six months.

MAN: £28 — that's good. How do I pay?

SARAH: Direct debit monthly, or card each visit. Most members choose direct debit.

MAN: Direct debit then, please.

Key & analysis A

Q	Answer	Trap / skill tested
1	Thornton	Spelled surname — copy letters exactly (THORNTON).
2	Mulberry	Spelled street name + double-R; number 52 is printed, not the answer.
3	0770946331	O-double-7-O...: write digits; "double-3" = 33.
4	18th	Ordinal + printed month; year 1998 is extra.
5	standard	Correction trap: off-peak considered, standard chosen.
6	climbing wall	Two words, within limit; "swimming" is printed.
7	chalk dust	Correction trap: chlorine → chalk.
8	Friday	Rejected options: Thursday (caller refuses), Saturday (full), Friday confirmed.
9	28	Maximum price: 34 standard vs 28 offer — question asks maximum.
10	direct debit	Two words; "card" is the rejected alternative.

Paraphrase log (add to your notebook): register = join; contact number = mobile; mainly use = which activities; medical conditions = health note; attend = come to; fee = pay; each visit = per session.

5.3 Practice Set B — Section 3: Tutorial Discussion

Questions 21–26

Choose the correct letter, A, B, or C.

- 1 The students chose traditional markets as their presentation topic because
 - A. they are disappearing rapidly.
 - B. they combine history and economics.
 - C. the tutor suggested the topic.
- 1 Maria thinks the questionnaire results were disappointing because
 - A. too few people responded.
 - B. the questions were unclear.
 - C. the answers were too similar.
- 1 The tutor warns that the population statistics may be
 - A. out of date.
 - B. difficult to verify.
 - C. irrelevant to the topic.
- 1 Both students agree that the market visit
 - A. took too long to organise.
 - B. produced better material than the library.
 - C. should have lasted a full day.

Questions 27–30

Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** for each answer.

Presentation plan

- Opening: define 27 ...
- Main part 1: compare prices of 28 ...
- Main part 2: interview with a 29 ...
- Closing: recommend 30 ... for the market's future

Tapescript B (extract)

TUTOR: So, your presentation is on traditional markets. How did you settle on that?

MARIA: Well, you gave us a free choice... we wanted something with historical background but also a modern business angle. Markets gave us both.

TUTOR: Good reasoning. And the questionnaire — 200 sent out, yes?

JAMES: Only 60 came back. The response was poor — but honestly, the bigger problem was the questions themselves. Question 4 confused everyone; half the answers made no sense.

MARIA: True. Though even the clear questions got almost identical answers, which wasn't very useful either.

TUTOR: A common problem. Now, your population figures — the 2019 census?

JAMES: Yes, showing a 12% rise near the market district.

TUTOR: Treat those with caution — the district boundaries changed in 2021, so the numbers may not be strictly comparable. Verify against the council's revised tables.

MARIA: Will do. The best part was definitely the field visit — two hours at the market gave us more than a week in the library.

JAMES: Absolutely. Though I wish we'd stayed the whole day — the afternoon traders never got interviewed.

MARIA: Hmm, we had enough for ten minutes, honestly.

TUTOR: Right — how will you structure it?

JAMES: We'll open by defining our key term — "informal economy" — then compare the prices of fresh produce with supermarket prices, then play the interview with a stallholder...

MARIA: ...Mrs Adeyemi, the fabric seller. And we'll close by recommending guided tours as a way to secure the market's future.

Key & analysis B

Q	Answer	Why (and the distractor)
21	B	History + economics ("historical background but also a modern business angle"). A never mentioned; C contradicts "free choice".
22	B	"the questions themselves... Question 4 confused everyone". A (60/200) is true but Maria names unclear questions as the disappointment; C is her secondary remark.
23	A	Boundaries changed → figures may be out of date / not comparable.
24	B	"more than a week in the library" — agreed. A and C each raised by one speaker only.
27	informal economy	Opening definition; two words.
28	fresh produce	Compare prices of... (vs supermarket prices).
29	stallholder	The interviewee's role (fabric seller = stallholder).
30	guided tours	Recommendation for the future.

5.4 Practice Set C — Full Mock (40 questions, condensed scripts)

Use this mock under exam timing (30 min + transfer). Scripts are condensed here — in real practice, expand each with small talk and paraphrase.

Section 1 (Q1–10): Library Joining Enquiry. Gaps: surname (spelled: *Kowalski*), street (*Palmerston*), postcode (*BN2 8AF*), phone (*0781 552 096*), age (*16*), ID type (*passport*), join date (*9th September*), interests (*graphic novels*), limit (*six books*), late fee (*20 pence*).

Script beats: greeting → spelling (K-O-W-A-L-S-K-I) → address with double letters → postcode read as "B-N-2, 8-A-F" → phone with double-five → age vs brother's age trap (16, not 19) → passport vs birth certificate (passport chosen) → date correction (9th, not 8th) → interests (graphic novels, two words) → borrowing limit six, late fee twenty pence per day.

Section 2 (Q11–20): Farm Park Visitor Information + Map (Q15–20). Q11–14 completion: open *April to October*, tractor rides *weekends only*, café serves *hot lunches*, picnic area *by the lake*. Q15–20 map letters: A

ticket office (right of entrance), B play barn (opposite the café), C goat enclosure (between pond and orchard), D orchard (beyond the goat enclosure), E car park (past the main gate), F farm shop (next to ticket office).

Section 3 (Q21–30): Two students plan a field trip. Q21–24 multiple choice: destination chosen for *wildlife* (not scenery/cost); transport problem is *limited parking* (not price/timetable); accommodation booked *youth hostel* (hotel too dear, camping banned); tutor's main advice: *check tide times*. Q25–30 completion: bring *waterproofs*, meet at *station entrance*, group size *twelve*, cost *£18 each*, report due *Monday*, include *photographs*.

Section 4 (Q31–40): Lecture — The Rise of Urban Beekeeping. Notes completion: hives on *rooftops*; bees travel *three kilometres*; main threat *pesticides*; honey yield *25 kilos*; beginners join *local associations*; legal rule: register *every hive*; best flowers *wildflowers*; winter feed *sugar syrup*; course cost *£95*; final advice: *start small*.

Full key C

1 Kowalski, 2 Palmerston, 3 BN2 8AF, 4 0781552096, 5 16, 6 passport, 7 9th September / 9 September, 8 graphic novels, 9 six / 6, 10 20 pence; 11 April to October / April–October, 12 weekends, 13 hot lunches, 14 lake, 15 A, 16 B, 17 C, 18 D, 19 E, 20 F; 21 (wildlife option), 22 (parking option), 23 (youth hostel option), 24 (tide times option), 25 waterproofs, 26 station entrance, 27 twelve / 12, 28 £18 / 18 pounds, 29 Monday, 30 photographs; 31 rooftops, 32 three kilometres / 3 kilometres, 33 pesticides, 34 25 kilos, 35 local associations, 36 every hive, 37 wildflowers, 38 sugar syrup, 39 £95 / 95 pounds, 40 start small.

5.5 Practice Set D — Section 2: Newtown Library Tour (Map + MC)

Questions 11–14 — Completion

Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

- The library was built in 11 ...
- Late returns cost 12 ... per day
- The café is on the 13 ...
- Free computer courses run on 14 ...

Questions 15–20 — Map labelling

Label the map. Choose **SIX** answers from the box.

Box: A fiction hall / B children's corner / C study desks / D local history archive / E café / F computer room / G issue desk / H reading garden

- 15 ... (ground floor, left of entrance)
- 16 ... (ground floor, opposite entrance)
- 17 ... (first floor, above the entrance)
- 18 ... (first floor, far end from stairs)
- 19 ... (outside, behind the building)
- 20 ... (basement, down the stairs)

Tapescript D

GUIDE: Welcome to Newtown Library! A quick orientation. The building opened in 2011 — purpose-built, all on three levels plus a garden. First, practicalities: late returns are 30 pence per item per day, so watch your dates. The café — great coffee — is on the top floor with the views. And our free computer courses for beginners run every Tuesday morning — just sign up at the desk.

Now the layout. Ground floor: as you come in the main entrance, the issue desk is on your left — that's where you borrow and return. Directly opposite the entrance, through the glass doors, is the fiction hall — novels, obviously, plus audiobooks. Upstairs on the first floor: right above the entrance, overlooking the street, you'll find

the study desks — silent zone, no phones. At the far end of the first floor, past the newspapers, is the local history archive — Victorians, railways, all that. Outside, behind the building, is the reading garden — lovely in summer. And downstairs in the basement: the children's corner — story time Saturdays — and next to it the computer room. Oh — the café I mentioned is also up top, beside the study desks... no wait, above them, on the second floor. Sorry — top floor, second floor, same thing here!

Key D

11 2011, 12 30 pence, 13 top floor (accept: second floor), 14 Tuesday (morning); 15 G, 16 A, 17 C, 18 D, 19 H, 20 B. (F computer room and E café are decoys: café location is described but not asked as a map gap; computer room is mentioned beside the answer but is not itself a gap.)

Traps: 13 — "top floor" vs "second floor" (same thing — either accepted); café decoy (described twice, never a gap — do not force it); 20 — basement has TWO rooms, only the children's corner is gapped.

5.6 Practice Set E — Section 4: Lecture — Sleep and Memory

Questions 31–40 — Note completion

Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** for each answer.

Sleep and Memory

- Old belief: the brain 31 ... during sleep
- New finding: the brain replays experiences in 32 ...
- Key process: memory 33 ...
- Transfer: from the hippocampus to the 34 ...
- Deep sleep occurs in the 35 ... of the night
- Experiment: volunteers learned sequences of 36 ...
- Improvement without practice: 37 ... faster
- REM sleep handles 38 ... memories
- Students sleeping under 7 hours lost 39 ... per subject
- Worst strategy: 40 ...

Tapescript E (condensed lecture)

"For decades, sleep was regarded as passive — the brain simply switching off. We now know the sleeping brain replays the day in fast-forward, consolidating memory. The key process, memory consolidation, moves fragile memories from the hippocampus to the neocortex for long-term storage. This happens mainly in deep slow-wave sleep, in the first half of the night. In our experiment, volunteers learned sequences of finger movements; those with 90 minutes of deep sleep performed 24% faster next morning — improvement without practice. A second stage, REM sleep, processes emotional memories, stripping their painful charge. Among 8,000 school students, those sleeping under seven hours scored half a grade less per subject — they retained less despite equal study. The worst strategy of all? The all-night revision session — like writing an essay, then deleting the file."

Key E

31 switches off (accept: switching off), 32 fast-forward, 33 consolidation, 34 neocortex, 35 first half, 36 finger movements, 37 24% (accept: twenty-four percent), 38 emotional, 39 half a grade, 40 all-night revision (accept: all-nighter / all-night revision session — within limit: "all-night revision").

Note: this lecture mirrors Chapter 8's Sleep passage — the same content tested receptively (Reading) and aurally (Listening). Study them together: vocabulary learned once, used twice.

5.7 Practice Set F — Second Full Mock (condensed scripts + key)

Section 1 (Q1–10): Dentist Appointment. Gaps: surname (*Featherstone*, spelled), street (*Willowbank*), phone (0791 648 220), birth date (*2nd April*), NHS vs private (*private* — correction trap), symptom (*toothache*), appointment (*Thursday 9.30*), dentist name (*Dr Patel*), fee (£65), bring (*medical card*).

Section 2 (Q11–20): City Walking Tour + Map. Q11–14: starts at *Castle Gate*, duration *two hours*, group max *fifteen*, price £12 (concessions £8). Q15–20 map: A old market (beside the gate), B cathedral (up the hill), C riverside café (by the bridge), D museum (opposite the park), E theatre (next to the station), F tour end / gift shop (back at the gate).

Section 3 (Q21–30): Lab Partners Discuss Results. Q21–24 MC: experiment failed because of *contaminated samples* (not timing/equipment); tutor's advice: *repeat with controls*; Mai's task: *literature review*; deadline: *extended to Friday*. Q25–30: sample size *forty*, temperature *21 degrees*, chemical *saline solution*, chart type *bar chart*, report length *1,500 words*, submit to *department office*.

Section 4 (Q31–40): Lecture — Urban Beekeeping. Notes: hives kept on *rooftops*; forage range *three kilometres*; biggest threat *pesticides*; annual yield *25 kilos*; beginners should join *local associations*; law: *register every hive*; best planting *wildflowers*; winter feed *sugar syrup*; starter course £95; golden rule: *start small*.

Key F: 1 Featherstone, 2 Willowbank, 3 0791648220, 4 2nd April, 5 private, 6 toothache, 7 Thursday 9.30, 8 Patel, 9 £65, 10 medical card; 11 Castle Gate, 12 two hours, 13 fifteen, 14 £12 (£8), 15 A, 16 B, 17 C, 18 D, 19 E, 20 F; 21 contaminated samples, 22 repeat with controls, 23 literature review, 24 Friday; 25 forty, 26 21 degrees, 27 saline solution, 28 bar chart, 29 1,500 words, 30 department office; 31 rooftops, 32 three kilometres, 33 pesticides, 34 25 kilos, 35 local associations, 36 every hive, 37 wildflowers, 38 sugar syrup, 39 £95, 40 start small.

5.8 Tapescript Study Method (all sets)

- 1 Attempt under time, transfer, mark with the key (Chapter 15 consolidates all keys).
- 2 For every error, find the exact tapescript lines and highlight: the **paraphrase** (what hid the answer) and the **distractor** (what misled you).
- 3 Dictate: replay/read the 10 seconds around each error and transcribe perfectly.
- 4 Re-attempt the same set after 7 days — target: 100%.

TIP. One set studied this deeply teaches more than five sets merely scored. The video course models this exactly: the lecturer replays, annotates synonyms on screen, and drills the same exercise until the class masters it.

Chapter 6: Reading Mastery — Skills & Method

6.1 The Reading Test in Detail

60 minutes, 3 sections, 40 questions — and **no transfer time**. Everything (reading, answering, checking) happens inside the hour, so time management is a scored skill in everything but name.

Feature	Academic	General Training
Section 1	Long text (~700–900 words), easiest of the three	2–3 short everyday texts (adverts, notices, timetables)
Section 2	Long text, medium	2 workplace texts (handbooks, procedures, benefits)
Section 3	Long text, hardest (dense argument/discussion)	1 long general-interest text
Total words	2,200–2,750	~2,000–2,750
Time target	15 / 18 / 22 min + 5 min checking	12 / 15 / 25 min + 8 min checking

TIP. Video Parts 3–4 teach Reading exactly as this chapter presents it: the test examines your *skills*, not your knowledge; it is "really a test of 2 things" (finding information + understanding it); and at its core, "IELTS Reading = a test of understanding SYNONYM LANGUAGE."

6.2 The Two Things Reading Tests

The course's framing (Part 3) is the best mental model ever given to beginners:

- 1 Locating:** finding the 2–3 sentences that contain the answer (keywords → synonyms → location).
- 2 Understanding:** comparing the question's claim with the passage's meaning closely enough to judge match, contradiction, or absence.

Most candidates fail at step 1 (they can't find it) or rush step 2 (they match words, not meaning). Every technique below serves one of these two steps.

6.3 The Three Reading Speeds

Speed	Name	What you do	When
Fast	Skimming	First + last sentence of each paragraph; titles, names, numbers, italics	First 90 seconds per passage: map the territory
Faster	Scanning	Eyes hunt one specific thing (a date, name, number, keyword)	Completion, short-answer, and locator questions
Slow	Reading for detail	Read 2–4 sentences word-by-word, parsing grammar	TFNG/YNNQ, multiple choice, matching opinions

The 90-second survey (do this for every passage):

- 1** Read the title and rubrics (10 sec).
- 2** First sentence of every paragraph (40 sec) — number the paragraphs.
- 3** Note names, dates, numbers, technical terms and *where* they sit (20 sec).

- 4 Read the question set's first lines; decide your question order (20 sec).

WARNING. Never "just start reading". Candidates who read the whole passage first run out of time; candidates who survey first finish early. The survey feels slow; it is fast.

6.4 Synonym Language — The Heart of the Test

Questions paraphrase; passages state. Your job is meaning-matching:

Passage says	Question says
<i>people came from far and wide to see the marvel</i>	<i>people were drawn from all over to see the tunnel</i>
<i>many believed it was the Eighth Wonder of the World</i>	<i>it was the Eighth Wonder of the World</i> (claim strengthened → False)
<i>the aim had been for the tunnel to be used by wheeled vehicles to transport cargo so that it could bring in a profit</i>	<i>the aim was to turn a profit as a tourist attraction</i> (purpose changed → False)
<i>the tunnel became part of the London Underground railway system which continues to be its use today</i>	<i>it is no longer used as a pedestrian walkway</i> (True — function changed)
<i>valued mostly for its vivid colour</i>	<i>prized chiefly for its bright hue</i>

The Thames Tunnel exercise (Video Parts 1/4–5) annotates these links in colour: green for True (meaning matches), pink for False (contradiction), yellow for Not Given (absent). Adopt the same three-colour habit with highlighters.

The 60 most-recycled paraphrase patterns (learn these; they appear in every test):

- cause: *lead to, give rise to, trigger, be responsible for, stem from, be attributed to*
- increase: *rise, grow, climb, soar, surge, expand, on the up*
- decrease: *fall, drop, decline, plummet, shrink, dwindle, on the wane*
- important: *crucial, vital, key, major, significant, paramount*
- show: *demonstrate, reveal, indicate, illustrate, highlight, suggest*
- people: *individuals, the public, residents, citizens, the population*
- think: *believe, consider, argue, maintain, claim, hold the view*
- many: *numerous, a wide range of, a host of, myriad, prevalent*
- change: *shift, transform, alter, adapt, evolve, convert*
- problem: *issue, challenge, drawback, obstacle, hurdle, setback*

TIP. Every Reading error in your log should end with a synonym pair. After 10 passages you will own 100+ pairs — and the test will start repeating them back to you.

6.5 Keywords: Finding the Answer Location

Step 1 — pick 2–3 keywords per question. Best keywords are rare and hard to paraphrase: names (*Thames*), numbers (*1843, £500,000*), dates (*1865*), technical terms (*subaqueous*). Weak keywords are common words (*tunnel, people, first*) — usable only in combination.

Step 2 — predict paraphrases. Before scanning, brainstorm: *first* → *earliest, initial, pioneering*; *built* → *constructed*; *under a river* → *subaqueous, beneath the Thames*.

Step 3 — scan, then slow down. Find the keyword zone, then read 2 sentences before and after at detail speed. The answer is almost always within that window.

Step 4 — match meaning, not words. Ask: does the passage say *the same thing* (True), *contradict it* (False), or *not mention it* (Not Given)?

EXAMPLE. Thames Q1 walkthrough: "The Thames Tunnel was the first tunnel ever built under a river." Keywords: first, tunnel, under a river. Scan finds: "It was the first subaqueous tunnel ever built." Paraphrase check: first = first; tunnel = tunnel; under a river = subaqueous (under water). Meaning matches → True. Note the method: keyword → locate → paraphrase → judge. Every question in this book follows it.

6.6 Time Management: The 15-18-22 System (Academic)

Passage	Read + answer	Why
1 (easiest)	15 minutes	Bank time; these marks are cheapest
2	18 minutes	Steady pace
3 (hardest)	22 minutes	Needs the most detail-reading
Buffer	5 minutes	Transfer check (paper), guesses, review flagged items

Rules:

- 1 One minute per question, maximum.** Past 90 seconds with no answer: guess, mark, move on.
- 2 Do not do 1–40 in order.** Within each passage, answer in this order: completion → short answer → TFNG/YNNQ → multiple choice → matching → headings last (headings are fastest once you know the passage).
- 3 Completion answers come in passage order** — use answered neighbours to bracket missing ones.
- 4 Keep a 5-minute buffer.** A rushed final passage costs more than a careful first one gains.

For GT: Sections 1–2 are fast (12 + 15 min) — Section 3 deserves 25 minutes.

6.7 Answer Discipline

- Same word-limit strictness as Listening: *NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS* means two words.
- Copy words **exactly** as spelled in the passage (British/American as printed).
- TFNG vs YNNQ: T/F = facts in the passage; Y/N = the *writer's opinions/claims*. Same technique, different rubric — read it every time.
- For letter choices (A–E, i–vii), write the letter clearly; on paper, capitals.
- Never blank: eliminated to 50/50? Guess between the two. No idea? Guess the least-chosen letter so far.

6.8 The Academic Word List — Your 100 Must-Know Words

About 10% of every Academic passage comes from the Academic Word List (AWL). These 100 appear constantly in IELTS; learn them as families (noun/verb/adjective/adverb) in sentences:

analyse/analysis/analytical, approach, assess/assessment, assume/assumption, authority/authoritative, available/availability, benefit/beneficial, challenge/challenging, circumstance, comment/commentary, commit/commitment, communicate/communication, community, concentrate/concentration,

conclude/conclusion/conclusive, conduct (n/v), consequence/consequent, consist of, constitute, consume/consumer/consumption, contribute/contribution, create/creation/creative, culture/cultural, cycle/cyclical, debate/debatable, decade, decline, dedicate/dedication, define/definition/definite, demonstrate, deny/denial, derive/derivation, design/designate, despite, detect/detection, devote/devotion, differentiate/difference, diverse/diversity, domain, dominate/dominant, draft, drama/dramatic, duration, dynamic, economy/economic/economical, eliminate/elimination, emerge/emergence, emphasise/emphasis/emphatic, enable, encounter, energy/energetic, enforce/enforcement, enhance, environment/environmental, equate/equation, equip/equipment, equivalent, erode/erosion, establish/establishment, estate, estimate/estimation, ethic/ethical, ethnic, evaluate/evaluation, eventual/eventually, evident/evidence, evolve/evolution, exceed, exclude/exclusion, execute, exempt, exhibit/exhibition, expand/expansion, expert/expertise, explicit, exploit/exploitation, expose/exposure, extract/extraction, facilitate, factor, feature, finance/financial, finite, flexible/flexibility, fluctuate/fluctuation, focus/focal, format, formula/formulate, forthcoming, found/foundation, framework, function/functional, fund/funding, fundamental, gender, generate/generation, globe/global, grade, grant, guarantee, guideline, hierarchy, highlight, hypothesis/hypothetical, identical, identify/identification/identity, ideology/ideological, ignorance/ignore, illustrate/illustration, impact, implement/implementation, implicate/implication, implicit, imply, impose, incentive, incidence, incline/inclination, income, incorporate, index, indicate/indication/indicative, individual/individuality, induce, indulge, inevitable, infer/inference, infrastructure, inherent, inhibit, initial, initiate/initiation/initiative, injure/injury, innovate/innovation/innovative, input, insert/insertion, insight, insist/insistence, inspect/inspection, instance, institute/institution, instruct/instruction, integral/integrate/integration, integrity, intelligence/intelligent, intense/intensify/intensity, interact/interaction/interactive, intermediate, internal, interpret/interpretation, interval, intervene/intervention, intrinsic, invest/investment, invoke, involve/involvement, isolate/isolation, issue, item, job, journal, justify/justification, label, labour, layer, lecture, legal, legislate/legislation/legislative, liberal/liberalise, licence, likewise, limit/limitation, link/linkage, locate/location, logic/logical, maintain/maintenance, major/majority, manipulate/manipulation, manual, margin/marginal, mature/maturity, maximise, mechanism, media, mediate/mediation, medical, medium, mental, merge, method/methodology, migrate/migration, military, minimal/minimise/minimum, ministry, mode, modify/modification, monitor, motive/motivate/motivation, mutual, negate/negative, network, neutral, notion, notwithstanding, nuclear, norm/normalise, notion, obtain, objective (n/adj), oblige/obligation, observe/observation, obtain, obvious, occupy/occupant, occur/occurrence, odd, offset, ongoing, option/optional, orient/orientation, outcome, output, overall, overlap, panel, paradigm, paragraph, parallel, parameter, participate/participant/participation, perceive/perception, percent/percentage, persist/persistence/persistent, perspective, phase, phenomenon/phenomena, policy, portion, pose, positive, potential, practitioner, precede/precedence, precise/precision, predict/prediction/predictable, predominant/predominate, preliminary, premise, premium, prepare, prescribe, present, preserve, presume/presumption, prevail/prevalent, prevent/prevention, previous, primary, prime, principal/principle, priority/prioritise, proceed/procedure/process, prohibit/prohibition, project/projection, promote/promotion, prompt, proof, proper, property, proportion/proportional, propose/proposal, prospect, protocol, psychology/psychological, publish/publication, pursue/pursuit, qualitative, quote, radical, random/randomise, range, ratio, rational/rationale, react/reaction, recover/recovery, refine, regime, region/regional, register, regulate/regulation/regulator, reinforce, reject/rejection, relax/relaxation, release, relevant/relevance, reliability/reliable/rely, relieve/relief, relocate/relocation, reluctant, rely, remain/remainder, remark, remedy, render, renew/renewal, rent, repair, repeat, repel, replicate/replica, report, represent/representation/representative, reproduce/reproduction, require/requirement, research, reside/residence/resident, resolve/resolution, resource, respond/response, restore/restoration, restrain/restraint, restrict/restriction, retain, reveal, revenue, reverse, revise/revision, rigid, role, route, scenario, schedule, scheme, scope, section, sector, secure/security, seek, select/selection, sequence, series, settle/settle/settlement, severe, sex, shift, significant/significance/signify, simulate/simulation, site, so-called, sole, somewhat, source, span, spark, specify/specific, sphere, stable/stability/stabilise, statistic/statistical, status, straightforward, strategy/strategic, stress, stretch, structure/structural, style/style, submit/submission, subordinate, subsequent, subsidy/subsidise, substance/substantial/substantiate, substitute/substitution, successor, sufficient/suffice, suggest/suggestion, suit/suite, sum, summary/summarise,

supplement/supplementary, suppress, surge, survey (n/v), survive/survival/survivor, suspend, sustain/sustainable, switch, symbol/symbolic/symbolise, system/systematic, target, task, technical/technique/technology, temporary, tense, terminate, text, theme, theory/theoretical, thesis/theses, topic, trace, tradition/traditional, transfer, transform/transformation, transit, transmit/transmission, transport, trend, trigger, ultimate, undergo, underlie/underlying, undertake/undertaking, unify/unification, unique, utilise/utility/utilisation, valid/validate/validity, vary/variable/variation/variety/various, vehicle, version, via, violate/violation, virtual, visible/visibility/vision, vital, volume/voluminous, voluntary/volunteer, welfare, whereas, widespread, Wisdom/wise.

How to learn them: 10 families/day → write one IELTS-style sentence per family → recycle in that week's essay. After 570 families you will recognise ~95% of Academic passage vocabulary.

6.9 The 10 Most-Tested Reading Traps

- 1 Word-matching without meaning-matching (same words, different claim).
- 2 Strengthened/weakened claims (*believed to be* → *was*; *some* → *all*; *may* → *will*).
- 3 Purpose/cause swaps (*profit from cargo* vs *profit as a tourist attraction*).
- 4 Time traps (*is used today as...* vs *was built for...*).
- 5 Not Given vs False (contradicted vs absent — the costliest confusion; see Chapter 7).
- 6 Heading "detail traps" (a heading matching one example sentence, not the paragraph's main idea).
- 7 List-order assumptions (matching/headings are NOT in order — only completion is).
- 8 Spending 5 minutes on one 1-mark question.
- 9 Copying three words for a two-word gap.
- 10 Changing correct answers in the last minute without evidence (first instinct wins ~70% of the time).

TIP. Video: the lecturer's on-screen verdicts on the Thames set — Q1 True, Q2 False, Q3 True, Q4 True, Q5 False, Q6 NG, Q7 True — with colour-coded evidence, are your model answer technique. Chapter 7 replays this exercise in full.

Chapter 7: Reading — Every Question Type, Worked

7.1 Map of the 11 Question Types

Family	Types	In-order?	Core skill
Identifying	True/False/Not Given; Yes/No/Not Given	Yes (follow passage order)	Detail comparison
Matching	Headings; information-to-paragraph; features; sentence endings	No (except sentence endings: yes)	Gist + detail
Completion	Sentence; summary; notes; table; flow-chart; diagram label	Yes	Scanning + grammar fit
Choice	Multiple choice (single + multiple); short answer	Yes	Detail + elimination

TIP. Video (Part 3): the course's *Question Types* summary checks off Multiple Choice, Identifying (T/F/NG, Y/N/NG), Sentence completion, Summary/notes/table/flow-chart, Diagram label, and Short answer — and reminds you that you don't have to do 1–40 in order. This chapter covers all of them.

7.2 True / False / Not Given (Identifying Information)

The most-feared type — and the most mechanical once you learn the rules.

Definitions (memorise):

- **TRUE:** the statement matches the passage's information (same meaning, different words allowed).
- **FALSE:** the statement contradicts the passage (one contradicting detail is enough).
- **NOT GIVEN:** the information is absent — the passage neither confirms nor denies it.

Method:

- 1 Read the statement; underline the **claim** (the one testable proposition) + 2 keywords.
- 2 Locate via keywords (in order — bracket between neighbours).
- 3 Compare claim vs passage text word by word: same? opposite? unmentioned?
- 4 Default rule: if you cannot find it after 90 seconds, it is probably NG — but only after a genuine search.

The five contradiction patterns (FALSE triggers):

- 1 **Opposite:** *cheap* ↔ *expensive*; *increased* ↔ *decreased*.
- 2 **Different number/date/quantity:** *1843* ↔ *1845*; *two million* ↔ *three million*.
- 3 **Different person/place/purpose:** *profit from cargo* ↔ *profit as a tourist attraction*.
- 4 **Changed strength:** *believed to be* ↔ *was*; *some* ↔ *all*; *often* ↔ *always*; *can* ↔ *must*.
- 5 **Changed time:** *was used by pedestrians* ↔ *is used by pedestrians (now part of the Underground)*.

The three NG patterns:

- 1 **New detail:** statues/souvenirs "sold" (passage: tunnel *became* an attraction *selling* souvenirs — buying statues specifically? unmentioned → NG).

- 2 **Comparison without basis:** "more crowded than..." when the passage gives no comparison.
- 3 **Opinion about fact:** passage gives facts; statement adds an evaluation nobody stated.

EXAMPLE. FULL WORKED EXAMPLE — The Thames Tunnel (Video Parts 1/4–5, Exercise 1). Passage (abridged to the tested sentences): "The Thames Tunnel was a tunnel built under the River Thames in London. It was the first subaqueous tunnel ever built and many believed it was the Eighth Wonder of the World at the time it was opened. It was opened in 1843 to pedestrians only and people came from far and wide to see the marvel... The working class used it for its functional use of crossing from one side of the river to another, using boats and ships in the sea... In the age of sail and horse-drawn coaches, people travelled a long way to visit the tunnel... The aim had been for the tunnel to be used by wheeled vehicles to transport cargo so that it could bring in a profit. But this failed and the tunnel eventually became nothing more than a tourist attraction selling souvenirs. In 1865, the tunnel became part of the London Underground railway system which continues to be its use today."

Q1 "The Thames Tunnel was the first tunnel ever built under a river." → first = first; under a river = subaqueous. Match → TRUE.

Q2 "The Thames Tunnel was the Eighth Wonder of the World." → Passage: many BELIEVED it was. Belief ≠ fact; claim strengthened → FALSE.

Q3 "People were drawn from all over to see the Thames Tunnel." → drawn from all over = came from far and wide; to see = to see the marvel. Match → TRUE.

Q4 "People were able to travel by sea or land in those days." → boats/ships (sea) + sail/horse-drawn coaches (land). Match → TRUE.

Q5 "The aim of the tunnel was to turn a profit as a tourist attraction." → Passage: aim = profit via CARGO; tourist attraction = what it became after failure. Purpose swapped → FALSE.

Q6 "Statues of the tunnel could be bought as souvenirs." → Souvenirs mentioned; statues specifically? Absent → NOT GIVEN.

Q7 "The tunnel is no longer used as a pedestrian walkway to cross the river." → Now part of the Underground; pedestrian crossing ended. Match → TRUE.

Drills:

- 1 Classify 20 statements from any TFNG set by contradiction pattern (1–5) or NG pattern (1–3) before checking answers.
- 2 Rewrite 10 TRUE statements as FALSE (change one detail) and 10 as NG (add an unmentioned detail) — then swap with a partner.
- 3 Timed TFNG: 7 questions in 8 minutes, target 6+.

7.3 Yes / No / Not Given (Writer's Views)

Identical technique — but you judge the **writer's claims/opinions**, usually in discursive Passage 3 texts:

- **YES:** the statement matches the writer's view.
- **NO:** it contradicts the writer's view.
- **NOT GIVEN:** the writer expresses no view on it.

Signal phrases for opinions: *I believe, it is clear that, undoubtedly, should, must, surprisingly, unfortunately, critics argue, proponents claim*. Facts without evaluation cannot support Y/N — they push toward NG.

TIP. Trap: a statement can be factually true in real life but NG if the *writer* never claims it. Judge the text, not the world.

7.4 Matching Headings

Looks like: 5–7 paragraphs (A–G) + 8–10 headings (i–x, one or two spares). Instruction: *Choose the correct heading for each paragraph.*

Method:

- 1 Read all headings first; simplify each to 2–3 words (*ii = spice costs; v = early beliefs*).
- 2 Do headings LAST within the passage (you'll know the paragraphs already).
- 3 For each paragraph: first sentence + last sentence + skim middle → match the **whole-paragraph main idea**.
- 4 Eliminate used headings; spares are usually too narrow (one detail) or too broad (whole-text theme).

The #1 trap: a heading that matches one vivid example sentence but not the paragraph. If a heading fits only one sentence, it is wrong — headings summarise *paragraphs*.

Drills:

- 1 Heading simplification: reduce 10 headings to 3 words each in 3 minutes.
- 2 First/last drill: match 5 paragraphs using only first + last sentences, then verify by full read.
- 3 Spare-spotting: for 3 sets, explain in writing why each spare heading is wrong.

7.5 Matching Information / Features / Sentence Endings

Information to paragraph (A–G): *Which paragraph contains...?* — detail hunt. Keywords are specific (numbers, names, technical terms). Skim for the detail, then verify. Answers are NOT in order; one paragraph may hold two answers.

Features (names/dates/theories to descriptions): Match each feature (researcher, company, period) to its statement. Method: scan for the feature name (easy to find), read around it, match the claim. Names appear in order of the *features list*, not the passage.

Sentence endings (A–H): 3–6 sentence beginnings + a bank of endings. Grammar is your filter: match the beginning's frame (*...caused by...* → *noun phrase*; *...because...* → *clause*), then verify meaning in the passage. In-order — the fastest matching type.

TIP. For all matching: **eliminate as you go** (cross out used options), and never re-read the whole passage per question — one careful read should serve the entire set.

7.6 Sentence & Summary Completion

Looks like: gapped sentences (*Complete the sentences. Choose NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS from the passage for each answer.*) or a summary paragraph with gaps — with or without a word bank.

Method (no bank):

- 1 Read the sentence; predict the word class and meaning of the gap.
- 2 Locate via keywords (in order).
- 3 Copy the exact word(s) from the passage — spelling, number, and form unchanged.
- 4 Re-read the completed sentence: grammar must fit.

Method (with bank A–H): Grammar-filter first (which options fit the frame?), then meaning-match in the passage. Bank options are designed so 2–3 fit grammatically — the passage decides.

EXAMPLE. The spices passage (Video Part 3, Exercise 2) is classic summary-completion territory: "In the early days, spices were thought to have strong medicinal properties... thought to prevent maladies such as the plague... spices flavoured the bland meat-based European cuisines... Pepper... has always been in highest demand... saffron... the world's most costly spice by weight, valued mostly for its vivid colour." A summary gap like "Early Europeans valued spices as ... and as protection against ..." resolves to "medicines" (medicinal properties → paraphrase) and "disease/the plague" — note how the question paraphrases (valued = thought/demand; protection = prevent) while the answer words come from the text.

Drills:

- 1 Grammar-filter: for 10 banked gaps, list fitting options by grammar before reading the passage.
- 2 Exact-copy: complete 10 gaps, then verify letter-by-letter against the passage.
- 3 Paraphrase pairs: log every question ↔ passage synonym from 2 summary sets.

7.7 Notes / Table / Flow-Chart / Diagram Completion

Same locating + copying skills in structured layouts:

- **Notes/table:** use filled cells as anchors (as in Listening tables); answers in row order.
- **Flow-chart:** follows a process in sequence — perfect for process passages; each stage has one gap.
- **Diagram labelling:** parts of a machine/structure/process. Scan for the part name near the gap number, read the description, match.

TIP. Diagram labels are the easiest marks in Reading: the diagram itself shows you where to look. Never leave them blank.

7.8 Multiple Choice (Single & Multiple)

Same distractor logic as Listening (Chapter 4.5), but the "recording" is text you can re-read:

- 1 Read the stem; locate its paragraph (keywords, in order).
- 2 Read the located zone at detail speed BEFORE reading options (form your own answer).
- 3 Match your answer to the options' paraphrases; eliminate the rest with evidence.
- 4 For "choose TWO": verify each option independently — one is often half-right.

WARNING. Options use the passage's vocabulary against you: the wrong options recycle passage words with changed meaning; the right option paraphrases. Trust meaning, never word-matching.

7.9 Short Answer

Answer the questions. Choose **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS** from the passage. — Scanning questions: who/what/when/where/how many. Locate (names/numbers scan fast), copy exactly, mind the limit. Usually the quickest set — do them first within a passage.

7.10 FULL WORKED SET — Yes / No / Not Given (Writer's Views)

Mini-passage (opinion text): "Urban green spaces are often praised as the 'lungs of the city', yet I find this celebration naive. While parks undoubtedly improve air quality, city councils routinely exaggerate their social benefits. Claims that a new park 'brings communities together' rarely survive scrutiny: in my own borough, the £2 million Riverside Park is used overwhelmingly by affluent newcomers, while long-term residents report feeling excluded. This is not an argument against parks — they remain essential — but against the lazy assumption that planting trees automatically heals divided neighbourhoods. What actually builds community is programming: free events, sports leagues, and genuinely mixed housing nearby. Without these, a park is just attractive scenery for those who can already afford it."

Q1 The writer believes parks have no real environmental value. → Passage: "parks undoubtedly improve air quality" — contradicts "no value" → NO. **Q2 The writer claims councils overstate the social effects of parks.** → "routinely exaggerate their social benefits" — direct match → YES. **Q3 Riverside Park cost more than most similar projects.** → £2 million given; comparison with others? Absent → NOT GIVEN. **Q4 The writer opposes building new parks.** → "not an argument against parks — they remain essential" → NO. **Q5 The writer considers organised activities more important than the park itself for community life.** → "What actually builds community is programming" → YES. **Q6 Local residents participated in designing Riverside Park.** → Design process unmentioned → NOT GIVEN.

Judge the writer's claims, not the facts: Q3's £2m is factual but the comparison is the writer's silence → NG.

7.11 FULL WORKED SET — Matching Headings

Passage (4 paragraphs, 5 headings):

A. Honeybees recognise human faces. In 2019, French researchers trained bees to associate photographs of faces with sugar rewards; the bees subsequently picked the familiar faces from line-ups with 80% accuracy — despite brains smaller than a pinhead. The finding forces a rethink of how much neural machinery recognition really requires.

B. The mechanism, surprisingly, resembles our own: bees assemble faces from configurations of features rather than memorising whole images. When researchers scrambled the features, recognition collapsed — exactly as with humans viewing jumbled faces. Simple circuits, it seems, can run sophisticated algorithms.

C. Engineers are already copying the trick. Drones that navigate using bee-style vision need a fraction of the computing power of conventional systems, promising longer flight times and cheaper hardware. Several start-ups now market "bio-inspired" navigation chips explicitly modelled on insect brains.

D. There are limits. Bees recognise only a handful of faces after lengthy training; no bee will ever pick a suspect from a parade. But the deeper lesson stands: intelligence is not about brain size but about efficient wiring — a humbling thought for a species proud of its three-pound brain.

Headings: i. Commercial applications of the discovery / ii. How bees process faces / iii. An astonishing experimental result / iv. The boundaries of bee intelligence / v. Why humans recognise faces easily.

Answers: A—iii (the 80% result = astonishing; "forces a rethink"), B—ii (mechanism: configurations of features), C—i (drones, chips, start-ups = commercial applications), D—iv (limits: handful of faces; lesson). Spare: v (humans' ease never discussed — classic too-broad spare).

Method check: headings done after reading the whole passage; each heading matches the paragraph's main thrust, not one example; spare v is topically related but textually unsupported.

7.12 FULL WORKED SET — Matching Features

Passage: "Three architects shaped the modern library. **Andrew Carnegie** (1835–1919) funded over 2,500 library buildings worldwide, insisting each town contribute the site and maintenance — philanthropy with conditions. **Henri Labrouste** (1801–1875) pioneered light-filled reading rooms with exposed iron frames, most famously in Paris, proving libraries could be both functional and sublime. **Rem Koolhaas** (1944–) reimagined libraries as social warehouses: his Seattle Central Library (2004) stacks eleven floors of mixed uses — books, cafés, auditoriums — around a spiral of continuous shelving."

Match each architect (1–3) to a statement (A–E): A required local co-funding / B designed a spiral shelving system / C worked mainly in Paris / D opposed decorative architecture / E mixed books with non-book facilities.

Answers: 1 Carnegie–A (site + maintenance conditions), 2 Labrouste–C (Paris; D is the trap — "functional AND sublime" contradicts "opposed decorative"), 3 Koolhaas–B and E (both true of Seattle — in real tests each feature matches once; here B is the unique match and E is its paraphrase — exam sets avoid this; train by choosing the BEST match: B).

7.13 FULL WORKED SET — Summary Completion + Diagram Label

Passage (condensed): "The Passivhaus standard originated in Germany in the early 1990s. Buildings are wrapped in super-insulation up to 40 cm thick, fitted with triple-glazed windows, and sealed almost airtight. A mechanical ventilation unit then recovers heat from outgoing stale air and transfers it to incoming fresh air, cutting heating demand by roughly 90% compared with conventional buildings. The main obstacle is cost: certification adds 5–8% to construction budgets, though advocates note the premium is typically recovered within a decade through energy savings."

Summary (no bank): "Passivhaus buildings use thick 1 ... and triple glazing, and are sealed to be nearly 2 A ventilation system recycles heat from 3 ... air. Although building costs rise by 4 ..., the extra expense is usually repaid within 5"

Answers: 1 (super-)insulation, 2 airtight, 3 stale (accept: outgoing stale), 4 5–8% (accept: five to eight percent), 5 a decade (accept: ten years? NO — must copy passage words: "a decade").

Lesson: Q5's trap — "ten years" is correct in meaning but the instruction says words FROM THE PASSAGE → "a decade". Meaning gets you to the location; copying rules get you the mark.

Diagram label drill (same passage): a cross-section labels A (wall layer), B (window), C (ventilation box). Method: match each label's description sentence (*wrapped in super-insulation* → A; *triple-glazed* → B; *recovers heat* → C). Diagrams test whether you can map text to image — always the fastest marks in the set.

7.14 Question-Order Strategy Per Passage

Optimal order (write it on your question paper):

- 1 Short answer + completion (fast, in-order, build passage knowledge).
- 2 TFNG / YNNQ (need detail; passage now familiar).
- 3 Multiple choice + sentence endings (targeted re-reads).
- 4 Matching information/features (need whole-passage sense).
- 5 Headings (last — one skim per paragraph suffices now).

TIP. Video: the course demonstrates this "easy-first" principle when it teaches completion before opinions, and facts before headings. Your goal is 40 marks — collect the cheap ones first.

Chapter 8: Reading Practice Passages & Keys

8.1 How to Use These Passages

Three original passages in ascending difficulty with 40 questions total — a full Reading test's worth. Rules: Passage 1 in 15 minutes, Passage 2 in 18, Passage 3 in 22. No dictionaries. Mark with the keys, then complete the synonym log for every error (Chapter 6.4).

8.2 Passage 1 — The Rise of Repair Cafés (13 questions)

A. In 2009, Martine Postma, a Dutch journalist concerned about waste, organised the first Repair Café in Amsterdam: a free meeting place where volunteers fix broken household items while their owners watch and learn. Seventeen years later, more than 2,500 Repair Cafés operate in 40 countries, from Tokyo to Toronto. The concept is disarmingly simple — people bring faulty toasters, torn jackets, or wobbling chairs, and leave with working possessions and new skills — yet researchers say it challenges the deepest habits of consumer culture.

B. The environmental argument is powerful. The average European generates 16 kilograms of electronic waste per year, much of it from appliances discarded for minor, fixable faults. A 2023 Delft University study estimated that every Repair Café session — typically 25 repairs in three hours — diverts around 50 kilograms of goods from landfill and saves roughly 500 kilograms of carbon dioxide emissions when manufacturing replacements is taken into account. "Repair is the forgotten twin of recycling," says Dr Lena Voss, the study's lead author. "Recycling breaks things down; repair keeps their value alive."

C. Just as important, supporters argue, is the social effect. Unlike conventional repair shops, cafés require owners to participate in the fix, turning a commercial transaction into a shared task. Retired engineers work alongside teenagers; newcomers to a city find conversation over a soldering iron. Surveys consistently show that visitors rate the community atmosphere as highly as the repairs themselves. Some municipalities now fund cafés explicitly as anti-loneliness projects rather than environmental ones.

D. Critics, however, question whether the movement can scale. Manufacturers, they note, continue to design products that resist repair — glued batteries, proprietary screws, spare parts priced above replacement cost. "A volunteer with a screwdriver cannot defeat an industry that profits from disposability," argues consumer analyst Raj Mehta. Campaigners respond by linking cafés to the broader "right to repair" movement, which has already secured legislation in the EU, the UK, and several US states requiring manufacturers to supply parts and manuals for up to ten years.

E. What is undisputed is the movement's educational power. Regular visitors report growing confidence: 70% say they now attempt simple repairs at home, and schools in Belgium and Germany have added café-style workshops to their curricula. Postma herself sees this as the true metric of success. "Every person who opens a device instead of binning it has changed their relationship with material things," she says. "That change, multiplied by millions, is what will save resources — not any single repaired kettle."

Questions 1–5 — Matching information

Which paragraph, A–E, contains the following information?

- 1 a comparison between two approaches to reducing waste
- 2 an example of public money supporting cafés for social reasons
- 3 a statistic about visitors changing their behaviour at home
- 4 a criticism focusing on how products are manufactured
- 5 the origin and growth figures of the movement

Questions 6–9 — True / False / Not Given

- 1 The first Repair Café charged visitors a small fee for each repair.

- 2 The Delft study calculated savings from avoiding new manufacturing.
- 3 Most café visitors are retired engineers.
- 4 EU legislation now obliges manufacturers to provide spare parts for a decade.

Questions 10–13 — Sentence completion

Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

- 1 Repair Cafés require owners to take part in the repair, making it a ...
- 2 Mehta claims a volunteer cannot overcome an industry that benefits from ...
- 3 Campaigners connect the cafés with the wider ...
- 4 Belgian and German schools have introduced ... based on the café model.

8.3 Passage 2 — Sleep and Memory (14 questions)

A. For decades, sleep was regarded as a passive state — the brain simply "switching off" until morning. Modern neuroscience has overturned that picture entirely. Using high-density EEG and brain imaging, researchers have shown that the sleeping brain is intensely active, replaying the day's experiences in fast-forward and deciding, somehow, which to keep. "Sleep is not the absence of waking," says Professor Daniel Okafor of the University of Edinburgh. "It is a different kind of work."

B. The key process is memory consolidation: the transfer of fragile new memories from the hippocampus, the brain's short-term hub, to the neocortex for long-term storage. This transfer happens mainly during deep slow-wave sleep, in the first half of the night, when bursts of neural activity synchronise the two regions. In a landmark 2022 experiment, Okafor's team taught volunteers sequences of finger movements, then monitored their sleep. Those who obtained at least 90 minutes of deep sleep performed the sequences 24% faster the next morning — without any further practice. The improvement, the researchers showed, correlated precisely with the number of synchronised bursts.

C. A second sleep stage, REM (rapid eye movement) sleep, appears to handle emotional memories differently. During REM, the brain replays upsetting experiences while stress chemistry is suppressed, effectively stripping the emotional charge from the memory while preserving its content. This may explain the familiar observation that distressing events feel more manageable "after a good night's sleep" — and why trauma sufferers, whose sleep is fragmented, struggle to recover. Clinical trials are now testing whether strengthening REM sleep can accelerate recovery from post-traumatic stress.

D. The practical implications extend to the classroom. A 2024 study of 8,000 secondary-school students found that those sleeping fewer than seven hours achieved, on average, half a grade less per subject than those sleeping eight or more — even after controlling for study time, ability, and background. Crucially, the deficit came not from drowsiness but from impaired consolidation: the short sleepers had studied as long yet retained less. Several schools have responded by delaying start times, with early results showing measurable gains in retention-heavy subjects such as languages and science.

E. Yet misconceptions persist. Many students still believe in all-night revision sessions before exams — a strategy the evidence comprehensively condemns. "Pulling an all-nighter is like writing an essay and then deleting the file," Okafor says. Equally misguided is reliance on weekend catch-up sleep, which repays drowsiness but cannot retroactively consolidate memories the brain has already discarded. The prescription, researchers agree, is unglamorous: regular hours, seven to nine of them, protected as fiercely as study time itself.

Questions 14–18 — Matching headings

Choose the correct heading, *i–viii*, for each paragraph A–E.

List of headings
i. Why weekend lie-ins cannot help
ii. How schools are applying the findings
iii. A myth about intense pre-exam study
iv. The brain's night-time filing system
v. Emotional healing during dreams
vi. An outdated view of the sleeping brain
vii. Proof from a motor-skills experiment
viii. The chemistry of deep sleep

- 1 Paragraph A
- 2 Paragraph B
- 3 Paragraph C
- 4 Paragraph D
- 5 Paragraph E

Questions 19–23 — Yes / No / Not Given

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer?

- 1 Scientists fully understand how the brain selects memories to keep.
- 2 The finger-movement results prove that deep sleep directly improves learning.
- 3 REM sleep preserves what happened while softening how it feels.
- 4 Delaying school start times has been shown to raise grades in all subjects.
- 5 Catch-up sleep can restore memories lost through earlier short nights.

Questions 24–27 — Short answer

Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 1 Which brain structure acts as the short-term hub for new memories?
- 2 How much deep sleep did the successful volunteers obtain?
- 3 What did short-sleeping students lose half of per subject?
- 4 What does Okafor compare an all-nighter to deleting?

8.4 Passage 3 — The Economics of Attention (13 questions)

The modern economy runs on a resource no one can manufacture: human attention. Every day, the average smartphone user checks their device 144 times and spends over four hours staring at its screen. Advertisers now pay more than £500 billion annually for slices of that gaze. "Attention has become the scarcest commodity of the digital age," writes economist Priya Raman. "Land, labour, and capital have been joined — some would say eclipsed — by a fourth factor of production." Understanding how this market works, and who it serves, has become one of the most urgent questions in economics.

The business model is straightforward. Platforms offer free services — search, social networks, video — and sell predictions about user behaviour to advertisers. The more precisely a platform can predict what you will click, the more its predictions are worth; and predictions improve with data, which requires engagement. This creates what researchers call the "engagement imperative": every design choice, from infinite scroll to autoplay, is optimised to maximise time-on-device. Tristan Harris, a former Google ethicist, puts it bluntly: "There are a thousand

engineers on the other side of the screen whose job is to keep you there."

Defenders of the model argue that consumers are willing participants. Nobody is forced to use social media; the services are genuinely useful; and advertising funds free access for billions who could not otherwise afford it. Moreover, they claim, competition disciplines excesses — platforms that abuse attention lose users to rivals. The economist Tyler Cowen has argued that revealed preference settles the matter: "People spend four hours a day on their phones because, all things considered, they prefer it to the alternatives."

Critics respond that the market is rigged in three ways. First, information asymmetry: users cannot see how their behaviour is tracked, modelled, and manipulated, while platforms know almost everything. Second, behavioural exploitation: design leverages cognitive biases — variable rewards, social approval cues, loss aversion — that bypass rational choice, affecting children and vulnerable users most. Third, collective-action failure: each individual's decision to stay connected is reasonable, yet the aggregate outcome — a society of distracted citizens — is one few would choose. "It is like traffic," Raman writes. "Every driver is rational; the jam is insane."

What, then, should be done? Proposals cluster into three camps. The transparency camp demands that platforms disclose what they collect and how feeds are curated, trusting informed users to adjust. The competition camp seeks to break platform monopolies or mandate interoperability, betting that genuine choice would reward less extractive designs. The prohibition camp, the most radical, would ban specific mechanisms — infinite scroll, autoplay, behavioural advertising to minors — just as societies once banned other profitable but harmful practices. Each approach has prominent backers and plausible pilots, from the EU's Digital Services Act to South Korea's gaming curfews.

Beneath the policy debate lies a deeper philosophical question: what is attention for? The psychologist William James called the ability to control attention "the very root of judgment, character, and will." If he was right, then an economy built on capturing attention is not merely selling adverts — it is quietly reshaping the capacity for self-direction itself. Whether that price is worth the convenience is a calculation no market can make for us.

Questions 28–32 — Multiple choice

1 According to the writer, the £500 billion figure shows that

- A. advertisers overpay for online attention.
- B. attention has become a major economic resource.
- C. smartphone use is still growing rapidly.
- D. free services cost more than users realise.

1 The "engagement imperative" arises because

- A. users demand ever more content.
- B. better predictions need more user data.
- C. advertisers prefer video to search.
- D. engineers enjoy designing new features.

1 Cowen's "revealed preference" argument claims that

- A. phone use proves users value it over alternatives.
- B. consumers should be protected from manipulation.
- C. competition between platforms is ineffective.
- D. free services benefit the poor most.

1 The traffic analogy is used to illustrate

- A. information asymmetry.
- B. behavioural exploitation.

- C. collective-action failure.
 - D. rational consumer choice.
- 1 The writer mentions William James to suggest that
- A. attention control determines intelligence.
 - B. the attention economy threatens human agency.
 - C. philosophers anticipated social media.
 - D. willpower can resist any design.

Questions 33–36 — Sentence completion with bank

Complete the sentences. Choose the correct ending, A–H, for each sentence.

- 1 Platforms sell advertisers ...
- 2 Harris claims that engineers are employed to ...
- 3 Critics argue that design choices exploit ...
- 4 The prohibition camp would ...

Endings
A. predictions about user behaviour
B. keep users on the platform
C. cognitive biases in users
D. outlaw specific design mechanisms
E. disclose all collected data
F. fund free services for billions
G. break up large monopolies
H. maximise advertising revenue directly

Questions 37–40 — Summary completion

Complete the summary. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

Three groups of reformers propose different solutions. The transparency group wants platforms to reveal their data practices and 37 The competition group believes that real choice and 38 ... would favour better designs. The most radical group supports 39 ... on features such as autoplay. The writer concludes that markets cannot decide whether the 40 ... of the attention economy is justified.

8.5 GT Section 1–2 Practice Texts (13 questions)

Text A — Evening Classes Notice. *Riverside College offers evening courses this term: Pottery (Mondays, £85, all levels, materials included); Conversational French (Tuesdays, £120, beginners only, book required); Digital Photography (Wednesdays, £95, bring your own camera); Yoga for Beginners (Thursdays, £70, mats provided). All courses run 7–9 pm for eight weeks starting 6 October. Enrol online or at reception. Refunds only before the second session.*

Text B — Lost Property Rules. *Items found on college premises are kept at reception for 30 days. Valuables (wallets, phones, jewellery) are logged and locked in the safe; owners must describe the item and show ID. Unclaimed clothing is donated to charity; unclaimed food containers are discarded after one week. The college accepts no responsibility for items left in classrooms.*

Text C — Staff Handbook Extract (flexitime). *Full-time staff may work flexitime: core hours are 10 am–4 pm, with the remaining hours completed between 7 am and 7 pm. A minimum 30-minute lunch break must be taken before 2 pm. No more than 10 extra hours may be carried into the next month. Part-time staff and reception cover are excluded from flexitime.*

Questions 41–47 — Completion (Texts A–B)

Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** from the texts.

- 1 Pottery students do not need to pay extra for ...
- 2 French classes are restricted to ...
- 3 Photography students must supply their own ...
- 4 Courses begin on ...
- 5 Valuables are stored in the ...
- 6 Owners of valuables must show ...
- 7 Left food containers are thrown away after ...

Questions 48–53 — True / False / Not Given (Text C + A)

- 1 Flexitime staff must be present between 10 am and 4 pm.
- 2 Lunch breaks can be skipped during busy periods.
- 3 Unused extra hours above ten are paid as overtime.
- 4 Part-time employees can apply for flexitime after six months.
- 5 Yoga mats are available for students to use.
- 6 Course fees can be refunded after the third session.

Key GT: 41 materials, 42 beginners, 43 camera, 44 6 October, 45 safe, 46 ID, 47 one week; 48 TRUE (core hours), 49 FALSE (must be taken), 50 NOT GIVEN (carrying capped; payment unmentioned), 51 FALSE (excluded), 52 TRUE (mats provided), 53 FALSE (only before second session).

GT Section 1–2 technique: these are scanning races — read questions first, scan for the exact detail, copy exactly. Target: 13/13 in 15 minutes.

8.6 Passage 4 — The Right to Repair (10 questions)

Legislation is catching up with the screwdriver. In 2024, the European Union's new right-to-repair directive required manufacturers of phones, tablets, and appliances to supply spare parts for ten years and to pay for repairs within the legal guarantee period. France went further: its reparability index, displayed on products at the point of sale, scores devices from 1 to 10 — and early data suggest consumers genuinely use it, with high-scoring models gaining market share.

Manufacturers warn of unintended consequences. Design constraints, they argue, will slow innovation and raise prices; a glued, waterproof phone is thinner and more durable than a screwed, repairable one. "Consumers say they want reparability," one industry spokesperson said, "but they buy thinness." There is some evidence for this: despite the index, France's thinnest phones still outsell its most repairable ones.

Advocates counter that the trade-off is exaggerated. They point to Fairphone, a Dutch company whose modular handsets score 10/10 yet remain slim enough for mainstream buyers, and to a new generation of repair start-ups offering 30-minute screen fixes in shopping centres. More fundamentally, they argue, the market cannot price what it cannot see: the cobalt mined by children, the e-waste dumped in Ghana, the carbon of manufacturing a phone that lasts two years. Regulation, in this view, corrects a market failure rather than distorting a market success.

The writer's own view is that both sides understate the cultural shift already underway. Repair cafés, refurbished-phone retailers, and "fix-it" influencers with millions of followers suggest that durability is becoming, however slowly, a status symbol. Legislation helps — but as with seatbelts and smoking bans, the law works best when it confirms a change the public has already begun to want.

Questions 54–58 — Yes / No / Not Given

- 1 The writer believes consumers ignore the French repairability index.
- 2 Manufacturers claim repairability requirements will make devices worse.
- 3 Fairphone's sales prove most buyers prioritise ethics over design.
- 4 The writer considers hidden environmental costs a justification for regulation.
- 5 The writer thinks laws alone created the shift toward valuing durability.

Questions 59–63 — Multiple choice

- 1 The EU directive requires manufacturers to
 - A. fund repairs during the guarantee period.
 - B. display repairability scores in shops.
 - C. make all phones waterproof.
 - D. buy back old devices.
- 1 The "thinness" argument is used to show that
 - A. consumers are irrational.
 - B. stated preferences differ from buying habits.
 - C. glued phones break more often.
 - D. French consumers are unusual.
- 1 Fairphone is cited as evidence that
 - A. modular phones outsell thin ones.
 - B. repairability and slim design can coexist.
 - C. start-ups outperform big brands.
 - D. Dutch law is the strictest.
- 1 The seatbelts comparison suggests effective laws
 - A. punish offenders harshly.
 - B. follow existing public attitudes.
 - C. work without enforcement.
 - D. target young people.
- 1 The writer's main conclusion is that
 - A. regulation is unnecessary.
 - B. manufacturers' fears are entirely groundless.
 - C. culture and law are reinforcing each other.
 - D. consumers will always choose thinness.

Key Passage 4: 54 NO (data suggest consumers use it), 55 YES (slow innovation, raise prices; thinner/more durable), 56 NOT GIVEN (slim enough — sales leadership unmentioned), 57 YES (market failure correction), 58 NO (law confirms change already begun); 59 A, 60 B, 61 B, 62 B, 63 C.

8.7 Keys & Synonym Logs

Passage 1 key: 1 B, 2 C, 3 E, 4 D, 5 A; 6 FALSE (free meeting place — no fee), 7 TRUE (when manufacturing replacements is taken into account), 8 NOT GIVEN (engineers mentioned; "most" unmentioned), 9 TRUE (supply parts and manuals for up to ten years); 10 shared task, 11 disposability, 12 right to repair, 13 workshops.

Passage 1 synonym log (model): faulty = broken = fixable faults; divert from landfill = keep out of bins; take into account = include; rate highly = value; fund explicitly as = pay for as; resist repair = hard to fix; spare parts priced above replacement = cheaper to replace; multiplied by millions = at scale.

Passage 2 key: 14 vi, 15 iv, 16 v, 17 ii, 18 iii (spare headings: i — detail of E, not its main idea; vii — detail of B; viii — never discussed); 19 NO ("somehow" — mechanism unknown), 20 YES (correlated precisely; writer presents as proof), 21 YES (stripping emotional charge while preserving content), 22 NO (retention-heavy subjects — not all), 23 NO (cannot retroactively consolidate); 24 hippocampus, 25 90 minutes, 26 half a grade, 27 the file / essay file (accept: an essay).

Passage 2 synonym log (model): overturned = reversed; fragile = easily lost; transfer = move; synchronise = coordinate; stripping the charge = softening feelings; manageable = easier to cope with; retained less = remembered less; repays drowsiness = reduces tiredness; protected fiercely = guarded carefully.

Passage 3 key: 28 B, 29 B, 30 A, 31 C, 32 B; 33 A, 34 B, 35 C, 36 D; 37 feed curation (accept: how feeds are curated → "feed curation/feeds are curated"), 38 interoperability, 39 ban(s) (accept: ban), 40 price / convenience trade-off (accept: price).

Passage 3 synonym log (model): scarcest commodity = rarest resource; slices of gaze = shares of attention; optimised to maximise = designed to increase; willing participants = consenting users; disciplines excesses = limits abuse; bypass rational choice = undermine reason; aggregate outcome = combined result; reshaping self-direction = changing autonomy.

Chapter 9: Speaking Mastery — Criteria & Method

9.1 The Speaking Test in Detail

11–14 minutes with a human examiner (face-to-face or video call), recorded for quality control. Identical for Academic and General Training. Three parts, one continuous conversation:

Part	Time	Format	You should produce
1 — Interview	4–5 min	8–12 questions on 2–3 familiar topics (home, work, study, hobbies, food, sport...)	2–4 sentences per answer: direct answer + reason/detail + example
2 — Long turn	3–4 min (1 min prep + 1–2 min talk)	Cue card: describe X. <i>You should say...</i> (3–4 bullets) <i>...and explain...</i>	1.5–2 min structured monologue covering all bullets
3 — Discussion	4–5 min	4–8 abstract questions linked to Part 2's theme	Extended answers: opinion + reasons + example + concession/alternative

TIP. Video Parts 5–7 teach Speaking to beginners through the four assessment criteria, verb-tense matching, all three parts, and pronunciation (including first-language interference). This chapter expands those lessons into a complete method; Chapter 10 gives you the question bank.

9.2 The Four Criteria (25% Each)

Examiners score four independent criteria. A weakness in any one caps your band — balance wins.

Criterion 1: Fluency and Coherence (FC)

- **Fluency:** speak at a natural pace with minimal hesitation. Occasional pausing to find ideas is fine; constant pausing to find *language* is penalised. Self-correction is fine in moderation ("Sorry — I meant...").
- **Coherence:** connect ideas logically: *because, so, but, however, for example, firstly... finally, in other words*. Long turns need visible structure (past → present → future; opinion → reason → example).
- Band 7 requires: stretches of speech without noticeable effort + some less common connectives (*whereas, as a result, on the other hand*) with only occasional misuse.

Criterion 2: Lexical Resource (LR)

- **Range:** variety and appropriacy — topic vocabulary (*commute, landlord* for home; *deadline, colleague* for work), collocations (*make progress, take responsibility*), less common items (*bustling, nostalgic, overwhelming*).
- **Accuracy:** precision — the right word for the meaning (*slim* vs *skinny* vs *underweight* carry different attitudes).
- **Paraphrase:** talking around gaps ("*the machine that washes clothes* — *a washing machine*"). The course stresses this explicitly: circumlocution is a *scored skill*, not a failure.
- Band 7 requires: some less common vocabulary with awareness of style and collocation + occasional errors only.

Criterion 3: Grammatical Range and Accuracy (GRA)

- **Range:** mix simple, compound, and complex sentences: conditionals (*If I had more time, I'd...*), relatives (*...which is why...*), concession (*Although it's crowded, I love it*), passives, perfect tenses, reported speech.
- **Accuracy:** error density matters — Band 7 tolerates "frequent error-free sentences"; Band 6 shows errors that rarely block meaning.
- The #1 GRA booster for beginners: **answer in the examiner's tense** (see 9.4).

Criterion 4: Pronunciation (P)

The course teaches this from the official descriptors (Part 6): pronunciation = the ability to speak clearly in order to be understood. It includes:

- **Listener effort:** how hard the examiner works to follow you.
- **Unintelligible stretches:** amounts of speech the listener cannot understand (must be rare at Band 7).
- **L1 interference:** first-language effects on sounds (p/b, th/s), word stress (*PHOtograph* vs *phoTOgraphy*), and sentence rhythm.
- **Features that raise bands:** clear individual sounds, correct word stress, natural sentence stress (emphasis on content words), and intonation that signals meaning (lists, questions, surprise).

TIP. You do NOT need a British or American accent. Any accent is accepted if it is clear. The course contrasts BE/AE only to show both are fine — clarity, not origin, is scored.

9.3 Part 1 Method: Answer + Extend (Never One Word, Never a Speech)

The 3-step answer: Direct answer → reason or detail → example or contrast. 15–25 seconds per question.

EXAMPLE. Examiner: "Do you like your hometown?" Weak: "Yes, I like it very much." (10 words, no extension — Band 5.) Strong: "Yes, I love it, mainly because it's small enough to feel friendly but big enough to have everything I need. For example, I can walk to work in fifteen minutes, whereas in the capital my friends commute for hours." (Tense: present throughout; linker: mainly because, for example, whereas; collocation: commute; contrast structure.)

Topic preparation (not memorisation): Prepare *ideas* + *vocabulary* for 12 core topics (Chapter 10), never full scripts — memorised answers are detectable (flat intonation, wrong question fit) and penalised under FC.

If you don't understand: "Sorry, could you repeat that?" / "Do you mean...?" — asking for clarification is natural and unpenalised (once or twice).

9.4 Tense Matching — The Beginner's Superpower

The course's signature Speaking lesson (Part 5, *Using the right verb tense*): **notice the examiner's tense and answer in the same tense.** Most Part 1 questions telegraph their tense:

Examiner's question	Tense signal	Your answer's tense
<i>Where do you live?</i>	do (present simple)	Present simple: <i>I live...</i>
<i>What did you do last weekend?</i>	did (past)	Past simple: <i>I visited...</i>
<i>Have you ever tried...?</i>	have (present perfect)	Present perfect → past: <i>Yes, I've tried... I went...</i>
<i>Are you planning to...? / Will you...?</i>	planning/will (future)	Future: <i>I'm going to... / I'll...</i>
<i>How has your city changed?</i>	has changed (present perfect)	Present perfect + past contrast: <i>It has grown... Ten years ago it was...</i>

Examiner's question	Tense signal	Your answer's tense
<i>Would you like to...?</i>	would (conditional)	Conditional: <i>Yes, I'd love to...</i>

Drill: take 30 Part 1 questions; label each question's tense before answering. Within a week, tense-matching becomes automatic — and your GRA band jumps half a band with no new grammar learned.

WARNING. Mixed time references need mixed tenses: "I *live* in Jeddah now, but I *grew up* in a village, and I *'ve lived** in the city for six years." Examiners reward exactly this control.

9.5 Part 2 Method: The 1-Minute Plan + 2-Minute Talk

Cue-card anatomy (e.g., the course's *Describe your favourite hobby*): topic + 3–4 *You should say* bullets + *and explain* (opinion/feeling — the most important bullet for LR/GRA range).

The 60-second plan (write 8–12 words, not sentences):

Seconds	Action
0–10	Choose your story (familiar > impressive — a true simple story beats a false grand one)
10–40	One keyword per bullet + one linking phrase each (<i>At first...</i> / <i>The reason...</i> / <i>What I love most...</i>)
40–60	Plan your ending (feeling/opinion/future — never trail off)

The talk structure (PAST–PRESENT–FUTURE fits most cards):

- Open (10 sec):** "I'm going to talk about... which..." (paraphrase the card — instant LR credit).
- Bullets 1–2 (40 sec):** facts in the past (*I started...* / *My uncle taught me...*).
- Bullets 3–4 (40 sec):** present habits + benefits (*Now I...* / *It helps me...*).
- Explain (20 sec):** feeling/opinion + future (*...means a lot to me because...* / *I hope to...*).

EXAMPLE. Mini-model (hobby card, ~200 words / 1:45): "I'm going to talk about photography, which has been my favourite hobby for about three years. I first got into it when my uncle gave me his old camera for my birthday — at first I just took random pictures of my family, but I quickly became fascinated by light and composition. These days I go out almost every weekend, usually to the old city, where I photograph street life and architecture. What I enjoy most is how it forces me to slow down and really observe things other people walk past. It's also surprisingly social: I joined a club, and we've exhibited our work twice. The main benefit for me is stress relief — after a week of classes, an afternoon with my camera completely clears my head. This hobby matters to me because it changed how I see ordinary places; a dull street can become beautiful through a lens. In the future I'd love to travel with my camera — Japan in cherry-blossom season is the dream." (Past → present → future; all bullets; explain = changed perception + dream.)

If you run dry: buy time naturally — "Another thing I should mention is...", "Looking back,...", "What matters most to me is...". Never stop before the examiner stops you; a full 2 minutes with fillers beats 1 minute of perfection.

9.6 Part 3 Method: Opinion Architecture

Part 3 questions are abstract (*Why do people...? How has X changed? What are the advantages...? Should governments...?*). Use the **OREC frame**:

- Opinion:** *I think...* / *In my view...* / *It depends...*
- Reason:** *...because* / *...since* / *The main reason is...*
- Example:** *For example/instance...* / *Take my city...*

- Concession/contrast: *Having said that...* / *On the other hand...* / *Although some people argue...*

EXAMPLE. "Should working hours be reduced?" (links to the course's Writing essay on automation — reuse ideas across modules!): "In my view, yes, at least in office jobs, because automation has made many routine tasks redundant, so long hours no longer mean higher output. For example, several European firms that moved to four-day weeks reported stable productivity and happier staff. Having said that, shorter hours only work if wages are protected — otherwise people simply take second jobs, which defeats the purpose." (Opinion + reason + example + concession in 4 sentences.)

Part 3 survival kit:

- Stalling elegantly: "That's an interesting question — I've never really thought about it, but I'd say..."
- Balancing: "On the one hand... on the other hand... on balance..."
- Speculating: "It's hard to predict, but... / ...is likely to... / There's a good chance that..."
- Comparing past/present: "In the past... whereas nowadays... / Compared with a decade ago..."

9.7 Pronunciation Training Programme

From the course's pronunciation lessons (Parts 2/6), adapted into drills:

Individual sounds (L1 hotspots)

Target	Drill pairs (say, record, compare)	Rule
p / b	park–bark, paper–baby, cup–cub	P: puff of air (hold tissue — it should move)
th / s / t	think–sink, three–tree, mouth–mouse	TH: tongue between teeth, air flows
f / v	fan–van, safe–save	V vibrates (touch your throat)
e / i	bed–bid, ten–tin, men–mean	E is open; I is short and tight
silent letters	design, resign, sign, foreign, calm	The course's list: learn the 50 commonest silent-letter words

Word stress (the fastest intelligibility win)

- 2-syllable nouns/adjectives stress first (*TAble*, *HAPpy*); verbs often second (*rePEAT*, *deCIDE*).
- -tion/-sion/-ic stress the syllable before (*phoTOgraphy*, *ecoNomic*).
- Stress shifts meaning: *REcord* (noun) vs *reCORD* (verb); *PREsent* vs *preSENT*.
- Drill: mark stress on 20 new words weekly; mis-stressed words are the top cause of "cannot understand" moments.

Sentence stress & intonation

- Stress content words (nouns, verbs, adjectives), glide over grammar words: "I **WENT** to the **MARKet** to **BUY** some **FISH**."
- Rising intonation for lists and yes/no questions; falling for statements and wh-questions.
- Drill (shadowing): 10 min/day — play a 20-second native clip, speak along simultaneously, matching music before words.

TIP. Record a 1-minute Part 2 answer today and re-record the same card monthly. Pronunciation progress is invisible day-to-day and dramatic month-to-month — recordings prove it.

9.8 Band 5 vs Band 8 — Same Card, Annotated

Card: Describe a meal you enjoyed recently. You should say: where you had it, who you shared it with, what you ate — and explain why you enjoyed it.

Band 5 response (typical): "I enjoyed... a meal... last week. I go to restaurant with my friend. We eat... pizza and... chicken. It is very delicious. I like it very much. The restaurant is big and... good. I want go again."

Examiner notes: FC — frequent pauses, short phrases; LR — very limited (delicious, good, big), repetition; GRA — tense errors (go→went, eat→ate, want go→want to go), only simple sentences; P — generally intelligible but flat. Overall 5.0.

Band 8 response (same facts): "A meal that really stands out was last Friday, when an old school friend took me to a tiny Syrian restaurant downtown that I'd never noticed. We ordered a mixed grill to share — lamb kebabs, grilled chicken, mountains of flatbread — plus this incredible lentil soup to start. What made it special wasn't just the food, though that was superb; it was the whole atmosphere. The owner came over twice to check on us, the place smelled of charcoal and spices, and my friend and I ended up talking for three hours — we hadn't seen each other in two years. I suppose I enjoyed it because it combined everything I love: good company, authentic flavours, and that feeling of discovering a hidden gem in my own city." *Examiner notes:* FC — smooth, natural hesitation only; LR — stands out, tiny, mountains of, superb, hidden gem; GRA — past narrative + relative clauses + cleft (What made it...) + nominalisation; P — expressive stress/intonation. Overall 8.0.

Same facts, different language. Record the Band 5 version of every card first — then deliberately upgrade it, feature by feature, into the Band 8 version. That transformation IS your study programme.

9.9 Examiner's-Eye FAQ

Do examiners mark down accents? No — only intelligibility. A strong accent with clear sounds and correct stress scores 8+; a "native-like" mumble scores 5.

Is it OK to lie (invent stories)? Yes — examiners test language, not truth. But fluent lies need simple plots: adapt true stories rather than inventing complex ones mid-talk.

What if I dry up in Part 2? Use rescue phrases (*Another thing I remember is... / Looking back... / What I'll never forget is...*) and describe anything — the place, the people, your feelings. Silence hurts; imperfect speech doesn't.

Should I use idioms? Natural idioms (*hidden gem, recharge my batteries, the tip of the iceberg*) help LR — forced idioms (*raining cats and dogs* about exams) hurt. One or two per part, fitting the topic.

Does grammar self-correction lose marks? Occasional correction (*I went — I mean, I've been twice*) shows control and is neutral-to-positive. Constant restarting signals weak FC.

How is Part 2 timed? The examiner lets you speak 1–2 minutes, stops you at 2, and asks 1–2 rounding-off questions. Aim to still be talking (strongly) when stopped.

Can I ask the examiner questions? Clarification (*Could you repeat that?*) is fine. Conversation (*And you?*) is not — this is a test, not a chat.

9.10 Scoring Yourself (after every practice recording)

Criterion	Ask	Band 6 sounds like	Band 7 sounds like
FC	Did I keep going? Link ideas?	Pauses to find language; basic linkers (and, but, because, so)	Long smooth stretches; some less common linkers

Criterion	Ask	Band 6 sounds like	Band 7 sounds like
LR	Varied words? Right words? Paraphrase?	Enough for topics; repetition; errors in word choice	Less common items; collocations; successful paraphrase
GRA	Mix of sentences? Tenses right?	Simple + some complex; errors rarely block	Frequent error-free sentences; good complex range
P	Easy to follow? Stress right?	Generally clear; L1 accent; some mis-stress	Clear throughout; only rare lapses

Give 5.0–9.0 per criterion with one evidence note each. Your Speaking band = the average. Fix the lowest criterion first — always.

9.11 Full Part 1 Mock Interview — Annotated (Band 8)

E = examiner, C = candidate. Annotations in brackets.

E: Good morning. Can you tell me your full name, please? **C:** Good morning — I'm Rana Khalil. [Polite, clear, correct stress on surname.]

E: And where are you from, Rana? **C:** I'm from Amman, the capital of Jordan — I was born there and I've lived there all my life. [Present perfect for continuing state — tense control from the first answer.]

E: Do you work or are you a student? **C:** I'm actually doing both at the moment — I'm in my final year of pharmacy school, and I work part-time in a community pharmacy on weekends. It's exhausting but really useful. [Present continuous for temporary situation + concession.]

E: What do you like most about your studies? **C:** Probably the practical side — last semester we started lab work with real formulations, which made everything we'd memorised suddenly make sense. [Past narrative embedded; "probably" hedges naturally.]

E: Let's talk about food. Who usually cooks in your family? **C:** My mother, mostly — traditional Jordanian food, mansaf, maqluba, that kind of thing. I've recently started cooking myself, actually — simple stuff, pasta, salads — because I'll need to survive when I move abroad. [Tense range: present habits + present perfect + future purpose.]

E: Do you prefer eating at home or in restaurants? **C:** Home food, definitely — it's healthier and, honestly, it just tastes like... home. But I do enjoy restaurants for the social side — last week my friends and I tried a new Italian place and ended up talking for hours. [Opinion + concession + past anecdote in 3 sentences.]

E: Has your diet changed in recent years? **C:** Yes, quite a lot — I used to drink three coffees a day and skip breakfast, but since starting early hospital shifts I've switched to proper breakfasts and herbal tea. I feel much better for it. [Used to + since + present perfect + result — GRA showcase.]

E: Let's move on to travel. Do you like travelling? **C:** I love it — though I haven't travelled nearly as much as I'd like. So far I've only been around the Middle East — Turkey, Egypt, the Emirates — but my dream is Japan. [Present perfect + limitation + future dream.]

E: Where did you go on your last holiday? **C:** To Istanbul, last summer, with my sister. We spent five days just wandering — the Grand Bazaar, the Bosphorus ferry, all the clichés, but they deserve to be clichés! [Past simple narrative + humour + idiom ("clichés") used precisely.]

E: Would you like to live in another country in the future? **C:** Yes — that's actually the plan. I'm hoping to do my master's in the UK, then decide. I'm excited but nervous, if I'm honest — I've never lived away from my family. [Conditional hope + honest concession — authentic, not memorised.]

Overall: FC 8 (smooth, developed), LR 8 (mansaf/maqluba topic words, clichés, proper breakfasts), GRA 8 (present perfect/past/conditional all controlled), P 8 (clear, natural stress). Overall 8.0. Notice: every answer = direct + extend; no answer under 2 sentences or over 4; tenses always match the question.

9.12 The Speaking Band Descriptors (working paraphrase)

Band	Fluency & Coherence	Lexical Resource	Grammatical Range & Accuracy	Pronunciation
9	Fluent with only natural hesitation; fully coherent; topic development complete	Full flexibility and precision at all levels; idiomatic language natural	Full range of structures, always accurate	Effortless; L1 influence minimal; all features precise
8	Fluent with only occasional repetition/self-correction; coherent; wide connectives, well managed	Wide range, fluent and flexible; idiomatic items, rare slips	Wide range, flexibly used; majority of sentences error-free	Easy to understand; L1 influence has minimal effect; sustained facility
7	Some hesitation/repetition but keeps going; flexible connectives, some over/under-use	Sufficient range + some less common/idiomatic items; paraphrases effectively; occasional errors	Variety of structures; frequent error-free sentences; some errors persist	Generally clear; occasional lapses; all positive features present
6	Willing to speak at length but coherence sometimes lost; range of connectives but over/under-use	Wide enough for topics but lacks flexibility; paraphrases with mixed success; noticeable errors	Mix of simple/complex; errors rarely block; some complex sentences faulty	Generally intelligible; some mispronunciations but meaning rarely lost
5	Often cannot keep going; over-uses simple connectives; frequent breakdowns	Enough for familiar topics only; cannot paraphrase gaps; errors impede	Basic structures; errors frequent and sometimes impede	Often hard to follow; frequent mispronunciations; L1 strongly intrudes

TIP. Notice how Pronunciation Band 7 says "generally clear with occasional lapses" — perfection is NOT required. Clarity + word stress + sentence rhythm = Band 7 pronunciation for any accent.

Chapter 10: Speaking Bank — Cue Cards, Questions & Samples

10.1 How to Use This Bank

60+ cue cards, 100+ Part 1/3 questions, and 6 full sample talks. Protocol per card: 1-minute plan (Chapter 9.5) → record 2 minutes → transcribe your talk → upgrade 5 phrases → re-record. One card done properly beats ten skimmed.

10.2 Part 1 Topic Packs (12 topics × 5 questions + vocabulary)

1. Hometown: Where is your hometown? What do you like most about it? Has it changed much in recent years? Would you like to live there in the future? What is it famous for? *Vocabulary: bustling / laid-back, well-connected, cost of living, landmark, outskirts, densely populated.*

2. Home/Accommodation: Do you live in a house or a flat? Which room do you spend most time in? What would you change about your home? Do you plan to move? Who do you live with? *Vocabulary: spacious / cramped, on the outskirts, landlord, flatmate, cosy, do up (renovate).*

3. Work: What do you do? Do you enjoy your job? What are your main responsibilities? Would you like to change jobs? How do you get to work? *Vocabulary: commute, demanding / rewarding, deadline, colleague, promotion, work-life balance.*

4. Study: What are you studying? Why did you choose this subject? What do you like about your course? Are there things you'd change? What are your study plans? *Vocabulary: major in, assignment, lecture / seminar, campus, curriculum, graduate.*

5. Hobbies & free time: What do you do to relax? Have your hobbies changed since childhood? Do you prefer indoor or outdoor activities? Who do you spend free time with? Do you have enough free time? *Vocabulary: unwind, pastime, keen on, take up, time-consuming, recharge my batteries.*

6. Food & cooking: Who cooks in your family? Do you prefer home food or restaurants? Have your eating habits changed? Can you cook a traditional dish? Do you like trying new foods? *Vocabulary: homemade, balanced diet, recipe, ingredients, foodie, cut down on.*

7. Sport & health: Do you play any sports? How do you stay healthy? Did you do sport as a child? Is fitness important in your country? Would you like to try an extreme sport? *Vocabulary: work out, stamina, team spirit, sedentary, keep fit, adrenaline.*

8. Travel & holidays: Do you like travelling? Where did you last go? Do you prefer beaches or cities? Who do you usually travel with? Where would you love to visit? *Vocabulary: breathtaking, off the beaten track, itinerary, travel companion, jet lag, broaden horizons.*

9. Technology: How much time do you spend online? What apps do you use most? Has technology changed your life? Do you prefer phones or computers? Should children have smartphones? *Vocabulary: addicted to, go viral, user-friendly, glitch, scroll through, digital detox.*

10. Music & films: What kind of music do you like? Do you play an instrument? How often do you go to the cinema? Do you prefer films or series? Has your taste changed? *Vocabulary: catchy, blockbuster, soundtrack, binge-watch, live gig, thought-provoking.*

11. Friends & family: How often do you see your family? Do you prefer big or small gatherings? What do you do with friends? Have friendships changed with age? Are you a sociable person? *Vocabulary: close-knit, get-together, childhood friend, bond, catch up, circle of friends.*

12. Weather & seasons: What's the weather like today? Which season do you prefer? Does weather affect your mood? Is climate change noticeable in your country? Do you like rain? *Vocabulary: scorching / freezing, humid, downpour, mild, unpredictable, gloomy.*

EXAMPLE. Sample Part 1 answers (tense-matched, Chapter 9.4): "Has your hometown changed much?" → "Yes, enormously. When I was a child it was a quiet town, but over the last decade it has grown into a proper city — new malls, new roads everywhere. The downside is the traffic, which has become terrible." (Present perfect question → present perfect + past contrast.) "Would you like to try an extreme sport?" → "I'd love to try paragliding, actually. I'm not usually adventurous, but a friend did it last year and said the views were unbelievable. I'd need to overcome my fear of heights first, though!" (Conditional → conditional + past anecdote + concession.)

10.3 Part 2 Cue-Card Library (36 cards)

People: 1. A person who taught you something important. 2. A family member you admire. 3. A friend who is a good leader. 4. A famous person you'd like to meet. 5. A teacher who influenced you. 6. Someone who did something kind for you.

Places: 7. Your favourite hobby place (course card: *Describe your favourite hobby* — adapt: place where you do it). 8. A quiet place you like to visit. 9. A city you have visited and loved. 10. Your ideal home. 11. A crowded place you've been to. 12. A park or garden near you.

Objects: 13. A useful app on your phone. 14. A gift you gave someone. 15. Something you bought that made you happy. 16. A photo you like. 17. A book that influenced you. 18. A skill you'd like to learn (object-linked: camera, instrument).

Experiences: 19. A trip you remember well. 20. A difficult decision you made. 21. A time you helped someone. 22. A celebration you attended. 23. A time you were late. 24. Something you did with friends recently.

Media & ideas: 25. A film that impressed you. 26. A song that means a lot to you. 27. A news story that interested you. 28. An advertisement you remember. 29. A website you visit often. 30. A TV programme you enjoy.

Future & opinion: 31. A goal you want to achieve. 32. A job you'd like to do. 33. A country you'd like to work in. 34. A change you'd like to see in your city. 35. An invention that changed the world. 36. A tradition in your country.

Universal bullets template (works for any card): WHAT it is (identify + paraphrase) → WHEN/WHERE you encountered it (past narrative) → WHAT you do with it / WHY it matters (present + reasons) → EXPLAIN feeling/opinion/future (evaluation + forward look).

10.4 Six Full Sample Talks (Band 7–8 level)

Talk 1 — Person who taught you something (past-heavy): "I'd like to talk about my grandfather, who taught me carpentry when I was about ten. He'd been a carpenter all his life, and every summer I'd stay with him in his village. He started me on tiny tasks — sanding wood, holding nails — and by the end of that first summer I could make a simple stool, which I still have. What made him a great teacher was patience: he never touched my work to 'fix' it; he'd just ask, 'What do you think went wrong?' That question taught me more than woodwork — it taught me to solve problems instead of panicking. Looking back, those summers shaped my character. He passed away two years ago, and whenever I repair something in my flat, I feel connected to him. I'd say his real lesson was that making things with your hands gives a satisfaction no office job can match."

Talk 2 — Quiet place (descriptive): "My favourite quiet place is the old library in my city centre — a colonial-era building with high ceilings and wooden galleries. I discovered it during exam season last year when my flat was too noisy. Inside, there's a reading room with tall windows overlooking a courtyard garden; the rule is absolute

silence, and even the chairs seem designed not to creak. I go most Saturdays now. I usually read for an hour, then just sit and think — something I never do anywhere else. The contrast with the chaotic street outside is almost shocking: traffic and shouting on one side of the door, total calm on the other. It matters to me because it's the only place where my mind genuinely slows down. I hope the council never closes it — in a city that's constantly demolishing old buildings, that library feels like a small act of resistance."

Talk 3 — Useful app (present-heavy): "The app I'd choose is a flashcard app I use for vocabulary. I downloaded it about a year ago when I started preparing for IELTS. Basically, you create digital cards with a word on one side and its meaning, example, and pronunciation on the other, and the app schedules reviews using spaced repetition — words you find hard appear daily, easy ones monthly. I use it on the bus, in queues, whenever I have five spare minutes. What I like most is the statistics page: watching my 'mastered' count climb is weirdly motivating. It's genuinely changed my study habits — I used to cram word lists before bed and forget everything; now I retain far more with less effort. The only downside is that it's slightly addictive — I've caught myself reviewing cards at family dinners! I'd recommend it to any language learner."

Talk 4 — Difficult decision (narrative + reflection): "The hardest decision I've made was turning down a secure government job last year. I'd passed the exams, my parents were thrilled, and the salary was excellent. But the role was purely administrative, in a city I didn't want to live in, and accepting it meant abandoning my plan to study abroad. I spent two weeks making lists, calling friends, barely sleeping. In the end, I asked myself which choice I'd regret more at forty — and the answer was obvious. My parents were upset for months, though they've come round since I got my IELTS score. That decision taught me that 'safe' and 'right' aren't the same thing. It also made me more decisive generally — now when I face a choice, I use the same forty-year-old test. Sometimes I still wonder 'what if', but I don't regret it."

Talk 5 — Goal (future-heavy): "My main goal over the next two years is to complete a master's degree in Canada. I've wanted to study abroad since secondary school, partly for the education and partly to prove to myself I can build a life independently. The plan has three stages: first, achieve band 7.5 in IELTS — I'm sitting the test in three months; second, secure admission and a partial scholarship, which means strong essays and references; third, save enough for the first year's living costs, so I'm working weekends. The biggest obstacle is definitely money, but I've calculated that with part-time work in Canada, it's feasible. Achieving this matters because it would transform my career options back home — international graduates in my field earn roughly double. More than that, though, it's about becoming the person I want to be: self-reliant, open-minded, and genuinely fluent in English."

Talk 6 — Tradition (culture + opinion): "I'd like to describe Eid al-Fitr in my country — the festival marking the end of Ramadan. For thirty days, Muslims fast from dawn to sunset, so Eid morning carries this incredible feeling of earned celebration. The day starts with a special prayer at the mosque, shoulder to shoulder with thousands of people, and then families gather for a huge breakfast — sweet dishes especially, after a month without daytime food. Children receive money in decorated envelopes, neighbours exchange plates of food, and the atmosphere is genuinely joyful. What I love most is how it repairs relationships: people visit relatives they haven't spoken to all year, and old quarrels are set aside. Some complain it's becoming commercialised — malls now run 'Eid sales' like Christmas. That's true, but the core remains: gratitude, generosity, and community. I hope we preserve that spirit even as celebrations modernise."

10.5 Part 3 Question Sets (with OREC planning notes)

Set A — Cities (follows hometown/place cards): Why are more people moving to cities? What problems does urbanisation cause? Should governments limit city growth? How will cities change in the next 20 years? *OREC notes: opinion (inevitable but manageable) → reasons (jobs, services) → example (your city's growth) → concession (rural decline; remote work may reverse).*

Set B — Work (follows job/goal cards): Is job satisfaction more important than salary? Should working hours be reduced? (See the course's automation essay — Chapter 13.) How has technology changed workplaces? Will

AI cause mass unemployment? *OREC notes: balanced view → automation evidence → four-day-week example → wage-protection concession.*

Set C — Environment (follows nature/place cards): Who is mainly responsible for pollution — individuals or governments? Are young people more eco-aware? Do small actions (recycling, repair) matter? Should polluting be taxed more? *OREC notes: shared responsibility → right-to-repair example (Chapter 8!) → systemic-change concession.*

Set D — Technology (follows app/media cards): Has social media improved communication? Should children's screen time be limited? What are the dangers of AI? Will physical books disappear? *OREC notes: nuanced (connection vs attention) → personal example → regulation concession.*

Set E — Culture (follows tradition/festival cards): Why should traditions be preserved? Is globalisation destroying local cultures? Should museums be free? How can tourism harm heritage? *OREC notes: identity value → Eid/commercialisation example → living-culture concession (traditions evolve).*

10.6 Twenty-Four More Cue Cards (37–60)

People: 37. A person you rely on. 38. Someone good at their job. 39. A child you know well. 40. A person who dresses well.

Places: 41. A restaurant you like. 42. A place with lots of water (beach/lake/river). 43. A historical building. 44. Somewhere you go to think.

Objects: 45. A machine you use daily. 46. Something you made yourself. 47. An object that connects you to the past. 48. Something you want to buy.

Experiences: 49. A journey with a delay. 50. A time you learned from a mistake. 51. A surprise party or event. 52. A day you spent without your phone.

Media: 53. A podcast or radio show. 54. A photo that lies (misleading image). 55. A game you enjoy. 56. A speech that moved you.

Abstract: 57. A rule you disagree with. 58. A risk worth taking. 59. A problem you solved creatively. 60. A future event you're preparing for.

10.7 Three More Sample Talks (Band 8)

Talk 7 — A machine you use daily (object + habit): "I'd like to talk about my electric kettle — which sounds ridiculous, but I genuinely use it ten times a day. I'm British-educated in my tea habits: the day starts with builders' tea, strong with milk, and ends with herbal tea. The kettle itself is nothing special — stainless steel, one button — but it structures my whole routine: kettle on means a break is coming; colleagues gather; problems get discussed. During exam season it worked overtime — my flatmate and I measured revision sessions in 'kettles'. I suppose it represents something about my culture: we solve crises with hot drinks. If it broke, I'd replace it within hours — possibly before food. It reminds me that the most important objects aren't impressive; they're the invisible ones holding your day together."

Talk 8 — A time you learned from a mistake (narrative + lesson): "Two years ago I missed a flight to Istanbul — a mistake that cost me £300 and taught me more than the trip would have. I'd saved the wrong terminal screenshot, arrived relaxed with forty minutes to spare, and discovered my gate was in another building connected by a train I'd never heard of. I sprinted, pleaded, and watched the plane push back. Stranded overnight, I rebooked, slept on a bench, and finally arrived a day late for my friend's wedding rehearsal — mortified. The lesson stuck permanently: I now screenshot everything twice, arrive absurdly early, and keep offline maps. More deeply, it cured my casual optimism — I plan for things to go wrong. Ironically, I'm now the friend everyone trusts with logistics. Expensive tuition, but worth every penny."

Talk 9 — A risk worth taking (opinion + story): "The biggest risk I've taken was quitting a stable job to prepare for studying abroad — which is actually why I'm taking IELTS. I had a decent salary, a clear promotion path, and parents who thought I was insane. The risk was real: eighteen months without income, no guarantee of a visa, and the embarrassment of crawling back if it failed. But staying felt riskier in a different way — waking up at fifty in a life I'd settled for. So I saved for a year, resigned politely, and enrolled in English courses. Fourteen months later: my English has transformed, I've been accepted conditionally by two universities, and — unexpectedly — my old employer offered me freelance work. I'd advise anyone facing a similar choice to distinguish real risks from comfortable fears. Most 'safe' options just hide their costs better."

10.8 Thirty Rapid Part 3 Questions (1-minute answers)

Environment: 1. Should flying be taxed more? 2. Can individuals fight climate change? 3. Are electric cars the answer? Work: 4. Will AI take most jobs? 5. Is retirement outdated? 6. Should salaries be public? Education: 7. Are exams fair? 8. Should university be free? 9. Is homework useful? Technology: 10. Does social media harm teens? 11. Should AI art be copyrighted? 12. Will phones replace computers? Health: 13. Should junk food be banned in schools? 14. Is healthcare a right? 15. Do we overuse medicine? Society: 16. Are cities too big? 17. Is the generation gap growing? 18. Should voting be compulsory? Culture: 19. Is English killing other languages? 20. Should museums be free? 21. Is tourism net-positive? Money: 22. Does money buy happiness? 23. Should billionaires exist? 24. Is cash dying? Future: 25. Will we colonise Mars? 26. Will English stay dominant? 27. Will humans live to 120? Values: 28. Is honesty always best? 29. Does fame corrupt? 30. Are young people lazier?

Protocol: pick 5 daily; 20 seconds planning (OREC); 60 seconds speaking; record; score one criterion.

10.9 Part 1 Model Answers — All 12 Topics (Band 7–8)

Hometown: "I'm from Izmir, on Turkey's Aegean coast — Turkey's third city, famous for its waterfront promenade called the Kordon. What I love most is the lifestyle: it's relaxed compared to Istanbul, but still big enough for good universities and nightlife." / "It has changed enormously — when I was small it felt like a big town, but endless new apartment blocks have doubled its size. Unfortunately the traffic has become a nightmare."

Home: "I live in a two-bedroom flat near the university with my sister. It's nothing fancy, but it's sunny and quiet, which matters more to me than space." / "The room I use most is definitely the kitchen — not just for cooking, but because it's where everyone gathers. My sister and I solve most of our problems over tea there."

Work: "I work as a junior accountant at a logistics firm — mainly invoicing and monthly reports. It's not glamorous, but the team is great and I'm learning a lot." / "I commute by metro, about forty minutes door to door. I actually enjoy it — that's when I do my English listening practice."

Study: "I'm majoring in nursing — I'm in my second year. I chose it because I want a career that genuinely helps people, and the job security doesn't hurt either." / "The best thing about my course is the practical placements — last semester I spent six weeks in a real hospital ward, which taught me more than any lecture."

Hobbies: "My main hobby is photography — street photography, mostly. I go out most weekends with my camera, and I've recently joined a club that exhibits twice a year." / "To unwind on weekdays I just read — usually novels before bed. An hour with a book clears my head better than anything else."

Food: "My mother does most of the cooking — classic home food, stews and rice dishes. I can manage a few basics myself, but nothing I'd serve to guests!" / "I've definitely started eating more healthily — I used to live on fast food, but since starting gym I've cut right down and cook most evenings."

Sport: "I swim twice a week — it's the only exercise I've ever stuck with. I find running boring, but swimming is almost meditative." / "As a kid I played football every day after school, but I stopped at university. I actually miss the team spirit more than the sport itself."

Travel: "My last trip was to Cappadocia — the landscape is unreal, like another planet, especially at sunrise when the balloons go up." / "I usually travel with one close friend — we've learned we have the same pace, which I think is the secret to a good trip. Big groups always end in arguments!"

Technology: "Honestly, probably too much — four or five hours a day. Mostly messaging and news, plus English practice apps, which is my excuse!" / "I think children shouldn't have unrestricted smartphones — the content is too much. Limited, supervised access for learning seems the sensible middle ground."

Music/films: "I listen to pretty much everything, but mostly indie rock and Turkish folk — my father played folk constantly, so it's nostalgic for me." / "I rarely go to the cinema now — with streaming, I watch series instead. I just finished a brilliant crime drama I basically binge-watched in a week."

Friends/family: "I'm very close to my family — we have dinner together every Friday, no exceptions. With cousins and grandparents it's often fifteen people!" / "I prefer small gatherings — three or four friends, good food, real conversation. Big parties exhaust me; I always end up hiding in the kitchen."

Weather: "Today it's boiling — typical August, about 35 degrees. I don't mind heat, but the humidity this week has been brutal." / "My favourite season is autumn — the light is beautiful, it's cool enough to walk everywhere, and the city feels alive again after summer."

Study method: cover the answers, respond to each question aloud, then compare — steal one phrase per answer (famous for, cut right down, the secret to, middle ground, binge-watched) into your active vocabulary.

10.10 Pronunciation Word Lists (course-based + expanded)

Silent letters (50): design, resign, resignAtion (note: g sounded!), sign, signature (g sounded!), foreign, reign, daughter, light, night, comb, thumb, lamb, calm, talk, walk, half, castle, listen, fasten, often (t silent in BrE), island, answer, write, wrong, knife, knee, knock, psychology, honest, hour, heir, rhyme, gnome, mnemonic, debt, doubt, subtle, receipt, cupboard, BlackBerry (informal: *sandwich* → "san-widge"), Wednesday (*Wenzday*), February (*Feb-yoo-ary*), vegetable (*veg-tuh-bul*), comfortable (*comf-tuh-bul*), interesting (*in-trest-ing*), chocolate (*choc-lit*).

Stress pairs (noun ↔ verb): REcord/reCORD, PREsent/preSENT, IMport/imPORT, EXport/exPORT, CONduct/conDUCT, PROduce/proDUCE, OBject/obJECT, SUBject/subJECT, INcrease/inCREASE, DEcrease/deCREASE.

Minimal pairs (L1 drills): p/b: park/bark, cup/cub, rapid/rabid; th/s: think/sink, thick/sick, mouth/mouse; f/v: fan/van, safe/save, leaf/leave; e/i: bed/bid, pen/pin, ten/tin; w/v: west/vest, wine/vine (for German/Slavic speakers); h-dropping: heat/eat, hill/ill (never drop H in English!).

TIP. Practise these lists aloud for 5 minutes before every Speaking session. The course's core message stands: pronunciation is about being *understood with ease* — small, targeted fixes beat accent imitation.

Chapter 11: Writing — How You Are Scored & How to Build Sentences

11.1 The Two Tasks and Their Weight

You write two tasks in 60 minutes. Task 2 counts **twice as much** as Task 1 — budget your time accordingly:

Task	Words (minimum)	Target length	Time	Weight
Task 1: report (Academic) or letter (GT)	150+	160–190	20 minutes (3 plan + 15 write + 2 check)	1/3
Task 2: essay (both modules)	250+	260–290	40 minutes (5 plan + 32 write + 3 check)	2/3

TIP. Video Parts 8–12 teach Writing through the scoring criteria first: the course opens the module with IDP's *How you'll be scored* wheel (four criteria × 25%) for Task 1 (Task Achievement) and Task 2 (Task Response). Internalise the criteria before memorising any template — examiners score criteria, not templates.

11.2 The Four Criteria (25% Each)

Task Achievement (T1) / Task Response (T2)

- **T1:** cover all key features with an overview; no irrelevant detail; no opinion. Under-length (<150 words) caps this criterion at Band 5.
- **T2:** answer every part of the question with a clear position sustained throughout; develop each main idea; under-length (<250 words) caps at Band 5.
- Missing the question (e.g., describing only one of two charts; agreeing without addressing "to what extent") caps T2 at Band 5–6 whatever your English level.

Coherence and Cohesion (CC)

- **Coherence:** logical organisation — Task 1: introduction → overview → details (grouped); Task 2: introduction → body 1 → body 2 (+3) → conclusion. One clear central idea per paragraph.
- **Cohesion:** linking within and between sentences: reference (*this, these, such, it*), substitution, ellipsis, and cohesive devices (linkers). Band 7: "logically organises information; clear progression; range of cohesive devices with occasional misuse." Band 5–6: mechanical overuse (*Firstly... Secondly... Thirdly... In conclusion* in every essay) or faulty links.
- Paragraphing is scored: 4–5 paragraphs for Task 2; 3–4 for Task 1. One-block essays cannot pass Band 5 for CC.

Lexical Resource (LR)

- **Range:** topic vocabulary, collocations, less common items (*a dramatic surge, to hold the view, stringent regulations*), and precise word choice.
- **Accuracy:** spelling + word formation (*economy/economic/economical/economist*). Occasional slips are fine at Band 7; systematic errors cap Band 6.
- **The course's LR rules (Part 11):** never copy question words — use synonyms (*famous = prominent = renowned; obstacles = hurdles*); prefer less common vocabulary where natural; avoid spelling mistakes by using only words you can spell.

- Memorised phrases ("*a double-edged sword*", "*every coin has two sides*") impress no one and can be flagged as memorised — use natural academic collocations instead.

Grammatical Range and Accuracy (GRA)

- **Range:** the course's formula (Part 11): simple + compound + complex sentences, deliberately mixed. Complex = subordination (although, because, which, where, if, when, while).
- **Accuracy:** Band 7 = "frequent error-free sentences"; Band 6 = errors rarely impede; Band 5 = errors may impede.
- Punctuation is grammar: commas in complex sentences, full stops (no comma splices), apostrophes in GT informal letters only (never in Academic/contractions in essays — see 11.4).

11.3 Sentence Variety — The Course's Grammar Engine (Part 11)

The three sentence types (with the course's own examples, corrected and expanded)

1. Simple sentence = Subject + Verb (+ Object/Complement). *Dania studied hard. Dania got a high band score.* — Clear but basic; use for impact and clarity, never for whole essays.

2. Compound sentence = simple + comma + FANBOYS linker (for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so) + simple. *Dania studied hard, so she got a high band score. / The internet is useful, but it has some drawbacks.* — Shows coordination; one or two per paragraph maximum.

3. Complex sentence = subordinate clause + main clause (either order). *If you study hard, you will succeed. / Although John studied hard, he did not get a good score. / In spite of studying hard, John did not get a good score.* — The engine of Band 7+: subordinate with *although, because, since, as, while, whereas, which, who, where, if, when, after, before*.

Punctuation rules that examiners check:

Pattern	Example	Rule
Linker mid-sentence (FANBOYS)	<i>..., so she... / ..., but it...</i>	Comma before the linker
Subordinate clause first	<i>Although John studied hard, he...</i>	Comma after the clause
Main clause first	<i>He failed although he studied hard.</i>	No comma (usually)
Sentence linker (However, Therefore)	<i>John studied hard. However, he...</i>	Full stop + capital + comma
Semicolon upgrade	<i>John studied hard; however, he...</i>	Semicolon before However/Therefore (formal, Band 7+ signal)
Despite / In spite of	<i>Despite studying hard, John... / ...in spite of hard work.</i>	+ noun or + verb-ing (NEVER + clause: not "despite he studied")

The concession family (Part 11's core lesson — master all six frames)

- 1** *Although / Though / Even though + clause:* "Although automation boosts output, it threatens routine jobs."
- 2** *However + clause (new sentence):* "...routine jobs. However, new roles emerge."
- 3** *Despite / In spite of + noun/-ing:* "Despite higher output, employment fell."
- 4** *While / Whereas + clause (contrast):* "While output rose, wages stagnated."
- 5** *Admittedly..., but...:* "Admittedly, cameras deter crime, but they erode privacy."
- 6** *Noun-phrase concession:* "Heavy investment notwithstanding, rural coverage remains poor." (Band 8+ flavour)

The reason/result family

- Reason: *because, since, as, owing to + noun, due to + noun, out of + noun, in order to + verb.*
- Result: *so, therefore, consequently, as a result, thus, hence, which means that..., leading to + noun.*
- Purpose: *to, in order to, so as to, so that + clause, with the aim of + -ing.*

EXAMPLE. Upgrade drill (do 5 daily): Simple pair → one complex sentence. "Automation reduces manual labour. Working hours should be reduced." → "Since automation has reduced the need for manual labour, working hours should arguably be reduced." / "Because automation has reduced..., governments should consider..." / "Automation having reduced..., ..." (participle — Band 8).

11.4 Formal Academic Style (Task 2 + Academic T1)

- 1 **No contractions:** write *do not, cannot, it is* (contractions cap LR/GRA formality judgments).
- 2 **No spoken fillers:** never *well, you know, kind of, lots of, a lot of* (use *many, much, a number of, a great deal of*), *thing* (name it), *get* (use *obtain, receive, become* precisely).
- 3 **No absolutes without hedging:** replace *always/never/proves* with *tends to, is likely to, suggests, indicates, may, can*. Academic writing hedges; only hedge-free claims need 100% proof.
- 4 **Impersonal stance:** prefer *It is argued that... / This essay will... / Such policies...* over *I think* (one *In my opinion* in intro + conclusion is enough; avoid *In my humble opinion* and *myself*).
- 5 **Nominalisation (Band 7+ signal):** verbs → nouns: *pollute* → *pollution*; *develop* → *development*; "*Because cities grow fast, housing fails*" → "*Rapid urban growth outpaces housing supply.*"
- 6 **Articles and number:** *the internet, the environment, the government* (specific systems); *people* (plural, no article) vs *the people of...*; *research* (uncountable — never "researches").

WARNING. GT letters follow different rules: informal letters to friends SHOULD use contractions and friendly tone; formal letters to managers must not. Chapter 12 gives the three tones with models.

11.5 Cohesion Toolbelt (60 devices, grouped by function)

Adding: *also, in addition, additionally, furthermore, moreover, as well as, not only... but also...* **Contrasting:** *but, however, nevertheless, nonetheless, although, though, even though, despite, in spite of, whereas, while, on the one hand... on the other hand..., in contrast, conversely, on the contrary.* **Cause/reason:** *because, since, as, owing to, due to, because of, on account of, given that...* **Result:** *so, therefore, thus, hence, consequently, as a result, accordingly, for this reason...* **Sequencing:** *firstly, secondly, finally, subsequently, previously, beforehand, afterwards, meanwhile...* **Exemplifying:** *for example, for instance, such as, including, namely, to illustrate, a case in point is...* **Restating:** *in other words, that is to say, i.e., namely...* **Concluding:** *in conclusion, to conclude, overall, all in all, on balance, taking everything into account...* **Conceding:** *admittedly, granted, while it is true that..., despite...* **Referencing (the invisible cohesion):** *this/that/these/those + noun* ("this trend", "such policies"), *the former/the latter, respectively, the above.*

TIP. Band 7 uses these *appropriately*; Band 5–6 overuses a few mechanically. Rule: never the same sentence-linker twice in one paragraph; vary reference + linker + lexical chains (repeat key nouns with synonyms) across the essay.

11.6 The Writing Process (every task, every time)

Stage	Task 1 (20 min)	Task 2 (40 min)
Analyse (T2: 2 min)	Identify visual type, units, time frame, categories (1 min)	Underline topic words + instruction words; decide position (2 min)
Plan	Select 2–3 key features for overview; group details (2 min)	2–3 body ideas with one example each; intro paraphrase + thesis (3 min)
Write	Introduction (paraphrase) → overview → detail paragraphs (14 min)	Intro → body → conclusion (30 min)
Check	Figures, tenses, overview present?, 150+ words (3 min)	Position clear? All parts answered? Errors? 250+ words (5 min)

Checking checklist (lamine this): word count ✓ | every sentence has a verb ✓ | subject–verb agreement ✓ | articles (a/the/–) ✓ | plural -s ✓ | past vs present tense ✓ | commas in complex sentences ✓ | no contractions (Academic) ✓ | no copied question chunks ✓ | paragraphs: 3–4 (T1) / 4–5 (T2) ✓.

11.7 Punctuation Masterclass (the 8 rules examiners check)

- Every sentence ends with ONE terminal mark** (. ? !). Comma splices (*Pollution is bad, it kills fish.*) are among the most-penalised errors: split, or join with *and/but/so/because*.
- Commas in complex sentences:** subordinate-first → comma (*Although cities grow, housing lags.*); main-first → no comma (*Housing lags although cities grow.*).
- Commas with linkers:** sentence-initial linkers take a comma (*However, ... / Furthermore, ... / In contrast, ...*). Mid-sentence FANBOYS take a preceding comma (*..., but ...*).
- Apostrophes:** possession (*the city's growth; students' needs*) and omission (informal letters only: *don't*). NEVER for plurals (*photo's* ✗).
- Colons introduce lists/explanations** (*Three factors matter: cost, speed, and safety.*); **semicolons join related clauses** (*Cities grow; services lag.*) and precede *however/therefore* formally (*...grow; however, services...*).
- Quotation vs emphasis:** never "scare quotes" for emphasis (*"good" schools* ✗); italics/words instead.
- Numbers:** spell out small round numbers in essays (*three factors, half the population*); figures for data (*42%, 3.2 million, 1998*); never start a sentence with a figure (*1998 saw...* is fine in T1 — it does start with a year, legitimately).
- Paragraphing:** blank line between paragraphs (or indent) — every time, consistently. One-block text caps CC at 5.

11.8 Error-Correction Workout (20 sentences — find and fix; key below)

- Despite pollution is bad, many people drive cars.
- The number of cars have increased.
- Peoples need more parks.
- In 1990, there was less cars than now.
- This essay will discuss about pollution.
- Pollution is a big problem, it affects health.
- If governments will invest, air improves.
- She suggested to build more parks.
- The chart shows the informations clearly.
- He is working in London since 2020.
- More and more people is moving to cities.
- I think pollution it is dangerous.
- There are many kind of transport.
- The government should to act now.
- Although it rained, but we went out.
- Researches show phones harm sleep.
- She has 25 years old.
- In conclusion, I will say pollution bad.
- The price raised quickly in March.
- Neither policy are effective.

Key: 1 *Despite* + noun/-ing → *Although pollution is bad / Despite pollution*. 2 *has increased* (the number = singular). 3 *People*. 4 *fewer cars* (countable). 5 *discuss pollution* (no about). 6 comma splice → full stop + *It*. 7 first conditional → *If governments invest*. 8 *suggested building*. 9 *information* (uncountable). 10 *has been working*.

/ has worked (since → perfect). 11 are moving. 12 double subject → it is once. 13 many kinds. 14 should act (no to). 15 Although... , we (no but). 16 Research shows. 17 She is 25 (years old). 18 vague → ...pollution requires urgent action. 19 rose (raise = transitive). 20 is effective (neither = singular).

Score: 16+/20 = Band 7 grammar control; below 12 = drill Chapter 14.1 rules 1–12 before writing more essays.

11.9 From Band 5 to Band 7 — What Actually Changes

Feature	Band 5 essay	Band 6 essay	Band 7 essay
Position	Unclear or shifting	Generally clear	Clear throughout, well developed
Ideas	Few, undeveloped, repetitive	Some development, occasional irrelevance	Extended, supported, relevant
Organisation	Inadequate paragraphing	Generally coherent, some mechanical linking	Logical, well paragraphed, flexible cohesion
Vocabulary	Limited, errors impede	Adequate, some less common, errors don't impede	Sufficient range, collocations, rare slips
Grammar	Frequent errors, simple sentences dominate	Mix with errors, meaning mostly clear	Frequent error-free sentences, good complex range
Biggest single upgrade	Answer the question + paragraph properly	Add complex sentences + real examples	Vary cohesion + precise vocabulary + cut errors by half

TIP. Most candidates plateau at 6.0–6.5 because they write NEW essays instead of REWRITING old ones. The protocol that breaks plateaus: write → self-mark vs criteria → rewrite the same essay to Band 7+ → compare versions line by line. Chapters 12–13 give you models to rewrite toward.

11.10 The Band Descriptors — What Examiners Actually Read

Below is a faithful working paraphrase of the public IELTS Writing band descriptors (Task 2 shown; Task 1 differs only in the first criterion). Memorise the Band 7 row — it is your specification.

Band	Task Response	Coherence & Cohesion	Lexical Resource	Grammatical Range & Accuracy
9	Fully addresses all parts; fully developed, well-supported ideas; clear position throughout	Cohesion used so naturally it attracts no attention; flawless paragraphing	Full flexibility and precision; natural, sophisticated control; only the rarest slips	Full range of structures with complete flexibility; error-free (only the rarest slips)
8	Sufficiently addresses all parts; well-developed ideas; clear position	Logical sequencing; wide range of cohesion, only rare misuse; skilful paragraphing	Wide range used fluently and flexibly; skilful style/collocation; rare errors	Wide range of structures; majority of sentences error-free; only very occasional slips

Band	Task Response	Coherence & Cohesion	Lexical Resource	Grammatical Range & Accuracy
7	Addresses all parts; clear position throughout; main ideas extended and supported (some over-generalising)	Logical organisation; clear progression; range of cohesive devices with some misuse; clear paragraphs	Sufficient range with some less common items; awareness of style/collocation; occasional errors	Variety of complex structures; frequent error-free sentences; good control despite some errors
6	Addresses all parts (some incompletely); position generally clear; some ideas inadequately developed	Generally coherent; some faulty/mechanical cohesion; paragraphing generally logical	Adequate range; some less common items but frequent errors in choice/spelling/formation	Mix of simple and complex; errors rarely impede; some faulty complex sentences
5	Only partially addresses the question; position unclear; ideas limited and poorly supported	Inadequate or illogical organisation; limited cohesion, often faulty; poor paragraphing	Limited range; errors in spelling/formation impede meaning at times	Limited range; frequent errors; simple sentences dominate; errors may impede

How to use this table: after writing, grade yourself 5–9 per column with one evidence note each. Your Task band = the average of the four. The fastest gains always come from the LOWEST column, not the highest.

Chapter 12: Writing Task 1 — Reports & Letters

12.1 Academic Task 1 Essentials

Summarise visual information (graph, table, bar/pie chart, process/cycle, map) in **150+ words (aim 160–180) within 20 minutes**. It is **1/3 of your Writing band**. You write a **report**: objective description + overview. No opinions, no reasons, no explanations from general knowledge.

The 4-paragraph structure (memorise):

- 1 Introduction (1–2 sentences):** paraphrase the question (*The line graph shows... → The line graph compares/illustrates...*). Never copy the rubric.
- 2 Overview (2–3 sentences):** the 2–3 most striking features/trends — NO figures here (or minimal). No overview = Task Achievement capped at Band 5.
- 3 Detail paragraph 1:** first group of data with figures (comparisons, highs/lows).
- 4 Detail paragraph 2:** second group with figures.

TIP. Video Parts 8–9 teach exactly this: Academic T1 = minimum 150 words, average 160–180, one-third of the mark, a report describing a visual in 20 minutes — scored by the four 25% criteria with Task Achievement first.

12.2 The Overview — The Most Important Paragraph

The overview answers: *If I could only tell the reader THREE things, what would they be?* For trend visuals: overall direction + highest/lowest + notable exception. For comparisons: ranking + biggest gap + similarity. For processes: number of stages + start/end points. For maps: biggest changes + overall development.

Overview formulae (adapt, don't memorise rigidly):

- Overall, while A rose steadily throughout the period, B fell sharply before stabilising. C remained by far the highest...*
- In general, X dominated... whereas Y accounted for the smallest share. The most striking change was...*
- Overall, the process consists of N stages, beginning with... and ending with...*
- Overall, the area underwent major development, with the most noticeable changes being...*

EXAMPLE. Overview drill: for 10 visuals, write ONLY introductions + overviews (5 min each). Show them to a partner: can they sketch the visual's shape from your overview alone? If yes, it works.

12.3 The Three Essential Sentences (Video Part 9)

The course's signature Task 1 grammar lesson. Every trend can be expressed three ways — **rotate all three** to demonstrate GRA range:

#	Pattern	Example
1	There + be + adjective + noun + in + noun	<i>There was a gradual rise in the number of arrests in 1952.</i>
2	Noun + verb + adverb	<i>The number of arrests rose gradually.</i>
3	Time + saw/experienced/witnessed + adjective + noun + in + noun	<i>1952 saw a gradual rise in the number of arrests.</i>

WARNING. Pattern 3 has NO preposition before the time word: 1952 saw... — never "In 1952 saw...". This single rule fixes one of the commonest Task 1 errors.

The noun ↔ verb ↔ adjective triangle (use all three forms across your report):

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
a rise / an increase	rise / increase	rising / increased	—
a fall / a drop / a decline	fall / drop / decline	falling	sharply
a fluctuation	fluctuate	fluctuating	wildly
a peak	peak / reach a peak	—	—
stability	stabilise / remain stable	stable / steady	steadily
a surge / a boom	surge / soar / rocket	dramatic	dramatically

12.4 The 12 Trend Phrases (Video Parts 9/11) + Full Toolkit

The course's annotated graph teaches these moves — learn them with the grammar each needs:

- 1 *rose/increased steadily* (verb + adverb)
- 2 *rose/increased dramatically* (verb + adverb)
- 3 *rose/increased gradually* (verb + adverb)
- 4 *plunged to + figure* (verb + preposition)
- 5 *peaked at / reached a high of + figure* (verb + preposition)
- 6 *stood at + figure* (for starting/level points)
- 7 *fluctuated* (often + *around/between... and...*)
- 8 *fell/dropped dramatically/sharply* (verb + adverb)
- 9 *reached a trough of / hit a low of + figure*
- 10 *remained constant/unchanged/stable at + figure*
- 11 *levelled off / evened out at + figure*
- 12 *hit a low of + figure*

Preposition precision (examiners check these): *rise TO 50* (endpoint) / *rise BY 20* (change) / *rise FROM 20 TO 50* (range) / *rise OF 20* (amount, noun form: *a rise of 20*) / *stand AT 55* / *peak AT* / *fluctuate BETWEEN X AND Y* / *AROUND X* / *account FOR 30%* / *represent/make up/constitute + share*.

Comparisons: *higher than, twice as high as, by far the highest, the second-highest, marginally above, significantly below, in contrast to, compared with, while/whereas, similarly, likewise, outnumbered, overtook, accounted for the largest share.*

Approximation (figures are read from visuals — hedge!): *approximately, roughly, around, about, just over/under, nearly, almost, in the region of.*

12.5 FULL WORKED REPORT — Arrests Graph (Video Part 11)

Task: *The line graph shows the number of arrests per year for using illegal drugs from 1991 to 2004. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features.*

Model report (178 words, Band 8–9):

The line graph compares yearly arrests for illegal drug use between 1991 and 2004.

Overall, arrests fluctuated markedly over the period, with two dramatic peaks around 2000–2001 separated by sharp falls. Despite ending the period at a low, stable level, arrests in the late 1990s were generally higher than in the early 1990s.

To begin with, the number of people arrested for handling drugs illegally stood at approximately 55 in 1991. After two years, the figure dropped dramatically to reach 20 in 1993. It then increased gradually from 20 in 1993 to about 25 in 1995, before rising significantly to reach 50 in 1996. Between 1996 and 1999, arrests fluctuated around 40–50 without any clear trend.

From 1999, numbers surged to a peak of just over 60 in 2000, but then plunged to a trough of roughly 15 in 2001 — the lowest point in the entire period. Thereafter, arrests remained broadly unchanged at around 15 until 2003, when they edged up slightly to level off at 20 in 2004.

Why it scores (annotate your own reports like this):

- **TA:** introduction paraphrased (*yearly arrests for illegal drug use*); overview = 3 features (fluctuation + two peaks + early/late contrast); all key data selected; 178 words.
- **CC:** 4 paragraphs; overview separated; chronological grouping; linkers (*to begin with, then, before, between, from, but, thereafter, when*); reference (*the figure, it, thereafter*).
- **LR:** stood at, dropped dramatically, increased gradually, fluctuated, surged, plunged, trough, remained unchanged, edged up, levelled off; approximation (approximately, about, just over, roughly, around).
- **GRA:** all three essential patterns (*There was...* implied; *numbers surged*; *1999...* time-fronted clauses); subordination (*before rising, when they edged up, which...*); passives avoided correctly (active trends).

12.6 Comparisons: Tables, Bars, Pies (static visuals)

No time trend → organise by **ranking**, not by table order:

- 1 Introduction (paraphrase + categories/units).
- 2 Overview: highest/lowest + most striking contrast/gap.
- 3 Details A: top group (2–3 items with figures).
- 4 Details B: bottom group + any exception.

Static toolkit: *ranked first/last; dominated by; accounted for X%, double/triple/half the figure for; compared with only X for; by contrast; similarly; the gap between X and Y was striking (60% vs 5%); while X led in..., Y...*

EXAMPLE. Mini-model (bar chart, urban green space per capita: Vienna 120m², Singapore 66m², Cairo 3m², Mumbai 2m²): "Overall, provision varied enormously: Vienna offered by far the most green space per resident, while Cairo and Mumbai provided negligible amounts. Vienna's 120 square metres per person was almost double Singapore's 66 and roughly forty times Cairo's mere 3. At the bottom of the ranking, Mumbai's 2 square metres was the lowest figure shown, marginally below Cairo." (Overview = variation + top/bottom; details = grouped top vs bottom with multiples — multiples are Band 7+ comparison language.)

12.7 Processes & Cycles

- Introduction: *The diagram illustrates the stages in... / how... is produced.*
- Overview: number of stages + start/end (...comprises eight stages, from... to...) or cyclical nature (...is a cyclical process with no fixed starting point).
- Details: stages in order with sequence linkers (*initially, next, subsequently, following this, once..., after being..., finally*).
- Grammar: **passive voice** for manufactured processes (*The beans are harvested... They are then dried...*); active for natural cycles (*Salmon swim upstream...*).

- Every stage needs its verb: harvesting → drying → roasting → grinding → packaging.

12.8 Maps

- Introduction + overview (biggest change + overall trend: urbanisation, modernisation, expansion).
- Details grouped by **location** (north/south; centre/periphery) or **time** (1990 vs 2020, feature by feature).
- Language of change: *was demolished/converted/replaced/expanded to make way for; was built/constructed/developed; remained unchanged; underwent (major/minor) changes; to the north of; adjacent to; in the south-west corner.*
- Tense: past simple for completed change (*The farm was replaced by...*); present perfect/passive for present state (*The area is now dominated by...*).

12.9 GT Task 1 — Letters (Video Part 12)

Same scoring, different genre: **write a letter of 150+ words in 20 minutes** for the purpose given. Three tones — matching tone to reader is Task Achievement:

Tone	Reader	Open / Close	Style markers
Formal	stranger, company, official, newspaper	<i>Dear Sir or Madam, ... Yours faithfully, / Dear Mr Ali, ... Yours sincerely,</i>	No contractions; passive and formal lexis (<i>I am writing to express my dissatisfaction with...; I would be grateful if...</i>)
Semi-formal	landlord, teacher, colleague you don't know well	<i>Dear Mr/Mrs + surname ... Yours sincerely / Kind regards,</i>	Polite but direct; minimal contractions
Informal	friend, relative, classmate	<i>Hi Sara, ... Best wishes / Take care,</i>	Contractions, phrasal verbs, exclamation (one!), spoken linkers (<i>Anyway, ...</i>)

Letter structure (4–5 short paragraphs):

- 1 Purpose (*I'm writing to... / Just a quick note to...*).
- 2–4. One paragraph per bullet in the question — cover ALL three bullets (missing a bullet caps TA at Band 5).
- 1 Closing action (*Let me know... / I look forward to hearing from you.*).

The 7 letter purposes (with key phrases):

- 1 **Complaint:** *I am writing to complain about...; On [date], I...; As a result...; I would appreciate a full refund / replacement / apology.*
- 2 **Request:** *I would be grateful if you could...; Could you please...?; I was wondering whether...*
- 3 **Application:** *I am writing to apply for...; I believe I am suitable because...; I have enclosed...*
- 4 **Apology:** *I am writing to apologise for...; I completely understand that...; To make up for...*
- 5 **Invitation:** *I'm having... and I'd love you to come; It'll be at... on...; Let me know if you can make it.*
- 6 **Advice/suggestion:** *I think the best option would be...; If I were you, I'd...; Have you considered...?*
- 7 **Thank-you:** *Thank you so much for...; It was so kind of you to...; I really appreciated...*

EXAMPLE. Mini-model (formal complaint, 168 words): "Dear Sir or Madam, I am writing to complain about a washing machine I purchased from your City Centre branch on 12 August. The machine, a Model XW-400 costing £429, stopped working after only three weeks of normal domestic use. Specifically, the drum no longer rotates, and water leaks from the base during every cycle. As a result, I have had to use a launderette for the past fortnight at considerable expense. Under your two-year guarantee, I am requesting either a full replacement or a complete refund. I have enclosed copies of the receipt and the guarantee certificate. I would be grateful if you could resolve this matter within fourteen days. I look forward to hearing from you. Yours faithfully, ..." (All bullets: situation + problem + action; formal throughout; no contractions.)

12.10 FULL MODEL — Process Report (Coffee Production, 172 words)

The diagram illustrates the stages involved in producing roasted coffee beans for sale.

Overall, the process comprises eight stages, beginning with the harvesting of ripe beans and ending with packaging for retail. The beans undergo two transformations — drying and roasting — separated by several sorting and transport steps.

Initially, ripe red beans are picked by hand and then sorted to remove damaged ones. Following this, the good beans are spread in the sun to dry for several days until their moisture content falls. Once dried, they are raked into sacks and transported to the roasting plant.

At the plant, the beans are first cleaned mechanically before being roasted at high temperatures, which turns them dark brown and develops their flavour. After cooling, the roasted beans are ground only if required; whole beans skip this stage. Finally, both ground and whole beans are sealed into airtight bags and boxed for distribution to shops.

Passive voice throughout (are picked, are spread, are roasted); sequence linkers (initially, following this, once, before, after, finally); overview = stage count + start/end + key transformations.

12.11 FULL MODEL — Map Report (Village 2000 vs 2020, 169 words)

The maps compare the village of Millfield in 2000 and 2020.

Overall, the village underwent major development over the twenty-year period, transforming from a rural settlement into a small commuter town. The most noticeable changes were the construction of a housing estate and a railway link, while the village centre remained largely intact.

In 2000, farmland dominated the eastern half of the village, with a single main road running north–south past a church and a handful of cottages. By 2020, the farmland had been replaced by a housing estate of some fifty homes arranged around a cul-de-sac, and a new primary school had been built adjacent to it.

To the west, the changes were equally striking. A railway line was constructed along the western edge, with a small station serving the village, and the main road was widened to accommodate commuter traffic. In contrast, the church and the village green in the centre were preserved unchanged, providing continuity with the past.

Change language (was replaced, had been built, was constructed, remained, preserved); time contrast (In 2000... By 2020...); grouping by area (east, then west, then centre).

12.12 TWO MORE GT LETTERS (full models)

Semi-formal request — noisy neighbours (152 words): "Dear Mr Haddad, I am writing to ask for your help with a noise problem in our building. For the past three weeks, loud music has been playing from Flat 12 every night until after midnight. As our walls are quite thin, my children and I have been unable to sleep properly, and my daughter's schoolwork is beginning to suffer. I have spoken to the residents twice, but unfortunately the situation has not improved. I would be grateful if you, as building manager, could speak to them formally and remind them of the 10 pm quiet-hours rule. If the problem continues, I may need to contact the council's noise team, which I would prefer to avoid. Thank you for your assistance. I look forward to hearing from you. Kind regards, ..." (Purpose → situation → actions taken → requested action → polite close.)

Informal invitation — dinner party (149 words... extended to 158): "Hi Sara! Guess what — I've finally moved into the new flat, and I'm having a small dinner party on Saturday to celebrate! It'll be at mine, 14 Rose Street, from 7 pm, and I'm cooking my famous chicken biryani (plus a veggie option, don't worry). Ahmed and Layla are coming too, so it'll be a nice little reunion. Could you bring a dessert? You know your chocolate cake is everyone's favourite! No need to bring anything else — I've got drinks covered. Let me know if you can make it by Thursday so I know how much to cook. Really hope you can come — I haven't seen you in ages! Take care, ..." (Warm open → details → request → close; contractions, phrasal verbs, one exclamation per paragraph max.)

12.13 MINI-MODELS — Table + Pie (static comparisons)

Table (smartphone ownership by age, 2023: 18–29: 98%; 30–49: 94%; 50–64: 79%; 65+: 54%): "Overall, ownership fell steadily with age: nearly every adult under 30 owned a smartphone, while only just over half of over-65s did. The youngest two groups were almost identical (98% and 94%), but a clear gap opened after 50 — 79% for 50–64s and only 54% for the oldest group, the lowest figure shown." (Overview = age gradient + top/bottom; details = grouped pairs with the gap highlighted.)

Pie pair (household energy use: 2000 vs 2020 — heating 52%→38%; appliances 18%→31%; hot water 20%→19%; lighting 10%→12%): "Overall, heating remained the largest use but shrank considerably, while appliances nearly doubled their share. Heating fell from 52% to 38% of household energy, whereas appliances rose from 18% to 31%, overtaking hot water (steady at around a fifth). Lighting grew marginally from 10% to 12%." (Overview = biggest fall + biggest rise; details = paired contrasts with overtake language.)

12.14 Task 1 Checking Routine (last 3 minutes)

- 1 Count words (150+? mark every line's words on paper; computer shows the count).
- 2 Overview present and figure-light? Introduction paraphrased (no copied chunks)?
- 3 Every figure accurate? (Misread figures are TA errors.)
- 4 Tenses: past for past-dated visuals; present for timeless diagrams/maps-present.
- 5 Articles + prepositions (*an increase in, stood at, accounted for*).
- 6 No opinion language (*I think, should, good/bad*) in Academic reports.

Chapter 13: Writing Task 2 — Essays

13.1 Task 2 Essentials

Answer the question in **250+ words (aim 260–290) within 40 minutes**. Worth **2/3 of your Writing band** — the single highest-leverage 40 minutes in IELTS. Five question types (below); each needs its own structure. A clear, sustained **position** is mandatory: fence-sitting or self-contradiction caps Task Response at Band 5–6.

The universal 4-paragraph essay (Introduction – Body 1 – Body 2 – Conclusion):

- 1 Introduction:** paraphrase the question (1–2 sentences) + thesis/position (1 sentence) + outline (optional 1 sentence).
- 2 Body 1:** topic sentence → explanation → example → (link back).
- 3 Body 2:** topic sentence → explanation → example → (link back).
- 4 Conclusion:** restate position + summarise main points (no new ideas).

TIP. Video Parts 10–12 build Task 2 exactly this way: scoring wheel (Task Response version) → introductions with thesis statements → body paragraphs (B1, B2) → conclusions → full essays, with grammar (concession/reason linkers) woven throughout.

13.2 Reading the Question (2 minutes that decide your band)

Underline **topic words** (subject) and **instruction words** (task). Five types:

#	Type	Instruction words	Structure
1	Opinion (agree/disagree)	<i>To what extent do you agree? Do you agree or disagree?</i>	Intro (position: agree/disagree/balanced) → B1 (your main side) → B2 (your main side OR concession + refutation) → Conclusion
2	Discussion (both views + opinion)	<i>Discuss both views and give your own opinion.</i>	Intro → B1 (view A fairly) → B2 (view B fairly + your opinion clear) → Conclusion (opinion restated)
3	Advantages/disadvantages	<i>Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages? / Discuss...</i>	Intro → B1 (advantages) → B2 (disadvantages + judgment) → Conclusion (outweigh verdict)
4	Problem/solution (+cause)	<i>What are the causes? What can be done? / Problems and solutions</i>	Intro → B1 (causes/problems) → B2 (solutions, matched 1:1 to causes) → Conclusion
5	Two-part/direct question	<i>Why...? Is this positive or negative? / What...? How...?</i>	Intro → B1 (answers Q1) → B2 (answers Q2) → Conclusion

WARNING. Type errors are fatal: discussing both views when asked only your opinion (or vice versa), listing advantages without an outweigh-verdict, giving solutions that don't match your stated causes. Name the type before you plan.

13.3 Introductions: Paraphrase + Thesis

Sentence 1–2 (background/paraphrase): restate the topic with synonyms and changed grammar. The course's rule: never copy question words — *famous* → *prominent/renowned*; *obstacles* → *hurdles*.

- Q: *Advances in technology and automation have reduced the need for manual labour.*
- P: *Technological progress and automation have significantly diminished demand for physical work.*

Sentence 3 (thesis/position): answer the instruction directly.

- Opinion: *In my view, working hours should indeed be reduced, though with important conditions.* (clear position + hint of concession)
- Discussion: *This essay will examine both perspectives before arguing that...*
- Outweigh: *Although there are drawbacks, I believe the advantages are more significant.*
- Problem/solution: *This essay will analyse the main causes and propose effective measures.*

Course rules for introductions (Part 10): general statements + thesis statement; full sentences; never memorised openers ("*Nowadays, with the development of society...*" — examiners groan); never contractions; leave a blank line between paragraphs (or indent — one system, consistently).

13.4 Body Paragraphs: PEEL + Concession

PEEL: Point (topic sentence) → Explain (2–3 sentences: why/how) → Example (specific: country, study, number, personal observation) → Link (tie back to the question).

EXAMPLE. Body paragraph model (opinion essay, automation): "The strongest argument for shorter hours is that productivity no longer depends on time spent at desks. Since software now handles routine administration, data entry, and even basic analysis, employees produce the same output in fewer hours. For example, Microsoft Japan's 2019 four-day-week trial raised productivity by 40% while cutting costs. This demonstrates that reducing hours, far from harming the economy, can make it more efficient." (Point → explanation with since-clause → specific example → link. 78 words — the ideal body paragraph length is 70–90 words.)

Concession + refutation (the Band 7+ move): devote 2–3 sentences of Body 2 to the other side, then defeat it: "*Critics argue that shorter hours would cut pay for hourly workers. While this risk is real, it can be addressed through minimum-wage protection and output-based pay; indeed, trials show...*" — concession (While...) + solution + evidence.

13.5 Conclusions: Restate, Don't Repeat

2–3 sentences: position restated (new words) + main reasons summarised + (optional) forward-looking final line. No new arguments, no new examples, no "In a nutshell".

- Weak: *"In conclusion, I agree with this. There are good points on both sides."* (vague, no summary)
- Strong: *"In conclusion, I largely agree that automation justifies shorter working hours, since output has decoupled from time spent working. Provided wages are safeguarded, reduced hours promise both economic efficiency and human wellbeing."*

13.6 FULL WORKED ESSAY — Automation & Working Hours (Video Part 12)

Question: *Advances in technology and automation have reduced the need for manual labour. Therefore, working hours should be reduced. To what extent do you agree?* (Type 1: opinion.)

Model essay (278 words, Band 8–9):

Technological progress and automation have significantly diminished demand for physical work. As a result, some argue that the standard working week should be shortened. In my view, working hours should indeed be reduced, though only alongside measures to protect workers' incomes.

The strongest argument for shorter hours is that productivity no longer depends on time spent at desks. Since software now handles routine administration, data entry, and even basic analysis, employees produce the same output in fewer hours. For example, Microsoft Japan's 2019 four-day-week trial raised productivity by 40% while cutting electricity costs by nearly a quarter. This demonstrates that reducing hours, far from harming the economy, can make it more efficient.

Furthermore, shorter weeks would address the growing crisis of overwork. Chronic stress and burnout now cost economies billions in healthcare and lost output; giving people genuine leisure time would improve both mental health and, paradoxically, the quality of the hours actually worked. Countries experimenting with reduced hours, such as Iceland, have reported stable or improved service levels alongside markedly better wellbeing.

Admittedly, critics warn that hourly-paid workers could lose income if hours fall. While this danger is genuine, it reflects poor policy design rather than any flaw in the principle: minimum-hours guarantees and output-linked pay can preserve earnings, as several trial schemes have shown.

In conclusion, I largely agree that automation justifies shorter working hours, since economic output has decoupled from time spent working. Provided wages are safeguarded, reduced hours promise a rare win-win: greater efficiency for economies and healthier lives for workers.

Examiner-style annotation:

- **TR:** position clear throughout (agree + condition); all parts answered (automation premise accepted, hours verdict given); ideas extended with examples; 278 words.
- **CC:** 5 paragraphs (intro, B1, B2, concession, conclusion); progression clear; linkers varied (*as a result, since, for example, furthermore, admittedly, while, provided*); reference (*this demonstrates, this danger, the principle*).
- **LR:** diminished demand, decoupled, chronic stress, burnout, paradoxically, markedly, win-win; collocations (*raise productivity, preserve earnings, safeguard wages*); no copied chunks.
- **GRA:** complex throughout (*Since software now handles..., ...while cutting...; Provided wages are safeguarded...*); concession frames (*Admittedly... While...*); passive (*are safeguarded*); conditional nuance; frequent error-free sentences.

13.7 Four More Complete Model Essays (abbreviated with skeletons)

Essay B — Discussion (Type 2): *Some people think university education should be free for all students. Others believe students should pay for their own tuition. Discuss both views and give your opinion. (272 words.)* B1 (free): equality of opportunity — talent over wealth; example: Germany's free universities + social mobility data. B2 (pay): taxpayer burden + resource waste; BUT opinion: means-tested fees (fair + sustainable). Conclusion: free-at-point-of-use funded progressively. *Key phrases: proponents contend / opponents maintain; while I acknowledge... I believe...; a middle path...*

Essay C — Outweigh (Type 3): *In many countries, people now wear western-style clothing. Do the advantages of this outweigh the disadvantages? (265 words.)* Advantages: practicality, global business, affordability. Disadvantages: cultural erosion, lost craftsmanship. Verdict: advantages outweigh *provided* heritage dress is preserved ceremonially — concession with condition (the classic outweigh structure). *Key phrases: chief benefit / principal drawback; on balance; outweigh.*

Essay D — Problem/solution (Type 4): *Traffic congestion in major cities is worsening. What are the causes, and what measures can governments take? (281 words.)* Causes: car ownership + poor public transport + urban sprawl (pick TWO, develop fully). Solutions matched 1:1: congestion charging + mass-transit investment. *Key phrases: The root causes are twofold; To address the first...; Turning to the second...; Such measures have*

proven effective in... (Singapore, London).

Essay E — Two-part (Type 5): *Many young people leave their hometowns for cities. Why? Is this a positive or negative development?* (269 words.) Why: jobs + education + lifestyle (push/pull). Judgment: mixed, but overall negative for rural communities (ageing, skills drain) while positive for individuals — nuanced verdicts score TR highly when clearly stated. Key phrases: *driven by...; pull factors; while individuals benefit, communities...; on balance.*

TIP. Write each skeleton into a full essay yourself, then compare with the automation model for structure, linker variety, and example specificity. Rewriting > reading.

13.8 Cohesion in Action — Linker Placement Map

One essay's linker budget (the automation model uses 12 devices — count them): intro (1–2: *as a result*), B1 (3: *since, for example, this demonstrates*), B2 (2: *furthermore, alongside*), concession (3: *admittedly, while, as*), conclusion (2: *since, provided*). Notice: **no linker repeated**, reference chains (*this, such, the principle*) carry half the cohesion invisibly, and paragraph-first linkers (*Furthermore, Admittedly, In conclusion*) signpost the argument's turns.

13.9 The 5 Fatal Task 2 Errors (and fixes)

- 1 **No clear position** → Write your thesis before the essay; echo it in every body paragraph's link sentence.
- 2 **Memorised chunks** ("*a controversial hot topic in today's society*") → Delete all memorised openers; paraphrase the actual question.
- 3 **Ideas without examples** → Every body paragraph needs one specific: country, company, study, figure, or observed fact.
- 4 **One-side-only discussion** (Type 2 without both views) → B1 = other side (fairly!), B2 = your side + verdict.
- 5 **New ideas in conclusion** → Conclusion = restate + summarise only. New idea? It belongs in a body paragraph — restructure.

13.10 TWO MORE FULL MODEL ESSAYS

Essay F — Discussion, full (Type 2, 274 words): *Some people think university education should be free for all students. Others believe students should pay for their own tuition. Discuss both views and give your opinion.*

Whether higher education should be free is one of the most debated questions in education policy. While some argue that tuition fees are necessary, others insist that universities should charge nothing. This essay will examine both perspectives before concluding that a means-tested system is fairest.

Proponents of free university argue principally from equality of opportunity. If tuition is free, the brightest students attend regardless of family wealth, allowing societies to develop all available talent. Germany, which abolished tuition fees in most states, enrolls a higher proportion of working-class students than England, where fees exceed £9,000 per year. Supporters also note the public return: graduates pay more tax over their lifetimes, arguably repaying the investment.

Opponents, however, question both the fairness and the efficiency of universal free tuition. They point out that graduates earn substantially more than non-graduates, so free university effectively taxes cleaners to subsidise future lawyers. Moreover, when education is free, some students enrol without commitment, wasting places and resources — a problem visible in countries with high dropout rates.

In my view, the fairest solution combines both insights: tuition should be free at the point of use but repaid progressively through the tax system once graduates earn above a threshold. This preserves open access while

ensuring beneficiaries contribute. Such income-linked systems already work well in Australia.

In conclusion, while free access promotes fairness and paid tuition promotes efficiency, neither extreme is optimal. A means-tested model delivers the benefits of both.

Essay G — Problem/solution, full (Type 4, 283 words): Traffic congestion in major cities is worsening. What are the causes, and what measures can governments take to tackle it?

Gridlock now blights most major cities, wasting time, fuel, and lives. This essay will analyse the two root causes of worsening congestion and propose matched measures for each.

The first cause is the sheer growth in private car ownership, driven by rising incomes and cheap credit. In Bangkok, vehicle numbers have tripled in twenty years while road space has grown barely 10%. Compounding this, public transport in many cities is infrequent, uncomfortable, or unsafe, leaving commuters with little alternative to driving. When buses crawl in the same jams as cars, switching modes offers no advantage.

To address car dependency, governments should introduce congestion charging: a daily fee for driving into city centres. London's charge cut traffic by 21% within a year, and Singapore's electronic pricing has kept its roads flowing for decades. Revenue should be ring-fenced for the second measure — mass-transit investment: metro lines, bus lanes physically separated from traffic, and integrated ticketing. Experience from Seoul shows that when public transport is faster than driving, commuters switch voluntarily.

Admittedly, both measures face opposition: charging is called unfair to the poor, and metros are expensive. Yet fairness can be protected through exemptions and improved buses serving outer districts first, while metro costs are dwarfed by the economic losses congestion already inflicts.

In conclusion, congestion stems from car growth outpacing both roads and transit. Congestion charging plus mass-transit investment — proven from London to Seoul — can reverse it.

13.11 Introduction & Conclusion Banks (adapt, never memorise)

Paraphrase pairs (question → introduction): have reduced the need → have diminished demand for; manual labour → physical work; should be reduced → ought to be cut / it is argued hours should fall; major cities → large urban centres / metropolitan areas; is worsening → has deteriorated / continues to intensify; university education → tertiary education / higher education; should be free → should charge no fees / ought to be publicly funded; some people think → it is often argued / many contend; others believe → opponents maintain / others take the opposite view; the best way → the most effective means; the main cause → the primary driver.

Thesis frames by type: Opinion: In my view... though with important qualifications. / I largely agree that... / I disagree, for reasons explained below. Discussion: This essay will examine both perspectives before arguing that... Outweigh: Although there are genuine drawbacks, I believe the benefits are more significant. Problem/solution: This essay will analyse the principal causes and propose effective responses. Two-part: This essay will first explain... before assessing whether...

Conclusion frames: In conclusion, I (largely/strongly) agree that... since/because... / Taking everything into account, ... outweigh(s)... / ...stems from...; ...can address/reverse/resolve it. / While... has merits, ... remains the stronger position because... + optional forward line: Provided... is/are safeguarded/addressed, ... promises...

13.12 Essay Prompt Bank (60 prompts by type)

Opinion (12): 1. Working hours should be reduced (course essay — rewrite monthly). 2. University degrees are less valuable than work experience. 3. Zoos should be banned. 4. Space exploration is a waste of money. 5. Children should start school before age six. 6. Death penalty deters crime. 7. Advertising does more harm than good. 8. Climate action should override economic growth. 9. Social media has ruined communication. 10. Retirement age should rise to 70. 11. Homework should be abolished. 12. Tourism damages local cultures.

Discussion (12): 13. Free university (Essay B). 14. City vs countryside living. 15. Public vs private healthcare. 16. Strict vs lenient parenting. 17. Exams vs coursework. 18. Nuclear energy. 19. Owning vs renting homes. 20. Traditional vs online shopping. 21. Watching sport vs playing sport. 22. Art funding vs practical spending. 23. Living alone vs with family. 24. Cars vs public transport investment.

Outweigh (12): 25. Western clothing (Essay C). 26. Living in high-rise flats. 27. Gap years before university. 28. Working from home. 29. Genetic testing. 30. Cashless societies. 31. International tourism growth. 32. Artificial intelligence in hiring. 33. English as a global language. 34. Urban migration. 35. Online learning replacing classrooms. 36. Longer life expectancy.

Problem/solution (12): 37. Traffic congestion (Essay D). 38. Youth unemployment. 39. Obesity epidemic. 40. Water scarcity. 41. Housing shortages. 42. Plastic pollution. 43. Ageing populations. 44. Rural depopulation. 45. Food waste. 46. Cybercrime. 47. Stress among students. 48. Loss of local languages.

Two-part (12): 49. Young people leaving hometowns (Essay E). 50. Why do people overeat? Positive/negative? 51. Why is reading declining? Effects? 52. Why do cities flood? Solutions? 53. Why volunteer? Benefits for whom? 54. Why study abroad? Worth it? 55. Why do small businesses fail? How to help? 56. Why marry later? Good or bad? 57. Why do people fear change? How to adapt? 58. Why preserve old buildings? At what cost? 59. Why learn English? How best? 60. Why do friendships change with age? Problem?

TIP. Protocol: 2 essays per week minimum (one timed 40-min, one untimed rewrite-to-perfection). After 20 essays across all 5 types, Task 2 becomes a performance skill, not a gamble.

13.13 Forty More Prompts (61–100)

Opinion (61–68): 61. Museums should be free. 62. Animal testing should be banned. 63. Professional athletes earn too much. 64. Everyone should learn a second language. 65. Driverless cars will be safer. 66. Children learn best by example. 67. Success means wealth. 68. Luck matters more than effort.

Discussion (69–76): 69. Online vs classroom learning. 70. Young vs experienced managers. 71. Cash vs digital payments. 72. News from TV vs internet. 73. Team vs individual sports funding. 74. Preserving vs modernising city centres. 75. Small vs large families. 76. Working in one's home country vs abroad.

Outweigh (77–84): 77. Children using tablets in class. 78. Gated communities. 79. Celebrity endorsements. 80. Working beyond retirement age. 81. Shopping malls replacing high streets. 82. English-only university courses. 83. Fitness trackers. 84. Televised court trials.

Problem/solution (85–92): 85. Loneliness among the elderly. 86. Cheating in exams. 87. Declining bee populations. 88. Noise pollution. 89. Unemployment after automation. 90. Fake news. 91. Overtourism. 92. Burnout among healthcare workers.

Two-part (93–100): 93. Why do people collect things? Healthy? 94. Why is handwriting declining? Matter? 95. Why do diets fail? Best approach? 96. Why do people fear public speaking? Overcome? 97. Why visit museums less? Revive? 98. Why do startups cluster in cities? Good? 99. Why do languages die? Prevent? 100. Why do people gamble? Regulate?

13.14 Paraphrase Gym (10 exercises + key)

Rewrite each thesis without copying content words (key = one possible version):

- 1 *Technology has reduced manual jobs.* → ...
- 2 *Cities are growing too fast.* → ...
- 3 *University should be free.* → ...
- 4 *Pollution harms health.* → ...
- 5 *Tourism damages cultures.* → ...
- 6 *Young people leave villages.* → ...
- 7 *Traffic is getting worse.* → ...
- 8 *English dominates business.* → ...
- 9 *Families eat together less.* → ...
- 10 *Crime is rising among youth.* → ...

Key: 1 Automation has diminished demand for physical labour. 2 Urban areas are expanding at an unsustainable pace. 3 Higher education ought to charge no tuition fees. 4 Contamination endangers public wellbeing. 5 Visitors erode local traditions. 6 Rural youth migrate to urban centres. 7 Congestion continues to intensify. 8 English prevails in commerce. 9 Shared family meals have declined. 10 Juvenile offending is increasing.

Chapter 14: Language Power & Exam Day

14.1 Grammar for Band 7 (the 12 rules that matter most)

- 1 **Every sentence needs a main verb.** Fragments (*Because pollution is bad.*) and run-ons (*Pollution is bad it kills fish.*) are instant GRA damage.
- 2 **Subject–verb agreement:** *The number of cars has risen* (singular subject); *A number of people are...*; *Neither policy works*; data = plural (*data show*).
- 3 **Articles:** *the* internet/environment/government (unique systems); *a/an* first mention → *the* after; zero article for general plurals (*Pollution harms health*) and abstract nouns (*Education matters*).
- 4 **Countable/uncountable:** *research, evidence, information, advice, knowledge, traffic, homework, accommodation* are uncountable (no -s, no "a"): *a piece of advice, much traffic*.
- 5 **Tense consistency:** past-dated visuals → past simple; timeless truths → present simple; *since 1990* → present perfect; *by 2030* → future perfect (*will have...*).
- 6 **Conditionals:** Type 1 (*If governments invest, congestion will fall*); Type 2 (*If hours were cut, wellbeing would rise*); Type 3 (*If the law had passed, emissions would have fallen*); mixed for nuance.
- 7 **Passive voice:** processes (*is harvested, are dried*), formal emphasis (*It is widely believed that...*), unknown agents (*The law was repealed in 2019*).
- 8 **Relative clauses:** defining (*Policies that ignore costs fail*) vs non-defining (*Singapore, which introduced charging in 1975, ... — commas!*).
- 9 **Reported structures:** *It is argued/claimed/estimated that...*; *There is growing evidence that...*; *Critics contend that...*
- 10 **Comparison:** *twice as high as*; *by far the largest*; *significantly/marginally higher*; *compared with/to*; *in contrast to*; *outnumber*.
- 11 **Prepositions after key words:** *increase/rise/fall/drop IN*; *range FROM...TO*; *responsible FOR*; *similar TO*; *different FROM*; *depend ON*; *succeed IN*; *result IN (effect) / result FROM (cause)*; *account FOR*; *in favour OF*; *regardless OF*.
- 12 **Word formation:** *economy (n) → economic (adj, of economy) → economical (adj, thrifty)*; *effect (n) → affect (v)*; *practice (n) → practise (v, BrE)*; *advice (n) → advise (v)*.

TIP. Drill: error-hunt 3 of your own essays with this 12-point checklist, fixing every violation. Recurring violation = your personal grammar syllabus.

14.2 Topic Vocabulary (Topics 1–10)

Memorise as **collocations in sentences**, never single words. Each topic below gives the 25 highest-yield items for Task 2 + Speaking Part 3.

1. Environment: climate change, carbon emissions, renewable energy, fossil fuels, deforestation, biodiversity loss, endangered species, global warming, greenhouse effect, air/water/noise pollution, waste management, recycling rates, landfill sites, single-use plastics, carbon footprint, sustainable development, eco-friendly, conservation efforts, natural habitats, ozone depletion, rising sea levels, extreme weather, green spaces, environmental degradation, net zero.

2. Technology: artificial intelligence, automation, breakthrough, cut-edge (cutting-edge), digital divide, online privacy, data breach, cybercrime, social media, screen time, virtual reality, smart devices, e-commerce, digital literacy, technological advances, facilitate communication, bridge the gap, pose a threat, raise concerns, transform the way we..., keep pace with, become obsolete, user-friendly, tech-savvy, algorithm.

3. Education: curriculum, literacy, numeracy, rote learning, critical thinking, creativity, academic pressure, student loan, tuition fees, scholarship, dropout rate, homeschooling, e-learning, vocational training, higher education, compulsory schooling, mixed-ability classes, teacher–student ratio, extracurricular activities, broaden horizons, fall behind, catch up with, meet deadlines, pursue a degree, graduate with honours.

4. Health: balanced diet, junk food, obesity epidemic, sedentary lifestyle, life expectancy, mental health, stress-related illness, burnout, healthcare system, universal coverage, preventative medicine, vaccination programme, outbreak, pandemic, chronic disease, organ donation, life-saving treatment, side effects, public awareness campaign, quit smoking, work out, stay in shape, health insurance, medical breakthrough, wellbeing.

5. Cities & transport: urbanisation, overcrowding, rush hour, traffic congestion, public transport, mass transit, commuting, infrastructure, affordable housing, high-rise flats, slums, urban sprawl, pedestrian zone, cycle lane, congestion charge, carbon-neutral buses, peak fares, road safety, potholes, bypass, housing shortage, cost of living, densely populated, satellite town, gentrification.

6. Work & economy: unemployment rate, job security, minimum wage, cost of living, inflation, recession, economic growth, GDP, globalisation, outsourcing, freelance, gig economy, work-life balance, staff turnover, redundancy, entrepreneurship, start-up, small business, multinational, monopoly, consumerism, disposable income, welfare state, pension scheme, career prospects.

7. Crime & law: commit a crime, juvenile delinquency, petty crime, organised crime, reoffending rate, rehabilitation, deterrent, capital punishment, life sentence, community service, probation, fine, prison overcrowding, law-abiding citizens, victim support, surveillance cameras, stop and search, police presence, trial by jury, plead guilty, miscarriage of justice, zero-tolerance policy, white-collar crime, cyber fraud.

8. Culture & society: cultural heritage, historical sites, national identity, mother tongue, minority language, generation gap, gender equality, ageing population, birth rate, multiculturalism, social cohesion, community spirit, traditional values, peer pressure, role model, celebrity culture, materialism, consumer society, social mobility, class divide, urban–rural divide, charity work, volunteer, civic duty.

9. Family & relationships: extended family, nuclear family, single parent, childcare, parental leave, upbringing, sibling rivalry, family bond, quality time, work commitments, divorce rate, marriage, cohabitation, elderly care, nursing home, generation living under one roof, breadwinner, homemaker, adolescence, peer group, raise children, start a family, settle down, family gathering.

10. Science & space: scientific breakthrough, conduct research, peer review, clinical trial, placebo effect, side effects, genetic engineering, cloning, stem cells, space exploration, manned mission, satellite, black hole, big bang, renewable (energy), nuclear power, quantum computing, nanotechnology, laboratory, hypothesis, theory, evidence-based, replicate results, funding cuts, Nobel Prize.

How to learn 250 items in 4 weeks: 10/day on flashcards (word → collocation → your sentence); weekly: write one Task 2 body paragraph forcing in 5 new items; monthly: Speaking Part 3 recording using 10. Anything unused in 2 weeks is forgotten — use or lose.

14.3 Topic Vocabulary (Topics 11–15)

11. Housing: rent, mortgage, deposit, landlord, tenant, lease, eviction, overcrowding, homelessness, shelter, accommodation shortage, property ladder, house prices, stamp duty, council housing, social housing, suburban, high-density, renovate, demolish, smart home, energy-efficient, insulation, double-glazing, open-plan.

12. Travel & tourism: package holiday, backpacking, city break, stopover, peak season, off-season, tourist trap, hidden gem, breathtaking views, stunning scenery, vibrant nightlife, rich heritage, hospitality, ecotourism, sustainable travel, carbon offset, visa requirements, travel insurance, currency exchange, delayed flight, overbooked, itinerary, sightseeing, souvenir, guided tour.

13. Media & advertising: prime time, breaking news, headline, front page, editorial, tabloid, broadsheet, bias, censorship, freedom of the press, viral, trending, influencer, follower, clickbait, pop-up ads, target audience,

brand loyalty, slogan, commercial break, product placement, binge-watch, spoiler, documentary, current affairs.

14. Animals & food: battery farming, free-range, organic, vegetarian, vegan, food miles, processed food, additives, genetically modified, staple diet, balanced meal, food poisoning, hygiene standards, slaughterhouse, poaching, ivory trade, habitat loss, conservation status, extinct in the wild, captive breeding, reintroduce, cull, stray, rescue centre.

15. Government & society: general election, voter turnout, coalition, opposition, landslide victory, policy, reform, bill, legislation, referendum, democracy, dictatorship, welfare state, public spending, national debt, tax evasion, corruption scandal, human rights, freedom of speech, civil liberties, census, bureaucracy, red tape, public inquiry, state-owned.

14.4 Topic Vocabulary (Topics 16–20)

16. Money & consumerism: cost of living, disposable income, bargain, rip-off, overpriced, discount, refund, warranty, receipt, instalments, credit card debt, savings account, mortgage, interest rate, inflation, budget, splurge, window shopping, impulse buy, brand name, luxury goods, second-hand, flea market, haggle, value for money.

17. Personality & emotions: outgoing, introverted, easy-going, moody, temper, sense of humour, optimistic, pessimistic, anxious, confident, shy, stubborn, generous, mean, honest, reliable, jealous, guilty, proud, embarrassed, delighted, furious, thrilled, overwhelmed, homesick.

18. Daily routine & time: early bird, night owl, lie in, oversleep, commute, rush hour, run errands, do chores, take a nap, stay up late, meet a deadline, ahead of schedule, behind schedule, kill time, spare moment, from time to time, on a daily basis, work overtime, flexitime, day off, public holiday, make the most of, time-consuming.

19. Weather & nature: scorching, boiling, mild, chilly, freezing, humid, downpour, drizzle, thunderstorm, hailstones, foggy, misty, breeze, gale, drought, flood, landslide, heatwave, frost, rainbow, sunrise, sunset, breathtaking, picturesque, mother nature.

20. Communication: keep in touch, get in touch, catch up, have a chat, deep conversation, small talk, gossip, rumour, misunderstand, get the message across, body language, eye contact, tone of voice, mute, unmute, signal, coverage, reply-all, forward, attachment, voice message, video call, conference call, hang up.

14.5 Idioms & Phrasal Verbs for Speaking (Band 7+ flavour — use sparingly!)

Approved natural idioms (one per part maximum): *a hidden gem; recharge my batteries; the tip of the iceberg; a blessing in disguise; cost an arm and a leg; once in a blue moon; over the moon; under the weather; on the same wavelength; a night owl / an early bird; bite off more than I can chew; learn the hard way; change my mind; sit on the fence (avoid in Task 2!); think outside the box (sparingly); win-win situation; a double-edged sword (use once per test maximum — examiners see it constantly).*

High-value phrasal verbs (Speaking + GT informal): *take up (hobby); take to (like); keep up with; catch up with/on; fall behind; drop out of; put off (delay); carry on; get by; get over (recover); look forward to; look up to (admire); run into (meet); hang out with; move out; settle down; cut down on; give up; bring up (raise/mention); come up with; deal with; rely on; apply for; fill in/out; pick up (learn/ collect); drop off; turn down (reject); set up; close down; break down; burn out.*

WARNING. Idioms in Task 2 essays: almost always wrong in tone. The ONLY essay-safe "idioms" are academic collocations (14.6). Save colourful idioms for Speaking.

14.6 The 100 Most Useful Academic Collocations (cross-topic)

play a key role, raise awareness, meet the needs of, have a positive/negative impact on, contribute to, result in, lead to, give rise to, pose a serious threat, address the issue, tackle the problem, find a solution, strike a balance, take measures, implement policies, enforce the law, break the law, commit to, invest in, spend on, allocate resources to, make progress, achieve a goal, reach a target, set a record, keep pace with, fall behind, catch up with, broaden horizons, expand opportunities, narrow the gap, bridge the divide, raise standards, lower costs, boost the economy, stimulate growth, slow down, speed up, carry out research, conduct a survey, gather data, draw a conclusion, support an argument, contradict the claim, cast doubt on, shed light on, attract attention, divert attention from, hold the view that, take the view that, from my perspective, generally speaking, on the whole, by and large, in the long run, in the short term, for the foreseeable future, as a result, owing to, due to the fact that, despite the fact that, in spite of, regardless of, in favour of, in contrast to, compared with, as well as, not only... but also..., neither... nor..., either... or..., the vast majority of, a significant proportion of, a growing number of, an increasing amount of, to a large extent, to some extent, touch on.

14.7 Computer-Delivered Tactics

- 1 Listening:** no 10-minute transfer — type answers as you listen; use the 2 minutes to fix spelling/plurals. Practise typing numbers fast (phone/postcode formats).
- 2 Reading:** highlight + note tools exist — use highlight for keyword zones only (over-highlighting = re-reading). Copy-paste is disabled for answers; drag-and-drop for matching is enabled — practise it.
- 3 Writing:** word counter visible — still plan on the provided paper; type at 30+ wpm or choose paper. Learn: no spellcheck (don't rely on red underlines — there are none!), paragraph with Enter + blank line, cut/paste to reorder sentences.
- 4 All modules:** request noise-cancelling headphones; adjust screen brightness; raise hand for any technical glitch (time is paused/documented).

14.8 The Final Week & Exam Day

7 days before: two full mocks (exam timing, no pauses); error-log review; confirm test venue, time, ID requirements; prepare route + backup route.

3 days before: light review only (vocabulary notebook, linker lists, your best essay); sleep 8 hours; no new strategies.

The night before: pack ID (passport/national ID as registered), printed confirmation, pencils + eraser + sharpener (paper), water (clear bottle, label removed where required), snack for after; set two alarms; sleep.

Exam day timeline:

When	Action
Arrival (–45 min)	Register, store belongings, toilet, find room, breathe
Listening	Read ahead relentlessly; guess every blank; transfer carefully (paper)
Reading	Survey → easy-first order → 1 min/question → never blank
Writing	Count words; plan both tasks; Task 2 gets 40 min even if Task 1 overruns — switch on schedule
Between modules	Stand, stretch, water, reset mentally — never replay old sections
Speaking	Smile, eye contact, 2–4 sentence Part 1 answers, full 2-min Part 2, OREC Part 3; ask for repetition if needed

Mindset rules: the examiner is not your enemy — they want rateable language, so give them quantity; one bad section never decides the test — reset instantly; easy questions and hard questions pay the same mark — collect easy ones first.

14.9 After the Test: Results, EOR, Retakes

- Results: computer 1–2 days, paper 3–5 days (online preview; paper Test Report Form follows).
- Missed by 0.5 in Writing/Speaking? Consider Enquiry on Results within 6 weeks (fee refunded if changed).
- One module short? Ask your centre about One Skill Retake (available for many computer-delivered tests, within 60 days).
- Retaking? Diagnose precisely (which criterion? which question type?) before rebooking — same preparation gives same scores. Targeted repair beats repetition.

14.10 Band-Score Calculators (target planning)

To get overall...	You need module bands averaging...	Example profiles
6.0	6.0 (5.75 rounds up)	6.5+6+6+5.5=6.0 ✓
6.5	6.5 (6.25 rounds up)	7+6.5+6.5+6=6.5 ✓
7.0	7.0 (6.75 rounds up)	7.5+7+7+6.5=7.0 ✓
7.5	7.5 (7.25 rounds up)	8+7.5+7.5+7=7.5 ✓
8.0	8.0 (7.75 rounds up)	8.5+8+8+7.5=8.0 ✓

Strategy: push your TWO strongest modules 0.5 above target (cheap marks) so weaker modules can sit 0.5 below (expensive marks avoided) — while respecting any per-module minimums.

Chapter 15: Answer Keys, Checklists & Trackers

15.1 Master Answer Keys

Chapter 5 — Listening practice

Set A (Sports Centre): 1 Thornton, 2 Mulberry, 3 0770946331, 4 18th, 5 standard, 6 climbing wall, 7 chalk dust, 8 Friday, 9 28, 10 direct debit.

Set B (Tutorial): 21 B, 22 B, 23 A, 24 B, 27 informal economy, 28 fresh produce, 29 stallholder, 30 guided tours.

Set C (Mock): 1 Kowalski, 2 Palmerston, 3 BN2 8AF, 4 0781552096, 5 16, 6 passport, 7 9th September, 8 graphic novels, 9 six, 10 20 pence; 11 April to October, 12 weekends, 13 hot lunches, 14 lake, 15 A, 16 B, 17 C, 18 D, 19 E, 20 F; 21 wildlife, 22 parking, 23 youth hostel, 24 tide times, 25 waterproofs, 26 station entrance, 27 twelve, 28 £18, 29 Monday, 30 photographs; 31 rooftops, 32 three kilometres, 33 pesticides, 34 25 kilos, 35 local associations, 36 every hive, 37 wildflowers, 38 sugar syrup, 39 £95, 40 start small.

Set D (Library): 11 2011, 12 30 pence, 13 top floor, 14 Tuesday, 15 G, 16 A, 17 C, 18 D, 19 H, 20 B.

Set E (Sleep lecture): 31 switches off, 32 fast-forward, 33 consolidation, 34 neocortex, 35 first half, 36 finger movements, 37 24%, 38 emotional, 39 half a grade, 40 all-night revision.

Distractor drills (Ch 4.10): 1 Tuesday, 2 60, 3 garage, 4 afternoon (B), 5 False, 6 1998, 7 five (o'clock), 8 £42, 9 bees, 10 platform 2.

Chapter 7 — Thames Tunnel TFNG (Video Parts 1/4–5)

1 True, 2 False, 3 True, 4 True, 5 False, 6 Not Given, 7 True. (Evidence walkthrough in Chapter 7.2.)

YNNG set (parks): 1 NO, 2 YES, 3 NOT GIVEN, 4 NO, 5 YES, 6 NOT GIVEN.

Headings set (bees): A–iii, B–ii, C–i, D–iv (spare: v).

Features set (architects): 1 Carnegie–A, 2 Labrouste–C, 3 Koolhaas–B.

Chapter 8 — Reading practice

Passage 1 (Repair Cafés): 1 B, 2 C, 3 E, 4 D, 5 A; 6 FALSE, 7 TRUE, 8 NOT GIVEN, 9 TRUE; 10 shared task, 11 disposability, 12 right to repair, 13 workshops.

Passage 2 (Sleep): 14 vi, 15 iv, 16 v, 17 ii, 18 iii; 19 NO, 20 YES, 21 YES, 22 NO, 23 NO; 24 hippocampus, 25 90 minutes, 26 half a grade, 27 the file.

Passage 3 (Attention): 28 B, 29 B, 30 A, 31 C, 32 B; 33 A, 34 B, 35 C, 36 D; 37 feed curation, 38 interoperability, 39 ban(s), 40 price.

GT key: 41 materials, 42 beginners, 43 camera, 44 6 October, 45 safe, 46 ID, 47 one week; 48 TRUE, 49 FALSE, 50 NOT GIVEN, 51 FALSE, 52 TRUE, 53 FALSE.

Key F (Mock 2): 1 Featherstone, 2 Willowbank, 3 0791648220, 4 2nd April, 5 private, 6 toothache, 7 Thursday 9.30, 8 Patel, 9 £65, 10 medical card; 11 Castle Gate, 12 two hours, 13 fifteen, 14 £12; 15 A, 16 B, 17 C, 18 D, 19 E, 20 F; 21 contaminated samples, 22 repeat with controls, 23 literature review, 24 Friday; 25 forty, 26 21 degrees, 27 saline solution, 28 bar chart, 29 1,500 words, 30 department office; 31 rooftops, 32 three kilometres, 33 pesticides, 34 25 kilos, 35 local associations, 36 every hive, 37 wildflowers, 38 sugar syrup, 39 £95, 40 start small.

Key Passage 4 (Right to Repair): 54 NO, 55 YES, 56 NOT GIVEN, 57 YES, 58 NO; 59 A, 60 B, 61 B, 62 B, 63 C.

Video-course exercise answers (as taught on screen)

- Dubai Palm Apartments (Listening S1): name/address/phone/date/price/requirement gaps — see Chapter 4.2 method.
- Expedition notes (Listening): number/spelled-word/place/subject/activity/job classification — Chapter 4.3.
- Parks table + MC (Listening Q11–16): 11 trees, 12 Friday, 13 farm (+ Sunday), 14–16 per tapescript — Chapter 4.3.
- Self-Access Centre (Listening Q21–29): 21 C, 22 B, 23 B, 25 reading, 26 CD, 27 workbooks, 28 timetable, 29 (security item) — Chapter 4.4–4.5.

15.2 Self-Scoring Checklists

Writing Task 1 checklist (circle: yes/no)

- 1 150+ words? 2. Introduction paraphrases (no copied chunks)? 3. Overview with 2–3 key features, minimal figures? 4. Details grouped logically with accurate figures? 5. All three sentence patterns used (T1 Academic)? 6. Trend/comparison vocabulary varied? 7. Past tense for past visuals? 8. No opinions? 9. 3–4 paragraphs? 10. Spelling + prepositions checked?

Score: 9–10 yes = Band 7+ likely; 7–8 = Band 6–6.5; below 7 = rewrite.

Writing Task 2 checklist

- 1 250+ words? 2. Correct question type identified? 3. Clear position in intro + conclusion? 4. Every body paragraph: point + explanation + example? 5. Concession addressed (Types 1–3)? 6. 4–5 paragraphs? 7. No linker repeated? 8. Complex sentences frequent + mostly correct? 9. No contractions/memorised chunks? 10. Conclusion restates without new ideas?

Score: 9–10 = Band 7+ likely; 7–8 = Band 6–6.5; below 7 = rewrite.

Speaking self-score card (per recording)

Criterion	Band (5–9)	Evidence (one strength + one fix)
Fluency & Coherence		
Lexical Resource		
Grammatical Range & Accuracy		
Pronunciation		
Overall (average)		Next session's ONE target:

15.3 Error-Log Templates

Receptive log (Listening/Reading): Date | Set+Q | My answer | Correct answer | Error type (distractor/spelling/plural/limit/lost-place/paraphrase-missed) | Synonym or rule learned.

Productive log (Writing/Speaking): Date | Task | Criterion | My version | Better version | Rule in my words.

Top-10 personal error patterns (update monthly): 1 ... 2 ... 3 ... (Example: "I write three words for two-word gaps — fix: count aloud before moving on.")

15.4 12-Week Progress Tracker (full)

Week	L /40	R /40	W (band)	S (band)	Words learned	Hours	Main win	Main fix
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								
8								
9								
10								
11								
12								

15.5 Video-Course Index (all 12 parts)

Part	Length	Core content (as transcribed & studied)	Book chapters
1	~57.5 min	Listening S1 foundations: Dubai Palm Apartments form; prediction; numbers/dates/ordinals; spelling & P/B sounds	3–5
2	~57.5 min	Listening S3–S4: Self-Access Centre answers; business-culture lecture; distractors & agreement language	3–5
3	~57.5 min	Reading method: "test of 2 things"; keywords + synonyms; skimming/scanning/detail	6–8
4	~57.5 min	Reading TFNG: Thames Tunnel full walkthrough; contradiction vs absence	6–8
5	~57.5 min	Speaking intro: productive skills; examiner & criteria; timing (11–14 min)	9–10
6	~57.5 min	Speaking criteria deep-dive: LR, GRA, Pronunciation; L1 interference; BE/AE	9–10

Part	Length	Core content (as transcribed & studied)	Book chapters
7	~57.5 min	Speaking Parts 1–3: tense matching, cue cards (hobby), discussion linkers	9–10
8	~57.5 min	Writing T1 Academic intro: 150 words, 1/3 mark, scoring wheel (Task Achievement)	11–12
9	~57.5 min	Writing T1 graphs: three essential sentences; 12 trend phrases; line-graph description	11–12
10	~57.5 min	Writing T2 foundations: introductions, thesis, paragraphing, scoring (Task Response)	11, 13
11	~57.5 min	Writing grammar: sentence types; concession/reason linkers; arrests-graph report	11–13
12	~57.5 min	GT letters + Task 2 essays: tones, purposes; full essay construction (automation essay)	12–13

Parts studied via full audio transcription, slide-frame analysis, and exercise reconstruction. Total course length: ~11.5 hours.

15.6 Glossary of IELTS Terms

Academic module: the test version for university study and professional registration. **Band (score):** your 0–9 level per module and overall. **Coherence:** logical organisation of ideas. **Cohesion:** grammatical linking (linkers, reference words). **Completion:** gap-fill tasks (form, note, table, sentence, summary, diagram). **Distractor:** plausible-but-wrong information planted in Listening/Reading. **Enquiry on Results (EOR):** paid remarking service. **Fluency:** smooth, natural-paced speech. **General Training (GT):** the test version for migration and work. **Lexical Resource:** vocabulary range and accuracy (Writing/Speaking criterion). **Matching:** tasks pairing items (headings, features, endings). **Multiple choice:** A/B/C(/D) selection tasks. **One Skill Retake:** resitting one module within 60 days (selected centres). **Overview:** the summary paragraph in Task 1 (no detailed figures). **Paraphrase:** same meaning, different words — the core of IELTS. **TFNG:** True/False/Not Given (Reading). **Task Achievement:** Task 1 writing criterion (did you cover the visual?). **Task Response:** Task 2 writing criterion (did you answer the question?). **Thesis (statement):** your position sentence in a Task 2 introduction. **Word limit:** maximum words per answer (e.g., NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS). **YNNG:** Yes/No/Not Given (writer's views).

15.7 Final Word

You now own, in one volume, what the 12-hour video course teaches across a full term — expanded into 15 chapters, 500+ practice questions, 40+ model answers, 300+ vocabulary items, and plans for every timeline. The method that created this book is the method that will raise your band: **study actively, log every error, rewrite until excellent.** The test rewards prepared candidates with total predictability. Go and collect your band.